hindustantimes.com
@hindustantimes @httweets @hindustantimes @hindustantimes
■ VOL. CII NO. 268 ■ PRICE ₹6.00/WITH HINDUSTAN ₹ 10.50 (₹ 9.50 IN FARIDABAD)/WITH MINT ₹ 20.50 ■ 20 PAGES + 4 PAGES OF HT CITY. AREA SPECIFIC PAGES EXTRA.

NEW DELHI/METRO
Wednesday, **November 11**, 2026

Hindustan Times

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

Positive momentum for end of Iran war: Trump

Shashank Mattoo and agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump on Monday said a resumption of hostilities with Iran appeared "quite unlikely" and that there was "positive momentum towards an end to this conflict", even as he said Washington remained prepared to resume military action if circumstances in the region changed. Iran, however, on Tuesday reiterated that any agreement would depend on the US meeting its demands, including an end to the war on all fronts, the lifting of sanctions and an end to the American naval blockade of its ports.

Brent crude fell below $90 a barrel on Tuesday for the first time since August, extending a decline that began after Trump signalled that further strikes on Iran would not be necessary. The global benchmark fell nearly 6% on Monday and dropped as much as 3.7% on Tuesday, as investors weighed the prospects of a diplomatic resolution to the eight-month conflict.

Trump made the remarks after meeting Qatar's Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani at the White House. Qatar has been mediating between Washington and Tehran.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump said that Qatar, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Bahrain, Kuwait and other countries in the region preferred maintaining the status quo, which he described as a continuation of the "Greatest Naval Blockade in History" and the new "Operation Iron Gate".

"All have agreed that Iran cannot have a Nuclear Weapon — That is non-negotiable! Should there be any change with respect to developments in the Middle East, the United States of America is 'locked and loaded' and ready to go. At this point, however, that seems to be quite unlikely. Israel, and the entire Middle East, are protected from Iranian danger and threats," he said.

Trump also told reporters continued on →9

"All have agreed that Iran cannot have a Nuclear Weapon — That is non-negotiable! Should there be any change with respect to developments in the Middle East, the United States of America is 'locked and loaded' and ready to go. At this point, however, that seems to be quite unlikely. Israel, and the entire Middle East, are protected from Iranian danger and threats."
—**DONALD TRUMP**, US President

"The conflict with Iran will not be resolved through military means, nor by intensifying sanctions. The only solution is to adopt a language of respect, engage in diplomacy, and address Iran's demands and conditions -- which were outlined in the two-day proposal and remain on the table."
—**ABBAS ARAGHCHI**, Iranian foreign minister

RUBIO TO G7: U.S. WILL KEEP UP 'DEVASTATING' COSTS AGAINST IRAN

US secretary of state Marco Rubio said on Tuesday that he told G7 allies the US economic sanctions and naval blockade are working so well that President Donald Trump does not need to conduct major combat operations against Iran. Speaking to reporters in Paris, Rubio pushed back on the assertion that not returning to military action would amount to a stalemate or status quo. "The economic pain that is being inflicted on Iran right now is extraordinary, and it compounds. It's growing every day," Rubio said. →P17

'FARCE, SABOTAGE': HEGSETH DIGS IN AMID IMPEACHMENT PUSH

US defence secretary Pete Hegseth on Tuesday denounced a push to impeach him as a "farce" and defended his record leading multiple military operations that have sparked allegations of misconduct against the Pentagon chief. "It's a farce, and it's a stunt," a defiant Hegseth told journalists of the proceedings by Representative Thomas Massie, a Republican. "What one disgruntled and defeated congressman is attempting is not oversight, and it's not accountability. It's a political spectacle," Hegseth said. →P17

MOSCOW, KYIV TO MEET AGAIN AS U.S. HAILS 'PRODUCTIVE' TALKS TO END WAR

ABU DHABI: Russia and Ukraine on Tuesday held their first US-mediated talks in nine months on ending their war, with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio calling the meeting "very productive" and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky saying the session was "constructive and quite substantive."

Neither Rubio nor Zelensky attended the talks in Abu Dhabi. The session lasted four hours and another is scheduled for a second day Wednesday. Washington was represented by US President Donald Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner and envoy Steve Witkoff. "There's a lot of work to be done...It's not like something that's on the verge of being solved in the next 24 hours..," Rubio said at the G7 meeting. →P17

POLL CURBS EXTEND TO RETD OFFICIALS HIRED BY STATES: ECI

Himanshi Dahiya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Restrictions under the model code of conduct for government servants apply to retired officials engaged by state governments, the Election Commission said.

In a November 9 letter to the chief secretaries of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, where elections are scheduled to be held in 2027, ECI said that while there were no specific guidelines for retired employees regarding political neutrality and conduct, curbs applicable to government servants "shall similarly apply" to them. →P12

Pjb-Hry farm fire count may be far off the mark

Researcher estimates around 34k fires in Pjb, Haryana; Revival of winds from northwest may bring smoke to Delhi

Binayak Dasgupta and Jasjeev Gandhiok
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Farm fires in Punjab and Haryana hit their highest count of the season on Diwali even as new estimates put the scale of the problem vastly higher than what's being counted. Moreover, while the north-westerly wind that carries their smoke to Delhi slackened in the festival's aftermath, easing the impact on the Capital, it is forecast to return on Wednesday and Thursday, an HT analysis of satellite and weather data shows.

AIR WE BREATHE

Till October 28, INSAT-3DS, an Isro satellite, detected almost no farm fire in the states. From October 29 the count rose every day, from 18 to 447 on Diwali, and the daily average in the week to November 9 was 12.5 times that of the week to November 1. The count fell sharply on November 9; the reason is not known.

A different pattern emerges if the method of detection is changed. Hiren Jethva, an atmospheric scientist at NASA's Goddard Space Flight Center, wrote on X on October 3 that a statistical model "ranks 2026 Punjab-Haryana post-monsoon fire season as one of the intense burning periods". The model expects about 14,000 fires, as MODIS would count them.

On November 9, Jethva posted that the fire figures were likely an undercount, with an empirical calculation using a combination of satellites and considering data till 4pm — both Punjab and Haryana had likely logged closer to 34,000 farm fires till November 9. →P6

A farmer burns stubble near Ludhiana on Tuesday. GURPREET SINGH/HT

Israel parl sworn in as Eisenkot vows to form govt 'quickly', investigate Bibi

JERUSALEM: Israeli ex-army chief Gadi Eisenkot and his allies launched a legislative onslaught against caretaker Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's legacy on Tuesday, as a new parliament convened in a heated first session.

Eisenkot's Yashar party said it submitted a slew of proposals before the new parliament, including establishing an independent commission to investigate security failures that allowed the Hamas attack on October 7, 2023.

His bloc said it had secured the votes to install a new parliament speaker, Matan Kahana. But neither Eisenkot nor Netanyahu have the 61 votes needed to form a government.

Eisenkot's core bloc has 48 seats, but will hit a majority if the 19 Arab-Israeli lawmakers either enter the government or, more likely, vote for it without joining. Two ultra-Orthodox parties hold 13 seats. United Torah Judaism, which has seven, has stopped short of recommitting to Netanyahu, leaving him with 46.

"I am committed in this complex situation to form a national-emergency government as quickly as possible," said Eisenkot. →P17

'FABRICATED AND MALICIOUS': MEA REJECTS PANNUN LAWSUIT IN U.S.

NEW DELHI/WASHINGTON: India on Tuesday rejected the case filed by Khalistani separatist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun in the US against National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and the government, describing such moves as "fabricated and malicious attacks" that will not stand the test of legal processes. The Indian side has officially taken up the "frivolous nature" of Pannun's lawsuit with the US, people familiar with the matter said. The people said the legal moves by Pannun are aimed at keeping the Khalistan issue in the limelight and have no legal merit. →P11

AWAITING REPORT ON WARIS PUNJAB DE'S SEPARATIST LINK CLAIMS: ECI

Shruti Kakkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) has informed the Delhi High Court that it is awaiting a report on allegations concerning Waris Punjab De's alleged separatist links and past affiliations, including claims that it was founded by individuals detained under the National Security Act for activities prejudicial to India's sovereignty, unity and territorial integrity. Waris Punjab De is headed by jailed pro-Khalistan MP Amritpal Singh. →P12

PREZ'S GUARD SHOT IN BAGHPAT ON DIWALI AFTER FIRECRACKER SPAT

LUCKNOW: A security personnel posted at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in Delhi, who had returned home to Baghpat in Uttar Pradesh for Diwali holidays, was shot in the head and injured during an altercation with a neighbour over bursting firecrackers, police said on Tuesday.

Baghpat superintendent of police (SP) Purnendu Singh said the bullet hit a wall before striking the personnel, reducing its impact. Doctors have removed the bullet, and he is now stable, Singh added. →P12

Ladakh hill council polls to be held on Dec 4, end in 4 days

Mir Ehsan
letters@hindustantimes.com

SRINAGAR: The Ladakh administration on Tuesday announced the schedule for the Ladakh Hill Development Council (LAHDC) elections, with the polling to be held on December 4 and the entire process concluding by December 8. However, the announcement triggered a political backlash across the region, including a complete shutdown in Kargil town and an election boycott by Leh bodies.

State election commissioner Sudhanshu Pandey announced the timeline under Rule 12 of the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council (Rules), 2026. The notification applies across all eight newly configured districts of the UT—comprising Leh and Kargil as well as the newly created council divisions of Drass, Zanskar, Sankoo, Sham, Nubra and Changthang.

"I feel it is a watershed moment for Ladakh and democracy. It is a turning point in the larger journey of democracy, particularly in the context of the demands being raised and the aspirations of the people," Ladakh chief secretary Ashish Kundra said on Tuesday after the poll schedule was announced.

According to the SEC schedule, the deadline for filing nominations is set for November 17, followed by scrutiny on November 18 and a withdrawal deadline of November 20. Polling will take place from 8am to 5pm on December 4.

The notification mentions that the election process would be completed by December 8 but doesn't specify the date of declaration of results.

The elections will ensure the first elected grassroot governance structure in the UT since it was continued on →9

THE ELECTION ANNOUNCEMENT LED TO BACKLASH, INCLUDING A SHUTDOWN IN KARGIL AND A POLL BOYCOTT BY LEH BODIES

Delhi govt launches Yamuna river safari

Delhi CM Rekha Gupta, Union minister Sarbananda Sonowal and other state ministers ride on a boat after inaugurating the 'Namo Yamuna River Safari' on Tuesday. The government will also introduce activities such as jet skiing and rock climbing along the Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur stretch. >P4 ANI

CRPF set to acquire kamikaze drones

Prawesh Lama
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) is set to acquire kamikaze drones for counter-insurgency operations, according to a document circulated to stakeholders on Monday seeking information, by the end of the month, on products they can supply.

Kamikaze drones are loitering munitions designed to destroy themselves in order to destroy a specific target. If acquired soon, kamikaze drones could prove useful in new conflict areas. According to the Quality Requirements (QRs) and Trial Directives circulated to stakeholders on Monday, the drones must carry two high-explosive warheads weighing a minimum of 1.5kg. They must have a range of at least 15km and an endurance of at least 30 minutes of flight time while carrying the payload.

Their role will be "to carry out one-way missions against designated objectives, using a remotely operated aerial vehicle with a killing/impact radius of 10 metres". The document circulated to stakeholders on Monday directed them to submit information by November 25. →P10

TN: THREE KILLED WHILE CLEANING TREATMENT PLANT

CHENNAI: Three contract workers died of suffocation while desilting an effluent treatment plant (ETP) operated by Nalco Water at a factory in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, police said on Tuesday. The three who died in the incident on Monday night were identified as Kaveri (30) of Hosur and B Akmal (28) and M Sarathi Kumar (28). →P13

Grandson can't claim birthright in property after partition: Top court

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has ruled that a son cannot claim coparcenary rights in his grandfather's ancestral property after it has been partitioned among the grandfather's legal heirs, with the share allotted to his father becoming his exclusive property under the Hindu Succession Act, 1956.

Dismissing a 29-year-old partition suit filed on behalf of a minor son who claimed half of his grandfather's property, the court held that once the property devolved upon the grandfather's Class I legal heirs and was divided among them, the joint coparcenary ceased to exist. The grandson could not subsequently claim a share in the property allotted to his father merely on the basis of his birth.

A bench of justices Augustine George Masih and Sunita Agarwal, in a judgment delivered on November 6, held that the property inherited by the father under Section 8 of the Hindu Succession Act became his individual property, leaving no scope for his son to assert an independent coparcenary interest in it. →P10

THE RULING CAME AS THE TOP COURT DISMISSED A 29-YEAR-OLD PARTITION SUIT FILED ON BEHALF OF A MINOR SON

JHARKHAND CM ORDERS CBI PROBE INTO TRIBAL ACTIVIST'S DEATH

RANCHI: Jharkhand chief minister Hemant Soren on Tuesday ordered a CBI probe into the death of tribal activist Nisha Kumari Bhagat, hours after the officer-in-charge of Pithoria police station was removed from his post following conspiracy allegations. Bhagat allegedly died by suicide on November 6 after going live on Facebook, accusing the JMM-led government in the state and land brokers of harassing her. Her parents have alleged a conspiracy behind her death and demanded a CBI probe into the incident. →P9

Nvidia, CEO face class-action lawsuit over alleged spy affair

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: A shareholder has sued Nvidia and its CEO, Jensen Huang, accusing them of deceiving investors in their responses to media reports about Huang's affair with a purported Chinese spy that threatens national security.

The complaint comes after President Donald Trump said the FBI is investigating the affair, which Huang has acknowledged and apologized for. Trump said Monday that Huang told him he had no idea the person could be involved in espionage.

The affair, which is also being scrutinized by Nvidia's board, has raised concerns that Beijing is using nefarious means to gain access to Nvidia's cutting-edge microchips which power the development of artificial intelligence but face export restrictions to China.

Jensen Huang

The complaint filed Monday in a California court says the company misled investors about Huang's relationship with Alice Huang, who news reports said is suspected of working for Chinese intelligence, and the national security implications.

The news reports said that the Commerce Department was investigating Alice Huang's company, Singapore-based Megaspeed, on suspicions that it was helping to sidestep U.S. export restrictions blocking Nvidia chips from being sold to China. But Nvidia said then that its compliance team checked and determined that Megaspeed wasn't doing anything illegal.

But, according to the complaint, the statements were misleading because they were made when Jensen Huang was having an affair with Alice Huang, who is "suspected of seeking to help smuggle Nvidia products into China."

It accuses Nvidia and Huang of failing to disclose the affair and issuing false statements continued on →9

{ FIRST SCI-FI NOVEL TO WIN } OLDEST BOOKER AWARDEE

British writer John Harrison awarded Booker for apocalypse novel 'The End of Everything'

M John Harrison

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

LONDON: British writer M John Harrison won the Booker Prize for fiction on Monday for "The End of Everything," a satirical dystopian novel whose themes of "catastrophe and apocalypse" chime with our uneasy times.

It's the first work of science fiction to take the prestigious 50,000 pound ($67,000) literary award, but 81-year-old Harrison said he doesn't want to be hemmed in by the sci-fi label.

He said Booker recognition after six decades as an author shows that the era of "genres as fences and boxes, pigeonholes, is over."

"I think this book shows, and the prize now shows, that it is very possible to write a book that mixes not just two genres, but three or four," Harrison told reporters at a post-ceremony news conference.

Harrison beat five other finalists including previous winners Douglas Stuart and Marlon James, who had been the odds-makers' favourites, and Pulitzer Prize laureate Elizabeth Strout.

"The End of Everything" is set on England's Channel coast in the near future, after an unspecified calamity has shattered society and brought an influx of enigmatic alien entities to Britain. It centers on a beachcomber who lives with his gun-toting aunt and discovers a puzzling, shape-shifting artifact on the shore.

Asked what he wanted to convey to readers, Harrison said: continued on →9

PAGE ONE PLUS

{ WORLD } AMID U.S. GOVT SCRUTINY

IBM Consulting cuts US visa sponsorships

IBM said on Tuesday that it was ending US visa and green card sponsorship for a majority of roles in IBM Consulting, which employs more than 150,000 people. The move comes amid tight scrutiny of foreign tech hiring by Donald Trump's administration. Last month, it suspended Microsoft, Adobe and several major outsourcers, including Cognizant, Infosys and Tata Consultancy Services, from the Permanent Labor Certification process — a key step toward green cards for foreign workers. IBM Consulting has used US high-skilled visa programs to address skill shortages, but participation has been declining for years, a company spokesperson told Reuters. REUTERS

{ WORLD } CHILDREN'S AUTHOR

Walliams accused of sex assault on minor

Children's author and comedian David Walliams used his fame to groom girls and young women for sex, two British news outlets reported on Tuesday. ITV News and the Guardian newspaper said their joint investigation featured interviews with multiple women who gave first-hand accounts of Walliams' conduct. One woman alleged he sexually assaulted her at his house when she was 15, while others accused him of grooming them when they were teens. Walliams, 55, denied the allegations. "I am not a sexual predator," Walliams said, according to ITV. "I have not broken the law." AP

{ BUSINESS } NVIDIA'S SHARES FALL AMID CEO'S AFFAIR

MS tops Nvidia's market cap for 1st time since June 2025

Microsoft overtook Nvidia as the world's second-most valuable company on Tuesday, as the chip giant's shares fell on uncertainty over the outlook for AI and an investigation into whether Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang was the target of a foreign intelligence effort. Shares of Microsoft were down 0.4% at $543.25, while Nvidia lost more than 6% and was last at around $167.11. Nvidia's losses put it on track to shed over $470 billion in market value over two sessions as concerns mounted over the fallout from Huang's affair with a Chinese businesswoman alleged to be a spy. His relationship with Alice Huang helped facilitate shipment of $7.5 billion worth of chips to Chinese firms, The Information reported. AGENCIES

{ WORLD } ONE-TIME 5% TAX

California voters reject wealth tax

California voters have rejected a first-in-the-nation tax on the net worth of billionaires following a contentious ballot fight that generated huge spending by some prominent tech leaders eager to stop their taxes from going up. The measure's failure is a win for Democratic leaders who opposed it. Critics of the tax, known as Proposition 40, said it would have prompted ultrawealthy taxpayers to leave the state. The "no" side raised roughly 10 times as much as the "yes" side. The measure would have imposed a one-time 5% tax on the wealth of Californians whose net worth exceeds $1 billion. AP

{ SPORT } UNDER-19 ASIA CUP

Sehwag Jr's 1st U19 ton propels India to semis

Aaryavir Sehwag continued his impressive run of form in the U19 Asia Cup, smashing 160 off 168 balls to help India beat UAE by 70 runs on Tuesday. This was his second substantial contribution in the tournament, following a 70 against Nepal last week. Sehwag's knock, studded with 17 fours and seven sixes, propelled India to 309/7. In reply, UAE could only manage 239. Pacer Ishan Sood played a key role with figures of 4/37. India will play Afghanistan in the semi-final. "Feels amazing. When I started my innings, the thought process was to play long and bat for 40-50 overs. The wicket was challenging as it was turning. But everything went well," Sehwag said after bagging the Player-of-the-Match award. →P19

CEC flags gaps in monitoring of sand mining

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

THE CEC REPORT WAS SUBMITTED IN A SUO MOTU PROCEEDING INITIATED BY THE SC OVER ILLEGAL MINING INSIDE THE NAT'L CHAMBAL SANCTUARY

NEW DELHI: Illegal sand mining continues across the country because of inadequate monitoring and weak enforcement after environmental clearances are granted, the Central Empowered Committee (CEC) has told the Supreme Court, recommending a series of measures to curb the practice, including stricter audits and digital tracking.

In a report dated November 2, the committee, which assists the court on environmental matters, said illegal sand mining was a "widespread" and "persistent" concern. It recommended measures to strengthen monitoring of riverbed mining and reduce dependence on sand extracted from rivers to meet the growing demand for construction.

The report, titled "Rivers and Mining", was submitted in a suo motu proceeding initiated by the Supreme Court over illegal mining inside the National Chambal Sanctuary. It is a first-of-its-kind pan-India assessment of river sand mining, following reports of illegal extraction from the Chambal and Ken rivers, it said.

"The main reason for persistence of illegal mining is the gap between grant of environmental clearance and continuing post-clearance monitoring," the CEC said. The report said that environmental clearance alone is not enough as the leaseholders need to be kept under check for extracting sand beyond approved depth or quantity. The Enforcement and Monitoring Guidelines for Sand Mining, 2020 issued by MoEFCC hold the state and district environment impact assessment authorities responsible for post-clearance monitoring. The CEC report does not give a reason why they are failing.

The committee, however, could not quantify the extent of illegal sand mining in the country, citing the absence of reliable national data.

"The available material establishes that illegal sand mining is a persistent and geographically widespread enforcement concern but does not support a scientifically defensible national estimate of its total volume or value," the report said.

The only available figures cited were from the Union ministry of mines for 2021-22, covering illegal mining of both major and minor minerals. Sand is classified as a minor mineral and its extraction requires prior environmental clearance under the Environment Impact Assessment Notification, 2006, along with compliance with state rules.

Around 95,306 cases of illegal mining of major and minor minerals were reported across states in 2021-22, including 17,938 in Telangana, 7,645 in Rajasthan and 4,886 in Gujarat. However, these figures are not specific to sand mining and do not indicate the quantity extracted, the report said.

CEC said a meaningful assessment would require river-wise information on the quantity extracted, mining locations, lease status, permitted quantities, transportation and final disposal of sand, but such data was not available.

Enforcement gaps

The report identified several gaps that allow illegal mining to continue. These include outdated district survey reports, poorly marked mining lease boundaries, outdated studies on sand replenishment, and extraction beyond approved depths or quantities.

Other concerns include mining at night, inadequate checkposts, forged or reused transit permits, discrepancies between extraction and transportation records, poor coordination between districts and states, and inadequate prosecution of offenders.

To address these gaps, the CEC recommended that every state constitute a District Level Task Force (DLTF) headed by the district magistrate or collector, with representatives from the police, transport, mining, irrigation and pollution control departments, along with independent experts. The task force should meet at least once a month to review mining operations and initiate corrective action.

The committee proposed making annual independent environmental audits mandatory for every operational riverbed mining lease. "The audit report shall clearly indicate the extent of compliance, deficiencies observed, environmental damage, if any, and corrective measures required...," the CEC said. It said officials found guilty of negligence or collusion should be identified and action taken against them.

Other recommendations include mapping potential mining zones to prevent extraction outside approved areas, prohibiting mining within 100 metres of the active edge of embankments, maintaining a minimum two-metre safety margin above the groundwater table in areas outside riverbeds, and banning riverbed mining during the monsoon.

Develop alternatives

The CEC stressed the need to reduce dependence on riverbed sand by promoting alternative sources. The alternatives include manufactured sand, recycled construction and demolition waste, recovery of sand from floodplains and river channels, and scientific desiltation of dams and reservoirs.

The committee recommended that all storage dams, including those used for irrigation, hydropower and multipurpose projects, that are more than 15 years old and have not undergone systematic desiltation be assessed for sediment accumulation, loss of storage capacity and the feasibility of removing the accumulated sediment.

It also proposed that the Centre prepare a time-bound national programme for scientific desiltation. Contracts for eligible works should be awarded within three years, followed by a structured 10-year desiltation cycle for reservoirs.

The Supreme Court is yet to consider the report. The matter was listed on November 4 but was not taken up. The next date of hearing has not been notified.

At the heart of the Nvidia scandal: Megaspeed

Singapore-based firm Megaspeed faces renewed scrutiny as US looks into Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's affair with businesswoman Alice Huang, alleged to be a spy for China. Here's what we know about Megaspeed, where Huang used to be an executive.

WHAT IS MEGASPEED?

Megaspeed, an Nvidia customer, was incorporated in 2015 as 7Road International before changing its name to Megaspeed International in March 2023, its business filings showed.
It is wholly owned by Singapore-registered Swiftdata incorporated in October 2023, which says providing hosting services by non-data centers is its principal activity.

WHO RUNS IT?

Two Singapore citizens are listed as officers of both companies. Tan Yong Pong was appointed a director of Swiftdata on October 31, 2023, before becoming a director of Megaspeed less than two weeks later. That month, Huang Le ended an eight-month tenure as managing director of Megaspeed, media said. Huang Le is Alice Huang's Chinese name. Swiftdata also shares an address with Ng Wei Shi Khloe, who is listed as company secretary of both companies. Tan and Ng are the only listed officers of the two firms in their business filings. Megaspeed has faced US scrutiny over suspicions that it helped Beijing gain access to Nvidia's advanced AI chips whose export to China is restricted.

A SURGE IN BUSINESS

On its website, it says it is an Nvidia Cloud Partner in the Asia-Pacific region and offers access to the company's GB200 NVL72 and HGX H100 systems.

$3bn Megaspeed's assets increased sharply in 2024 from $33 million in 2023, its business filings showed.

It reported an after-tax loss of $20 million in 2024, versus a loss of $21,283 a year earlier, while revenue jumped to $294 million from zero. Its cashflow statement showed $844,555 went to investing activities in 2024, after financing brought in cash of $10 million the previous year.

HOW IS SINGAPORE INVOLVED?

Last October Singapore police said they were investigating Megaspeed over "suspected breaches of our domestic laws" after a US senator requested the Commerce Department to investigate whether Megaspeed had diverted Nvidia chips. The Wall Street Journal last month reported that Singapore was concerned about Alice Huang's ties to Jensen Huang, with authorities separately investigating her alleged links to Chinese intelligence. However, Singapore denied these claims.

THE SCANDAL HAS FOCUSED ATTENTION ON HOW CHINA OBTAINS THE CUTTING-EDGE CHIPS DESPITE U.S. EXPORT RESTRICTIONS

WHY NVIDIA CHIPS ARE KEY

Nvidia designs advanced components originally created to handle 3D visuals in video games, called Graphics Processing Units. These have the power to crunch colossal amounts of digital data, so are also used at scale to train and run artificial intelligence systems.

WHICH CHIPS DOES U.S. RESTRICT?

Washington bans the export of Nvidia's top-end "Blackwell" and "Rubin" GPUs to China, citing security concerns, as advanced AI has military applications. The policy also allows the US's top AI labs to maintain their global lead. This year, Washington eased controls on Nvidia's previously banned -- and less powerful — "H200" chip, with the United States taking a 25% cut of sales.

HOW DOES CHINA GET ITS CHIPS?

"Chinese vendors are still using cutting-edge Nvidia chips to train their models" despite the controls, Lian Jye Su, a chief analyst at Omdia, told AFP. Chips may be smuggled into the country, or accessed through a loophole that allows Chinese firms to rent out computing power at data centres stuffed with Nvidia chips in a third nation, often Southeast Asian.

In 7k WB booths, all cleared voters face EC exclusion plea

Himanshi Dahiya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: In 7,335 polling booths spread across 23 districts of West Bengal, every voter cleared by judicial officers during the controversial logical discrepancy phase of the special intensive revision (SIR) earlier this year is facing an appeal against their inclusion in the electoral roll, a new report has found.

These appeals – filed by the West Bengal Chief Electoral Officer's (CEO) office, according to the Election Commission of India (ECI) affidavit before the Supreme Court – are part of the 1.6 million appeals filed in total against the inclusion of people before judicial tribunals in the eastern state.

ECI told the apex court last month that 3.8 million appeals are pending before the tribunals – 2.2 million filed by people excluded in the logical discrepancy category and 1.6 million filed by state poll authorities against the inclusion of people.

The analysis is part of a report on SIR appellate tribunals by the Civic Research Group (CRG), a research collective based in Kolkata.

ECI declined to comment. "These appeals were filed by [West Bengal] CEO officials who had the authority to do so as per the Supreme Court. It's just a technicality. Only because an appeal was filed against them does not mean they were ineligible to vote. Their names appeared in the supplementary lists, which means they were eligible to vote in the assembly elections," said a senior ECI official on the condition of anonymity.

PICK OF THE DAY

These 7,335 booths held 27,277 voters who judicial officers cleared. Of these, 21,615 (79%) were pending and 5,662 were disposed of, according to the CRG analysis. It wasn't clear how many of the disposed appeals were successful. All 294 assembly constituencies in the state had at least one such booth, the data showed.

BLOs assist people in filling up SIR forms, in January in Kolkata. HT

Among districts, the largest proportion of appeals against inclusion came from Kalimpong (71.4%), followed by Purba Bardhaman (59.7%) and Darjeeling (59.3%), the report said. The lowest proportion came from Dakshin Dinajpur (39.3%), Cooch Behar (39.4%) and Nadia (39.5%), the report added.

The developments bring focus back to the controversial logical discrepancy process in West Bengal, the first state where it was implemented. The state had 76.6 million electors before SIR. When the draft roll was released on December 16, 2025, it dropped 5.8 million voters and the roll shrank to 70.8 million. But another six million people were flagged under logical discrepancy and faced the prospect of being struck off over name mismatches, typos, age gaps between parents and applicants, and number of children.

After weeks of conflict between the state and ECI, the Supreme Court intervened on February 20, 2026, and instructed judicial officers to hear cases of logical discrepancy. Over six weeks, 700 judicial officers cleared all cases. They approved 3.2 million cases and rejected 2.7 million people, who had to appeal before judicial tribunals. But the tribunals didn't become functional on time and eventually 2.71 million people were disenfranchised.

There are 19 appellate tribunals that are hearing both deleted voters appealing against their exclusion, and CEO officials appealing against the inclusion of certain voters. The 1.6 million appeals filed by election officials represent roughly half of the 3.28 million people cleared by judicial officers.

Of these 1.6 million appeals by election officials, approximately 1.5 million are pending and 81,242 have been disposed of, according to data compiled by CRG from the tribunal's appeal portal.

Anthropic targets valuation of $1.4tn in test of AI fervour

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW YORK/BENGALURU: Anthropic's blockbuster IPO is set to give the company a valuation of up to $1.4 trillion, slightly short of some investors' expectations amid cooling AI appetite, setting up a defining test of Wall Street's faith in the boom that it helped ignite.

The AI lab best known for its Claude chatbot and some of its investors are aiming to raise up to $64.4 billion in the IPO by selling 825 million shares priced between $70 and $78 apiece.

Anthropic will also raise $26 billion via a separate private placement deal with cornerstone investors, including Alphabet's Google, Nvidia, Advanced Micro Devices.

The company is launching the roadshow for a share sale that is expected to set a benchmark for the sector. At the top of the price range, Anthropic would be valued at about $1.4 trillion on a fully diluted basis, which includes securities such as stock options and restricted stock. On a non-diluted basis, excluding those securities, Anthropic's market value would be about $1 trillion.

Hours before Anthropic filed an updated prospectus on Tuesday, details of its IPO were briefly circulated to investment banks late on Monday shortly before being retracted, according to emails seen by Reuters.

The preliminary terms showed Anthropic's IPO could raise as much as $69.3 billion. But the updated prospectus filed with the US Securities and Exchange Commission contained different terms, with Anthropic setting a lower price range and targeting reduced proceeds.

Investors are also closely watching Anthropic's IPO for clues about rival OpenAI, which is seeking to raise $30 billion in what is expected to be its final private funding round before a potential IPO early next year.

The second half of the year has brought a reckoning for the AI boom, as investors question whether returns will justify the massive spending and mounting debt costs in an elevated interest-rate environment.

Despite the midterms being widely viewed as a rebuff to a White House which has aggressively supported the AI build-out and opposed regulations, Anthropic adopted President Donald Trump's preferred name for the new technology, "Super Intelligence", in its IPO filing.

Its filing spoke of a vision to "bring forth an age of miracles," even as it warned of existential risks to humanity, laying bare the extraordinary promise and profound uncertainties at the heart of the AI boom.

Nippon India Mutual Fund

Wealth sets you free

Sweet.
Salty.
Spicy.

Every plate has a favourite. There's a Mutual Fund for every investor too.

Just as a festive Diwali plate brings together a mix of flavours, colours, shapes and sizes, Mutual Funds offer a variety of investment choices too. From equity, debt and hybrid funds to those that invest in commodities. With different investment approaches and time horizons, there's more than one way to find your flavour in investing.

MUTUAL KA FESTIVAL

Disciplined form of investing

Professionally managed by experts

Aim for better long-term benefits from the power of compounding

mf.nipponindiaim.com/EdgeOfKnowledge

Contact your Mutual Fund Distributor or Registered Investment Advisor I Give us a missed call on **8000112244**

An investor education and awareness initiative of Nippon India Mutual Fund

Helpful information for investors: All Mutual Fund investors have to go through a one-time KYC (Know Your Customer) process. Investors should deal only with registered mutual funds, to be verified on SEBI website under 'Intermediaries/ Market Infrastructure Institutions'. For redressal of your complaints, you may please visit https://scores.sebi.gov.in. For more info on KYC, change in various details & redressal of complaints, visit mf.nipponindiaim.com/investoreducation/ what-to-know-when-investing

Nippon India Mutual Fund | MF/022/95/1

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

rediffusion.in

Delhi gets first Yamuna safari; water sports and eco-tourism hub on cards

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Capital's first recreational cruise service on the Yamuna, inaugurated on Tuesday, will offer more than just a river ride, with visitors also set to enjoy adventure activities such as jet skiing, skating and rock climbing as part of a planned eco-tourism destination along the Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur stretch.

The 30-seater electric cruise vessel, launched by Union minister for ports, shipping and waterways Sarbananda Sonowal in the presence of Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta at Sonia Vihar, near the Capital's northern border, will offer a 6km round-trip journey between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur. The launch marks Delhi's first major push towards riverine tourism.

The initiative is aimed at tapping the Yamuna's tourism potential and encouraging public engagement with the river, officials said.

It is part of the government's wider plan to develop the stretch as an eco-tourism destination, with facilities including a musical fountain, food court, shopping area, children's play zone and adventure sports activities.

Inaugurating the Namo Yamuna River Safari on Tuesday morning, Sonowal said the initiative reflected the Centre's commitment to developing inland waterways as drivers of tourism, economic growth and sustainable connectivity.

"India's rivers and inland waterways are emerging as important drivers of economic growth, tourism and sustainable connectivity. The launch of Delhi's first recreational cruise service on the Yamuna is another step towards reconnecting people with our rivers and unlocking their immense potential," he said.

Gupta said the cruise would add a new dimension to Delhi's tourism landscape and give residents and visitors an opportunity to experience the river differently.

"The Yamuna is an integral part of Delhi's history, culture and identity. This recreational cruise service will offer residents and visitors a new way to experience the river while creating fresh opportunities for tourism and local economic activity," she said.

(Clockwise from above) Union minister for ports, shipping and waterways Sarbananda Sonowal and Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta and other ministers take a ride on the boat as part of the inauguration of the Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur cruise service; and water minister Parvesh Verma on a jet ski on Tuesday. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT PHOTOS

A major attraction at the site will be a musical fountain featuring a coordinated light-and-sound show depicting the Yamuna's history and spiritual significance. The presentation will include its association with Surya Dev and Yama, as well as Lord Krishna's Kaliya Daman episode. Entry to the show will be free, officials said, adding that the response would be assessed before deciding on seating arrangements.

The destination will also have floating jetties, ticket counters, online booking facilities, restrooms, waiting areas and illuminated approach pathways. Other planned facilities include food kiosks, a restaurant and a children's zone.

The Delhi government has also procured two jet skis, for a new service that is expected to be launched within a week. The ride, lasting two to three minutes, will cost ₹800, an official said.

"In other states like Haryana, it is priced at ₹1,000. Here it will be offered at a price of ₹800. The ride will last for two to three minutes," the official said.

Delhi tourism minister Kapil Mishra said the Namo Yamuna River Safari would offer visitors a new tourism experience, allowing them to enjoy scenic views of the river. The musical fountain, he added, would present the "story of Lord Krishna" and the "glory of Yamuna Maiya" through music.

Delhi water minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the Yamuna should be developed as a tourism destination while retaining its cultural and religious significance. He cited the Sabarmati riverfront project in Ahmedabad and the upgraded ghats of Varanasi as examples of riverfront development.

"Just as Prime Minister Narendra Modi developed the riverfront in Varanasi and the Sabarmati riverfront in Ahmedabad, a similar riverfront will be developed here," Singh said.

He added that contracts to upgrade sewage treatment plants had been awarded and that water quality would improve as the facilities became operational.

Round-trip cruise tickets will cost ₹500, while the basic entry fee to the destination will be ₹50.

Experts say impact of cruise on river ecology not studied

Paras Singh
paras@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Environmentalists questioned the newly launched Yamuna cruise service on Tuesday, saying it was introduced without an ecological impact assessment or navigability studies in one of the river's last remaining relatively clean stretches.

Bhim Singh Rawat, a Yamuna activist and member of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People (SANDRP), said the government should have commissioned an ecological impact assessment and a topographical study before allowing motorised cruise operations.

"This clean part of the river sees migratory birds, and efforts should be made to cause minimal disturbance. A similar plan to run a water taxi in this stretch failed in the past, but no lessons have been learnt. They should first assess the depth of the river and the requirements for boat operations, as this might adversely impact aquatic life."

Rawat said ecological restoration, rather than eco-tourism, should be the government's priority, particularly along the Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur stretch, which supports aquatic life and attracts migratory birds. He also cautioned that motorised propellers could harm aquatic species, citing similar services in other cities. "Additionally, the river runs dry in May-June, exposing the riverbed. This year, we saw a monsoon deficit, and ecological flow in the river is missing. The river did not cross even the warning level once during the monsoon," he said.

The concerns come against the backdrop of fluctuating water levels and poor navigability. During a ground visit in May, HT found that much of the proposed route between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur had dried up, leaving shallow pools and narrow streams. The cruise boat could not travel beyond a few hundred metres near the Sonia Vihar sports club because of inadequate water depth.

The 40-foot vessel has a draft — the vertical distance between the water surface and the vessel's deepest point — of three feet. It is powered by two 40-horsepower electric motors. While its operators have highlighted its shallow draft and electric propulsion, environmentalists say these features do not address the ecological implications of motorised vessels.

Navigability concerns are not new. In June 2023, an 11-metre Indian Navy boat, Barasingha, brought to Delhi to assess the river's navigability, got stranded because of insufficient depth.

PM2.5 readings of 1K+ excluded from AQI: CPCB

Jasjeev Gandhiok
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) on Tuesday said it has capped the upper limit of readings from all continuous ambient air quality monitoring stations (CAAQMS) at 1,000 micrograms per cubic metre (μg/m³), meaning readings beyond this threshold will not be used to calculate the National Air Quality Index (NAQI). The board said the index is intended to reflect "prolonged exposure" rather than "momentary readings".

At the same time, the pollution watchdog said its methodology remains under review in light of advances in monitoring technology and international practices.

The clarification came a day after HT reported that more than two-thirds of the Capital's 59 air-quality monitoring stations went offline between 10pm and 6am on Diwali, when exposure to pollution was at its highest. Data later released by the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC), and acknowledged by CPCB on Tuesday, showed readings as high as 3,744 μg/m³ at west Delhi's Mundka at 2am on Monday, 3,023 μg/m³ at south Delhi's JNU at 4am and 3,008 μg/m³ at NSUT West Campus at 5am. These readings were not used to calculate the AQI.

"The NAQI system has defined measurement ranges for all pollutants. The particulate matter analysers deployed at the time of introduction of the NAQI were calibrated for a measurement range of 0–1,000 μg/m³. Accordingly, consistent with this, the designed system of automated data validation treats hourly readings beyond the calibrated range as outside range, and such readings are not used in the computation," the CPCB said in a statement released late on Tuesday.

It added that during occasional extreme episodes, such as Diwali, this could result in a data gap for the station concerned, with those hours excluded from the calculation of the 24-hour average for the relevant pollutant.

"The NAQI recognises that prolonged exposure, rather than a momentary reading, is the more relevant indicator of ill effects on human health," the board said, citing the National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS), 2009, which prescribe both short-term and long-term weighted averages. It described spikes during firecracker bursting as episodic and short-lived.

Launched in 2015, NAQI generates an hourly AQI based on sub-indices for eight pollutants: PM2.5, PM10, carbon monoxide (CO), nitrogen dioxide (NO2), sulphur dioxide (SO2), ammonia (NH3), ozone and lead. The highest sub-index among the pollutants determines the AQI for that hour.

The board also clarified that AQI has an upper limit of 500, beyond which readings remain in the "severe" category. "Beyond this level, the AQI remains in the 'severe' category and extrapolation of the index would not alter the assigned health impact category," it said.

{ SURROGACY AGE LIMIT }

No HC relief to couple over prescribed limit

NEW DELHI: Sympathy, howsoever genuine, cannot substitute statutory eligibility, the Delhi High Court has held, refusing to exempt a couple from the prescribed age limit to enable them to undergo surrogacy.

"Notwithstanding, the court is required to decide the matter in accordance with the governing statutory framework and sympathy, howsoever genuine, cannot be a substitute for statutory eligibility," a bench of justice Amit Mahajan said in his November 2 order, released later.

In the case at hand, the couple approached a clinic for their first consultation on February 6, 2025, when the woman was approximately 49 years and seven months old. Four days later, gestational surrogacy using a donor was recommended. However, while undergoing infertility treatment in July 2025, she crossed the upper age limit of 50 prescribed under Section 4(iii)(c)(I) of the Surrogacy (Regulation) Act, 2021.

The couple approached the high court, arguing that the woman crossed the prescribed age limit while they were already undertaking the steps to initiate the surrogacy process. HTC

Dipke gets exemption from court appearance

Arnabjit Sur
arnabjit.sur@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) founder Abhijit Dipke was on Tuesday granted an exemption from appearing in person before the Special Executive Magistrate (SEM) in a case of preventive inquiry against him.

The Magistrate at Mandir Marg police station allowed the exemption after Dipke's counsel, Abhik Chimni, cited medical grounds for his absence.

The matter was posted for hearing on December 2.

Chimni was also provided copies of the "kalandra" (preventive police report) and other legal documents that the Delhi Police relied on to issue Dipke a show-cause notice, asking him to furnish a peace bond.

The development comes weeks after Dipke was granted conditional bail by an SEM following his arrest over an alleged breach of a peace bond he furnished earlier.

Dipke was detained on October 16 while heading towards Connaught Place for a protest march called by the CJP.

He was subsequently arrested on October 17 for allegedly violating a peace bond furnished on October 10 and later released on a conditional bail bond by the SEM. The bond was intended to secure an undertaking from him to maintain peace and prevent any disturbance to public order for a year.

DMRC diverted slum sewage into pond, DUSIB informs NGT

Paras Singh
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) has informed the National Green Tribunal (NGT) that sewage from a 2,511-household slum cluster in south Delhi's Rangpuri Pahari was diverted into a nearby pond by the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) during construction of the underground Mahipalpur Metro station in 2024, allegedly without informing DUSIB.

The diversion led to wastewater in the pond and eventually overflowing, DUSIB said.

In a status report filed before the tribunal in an ongoing case dated November 5, DUSIB said sewage from the cluster, known as Rangpuri Pahari, was earlier discharged into a larger drain constructed by the Public Works Department (PWD) near Vasant Kunj Road. However, during metro construction in 2024, DMRC stopped this arrangement and diverted the discharge into the pond, the letter stated.

"At no point of time did the said discharge flow directly into the said pond," DUSIB said in the affidavit, adding that the diversion had been carried out unilaterally by DMRC without any intimation to the agency.

The affidavit estimated the cluster's total sewage discharge at approximately 27.87 kilolitres per day (KLD). DUSIB said wastewater from community toilet complexes was routed through septic tanks into the Delhi Jal Board's sewer line and did not flow into the pond. The remaining 6.97 KLD was channelled through a drain constructed by DUSIB into the PWD drain.

However, DUSIB acknowledged that this remaining discharge was not being treated. Following the pond's overflow, DMRC initiated pumping and drainage arrangements, it said.

A DMRC official said the agency is not a party in this case, and that the Delhi Metro has only improved drainage in the region with the assistance of the drain-owning agency.

Visibility remained poor in Punjabi Bagh in the early hours of Tuesday amid a thick layer of smog and haze. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT

AQI sees marginal improvement; relief may last few days

HT Correspondent
htcorrespondent@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's air quality improved marginally on Tuesday, with the 24-hour average AQI dropping to 299 in the "poor" category from Monday's 344 (very poor), according to the Central Pollution Control Board's bulletin.

Weather experts attributed the improvement to stronger northwesterly winds that helped disperse pollutants, and noted that the trend could continue over the next couple of days.

The Air Quality Early Warning System (EWS) for Delhi also forecast a decline in PM2.5 and PM10 concentrations over the next two days.

According to the Centre's Decision Support System (DSS), the transport sector was the largest contributor to Delhi's pollution on Tuesday, accounting for 18% of the total. The contribution of stubble burning was estimated at 2%, though forecasts indicate it could rise to 7.9% on Wednesday.

On Tuesday, 28 of the 58 air quality monitoring stations reported "very poor" air quality, while another 28 logged levels in the "poor" category. Two stations recorded "moderate" air quality, and none reported severe pollution levels.

Delhi Cantonment and Sri Aurobindo Marg were the only two locations to record moderate air quality, with AQI readings of 135 and 155, respectively.

Meteorologist Navdeep Dahiya said the season's first western disturbance is arriving over the Himalayas, which could further improve air quality levels in Delhi. He added that the wind pattern is expected to shift to southwesterly at the surface level between November 12 and 15, aiding the AQI recovery.

Satellite data recorded 559 farm-fire incidents across six states on Monday, including 198 in Punjab, 17 in Haryana, and 47 in Uttar Pradesh.

Meanwhile, Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 29.6°C on Tuesday.

DU GRAD STUDENT SUSPENDED FOR LURING GIRLS TO GUJARAT CONCERT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University's Ramanujan College has suspended a third-year undergraduate student until February 1, 2027, following allegations that he lured female students with "gifts" to attend Diljit Dosanjh's show in Ahmedabad.

The decision follows a preliminary report submitted by the college's internal inquiry committee. It stated that the student would be barred from participating in academic and extracurricular activities during the period. He would be permitted to appear for internal assessments, submit assignments and take examinations, subject to prior approval from the college proctor.

However, the student, Anas Khan, said the allegations were baseless and he was being "targeted" because of his previous affiliation with a student organisation. GARGI SHUKLA

18k vehicles denied Delhi entry from Nov 1 to 10

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Authorities stopped and checked 81,340 vehicles, and at least 18,044 non-CNG and non-electric vehicles not registered in Delhi were turned back from the city's borders during the first 10 days of the ban on entry for vehicles below BS-VI emission standards under the government's winter action plan, according to official data.

Starting November 1, the Delhi government implemented its winter action plan to curb air pollution, restricting entry of non-Delhi-registered vehicles that do not meet BS-VI emission standards into the national capital. Joint enforcement teams from the Delhi traffic police, Delhi transport department and MCD were deployed on the borders to stop and verify vehicles, return those that were non-compliant or issue them challans.

Data on action taken between November 1 and 10 showed that a total of 767 such vehicles were issued challans.

HT carried out a spot check at six borders — Kalindi Kunj, Chilla, Maharajpur, Seemapuri, Apsara, and Ghazipur — in northeast and south Delhi that connect to Uttar Pradesh between 2.30pm and 5 pm.

While traffic police personnel were present at three borders, namely the Kalindi Kunj, Chilla at New Ashok Nagar, and Maharajpur near Anand Vihar, MCD enforcement teams were not present at any of the six.

Except for the Chilla border, no enforcement teams from the Delhi transport department were present at the other five borders that HT visited.

In response, a senior transport department official said, "Enforcement teams deployed at Delhi's border checkpoints were present and functional during their assigned shifts." The official clarified that teams do not install permanent barricades or remain stationed at fixed points, but conduct mobile checks and intercept violating vehicles.

Traffic police personnel at Chilla border on Tuesday. ARVIND YADAV/HT

A senior traffic police officer, who asked not to be named, said, "I checked with the teams deployed at these border points. They said they were present."

According to the winter action plan notification, transport department, MCD and Delhi traffic police have been directed to ensure entry restriction on non-compliant vehicles.

However, an MCD spokesperson said, "As far as MCD mandate, this is beyond our purview stopping vehicles from entering a city as part of a joint team can not pertain to us."

Around 2.45 pm, at the Seemapuri DLF border, nobody from the joint teams was found present. According to two toll tax collectors present at a booth, no enforcement teams from traffic, transport or MCD had been visited after the first few days. "You can even see old private vehicles not registered in Delhi and crossing the border without any checks," said one employee.

Around 3.30pm, at the Apsara border, police barricades were placed near the roundabout but no enforcement teams were present. Two policemen at a post said a two-member traffic police enforcement team had been conducting checks since morning but had recently left.

At the Chilla and Kalindi Kunj borders, 5-6 traffic police personnel were seen verifying vehicles using their hand-held challan machines.

KIRORI MAL, SRI VENKATESWARA COLLEGES GO ONLINE, HYBRID

NEW DELHI: Amid worsening pollution levels in the city, Delhi University's Sri Venkateswara College has shifted classes online, while Kirori Mal College has moved to a hybrid mode.

In a notice on Monday, the college said all the classes would be conducted online from November 10 to 14. "However, departments conducting practicals have been permitted to continue classes in physical or hybrid mode," the notice read.

Kirori Mal College also moved to a hybrid teaching mode, allowing teachers to conduct classes through a combination of online and offline formats. HTC

Your light
enlightens our journey.

Fondly remembered by all

Dr. Krishna Kumar Birla

November 11, 1918 - August 30, 2008.

New estimates show farm fires may be vastly undercounted in Pb, Hry

North-westerlies set to return, raising risk of farm-fire smoke reaching Delhi again

Binayak Dasgupta and Jasjeev Gandhiok

htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Farm fires in Punjab and Haryana hit their highest count of the season on Diwali even as new estimates put the scale of the problem vastly higher than what's being counted. Moreover, while the north-westerly wind that carries their smoke to Delhi slackened in the festival's aftermath, easing the impact on the Capital, it is forecast to return on Wednesday and Thursday, an HT analysis of satellite and weather data shows.

Till October 28, INSAT-3DS, a weather satellite run by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), detected almost no farm fire in the two states. From Oct 29 the count rose every day, from 18 to 447 on November 8, Diwali, and the daily average in the week to November 9 was 12.5 times that of the week to November 1. The count fell sharply on November 9; the reason is not known. (See Chart 1)

INSAT-3DS stays over the same spot and scans the region every half hour. Each fire it detects is a patch of ground several kilometres across that is hot enough to be burning.

A different pattern emerges if the method of detection is changed. Hiren Jethva, an atmospheric scientist at NASA's Goddard Space Flight Center, wrote on X on October 3 that a statistical model, which predicts the number of fires from how green the crop was as measured by NASA's MODIS satellite instrument, "ranks 2026 Punjab-Haryana post-monsoon fire season as one of the intense burning periods". The model expects about 14,000 fires, as MODIS would count them.

On November 9, Jethva posted on X that the current farm fire figures were likely an undercount, with an empirical calculation using a combination of satellites and considering data till 4 pm: both Punjab and Haryana had likely logged closer to 34,000 farm fires till November 9. Referring to data from the NOAA-20 VIIRS satellite (375m resolution) for both Punjab and Haryana from October 1-November 9, he said 4,089 fires were logged around 1:30pm. Similarly, data from the Aquad MODIS satellite (1km resolution) showed 4,196 fires had been logged around 4 pm local time.

"After empirical adjustment to VIIRS 375 m fire-count baseline, the total reaches to around 34,000 fires – a conservative estimate," he said on Monday evening.

HT cannot check that ranking against the fire counts of earlier years. NASA's satellites have missed more of the stubble burning season after season as the activity moved to later in the day, so a comparison with past counts would mostly measure how much they missed. ISRO's counts are not comparable from one season to the next. The closest like-for-like measure is the area burned, which the research group iFOREST maps from European Sentinel-2 satellite images; burnt fields show up in them whatever time of day they were set alight.

A CAQM official, when contacted, said the fact that fields are being set on fire later in the day is well-known now. "The Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI) has also begun utilising the AQUA satellite to capture instances later in the day, but counts beyond 4 pm are still being missed," he said, adding they are putting to use drones and even low-cost sensors to gather more data on-ground.

Smoke from the fields travels to Delhi on a north-westerly wind 1 km to 3 km above the ground. The India Meteorological Department's weather balloon, launched from Safdarjung in Delhi, measured that wind at 29 km/h on November 7. On Diwali afternoon it had eased to 15 km/h, and by the early hours of Tuesday it was down to 6 km/h and blowing from the north-north-east, no longer from the direction of the fields. On Diwali afternoon, the mixing layer, the band of air above the ground in which pollution spreads and thins, was 364 metres deep, against a usual depth of about 1,300 metres in early November, so pollution had far less room to thin out. (See Chart 2)

Using winds from two weather models, the US Global Forecast System (GFS) and the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF), HT traced where the air reaching Delhi at 2pm each day had been over the previous three days. On Diwali, that air had come through the fire belt, the farmland of Punjab and northern Haryana where most of the fires burn. On November 9 and November 10 it came from the east and north-east, passing no INSAT-3DS detections and no more than nine NASA-detected fires.

The fires typically burn around 260 km away from Delhi. The air reaching the city on Diwali afternoon had passed over most of the fires roughly 30 to 35 hours earlier, the trace shows. At the speeds that have been forecast for Wednesday and Thursday, the air would cover that distance in about 10 hours.

The models forecast the north-westerly will return at 27 km/h on Wednesday and 23 km/h on Thursday. Both trace the air reaching Delhi on Thursday afternoon back through the fire belt. On Wednesday, the ECMWF traces it through the belt; the GFS, at about 800 metres above the ground, has it skirting the belt. Near the ground, the models forecast light winds, and no rain through November16. Rain would wash some of the smoke out of the air. (See Chart 2)

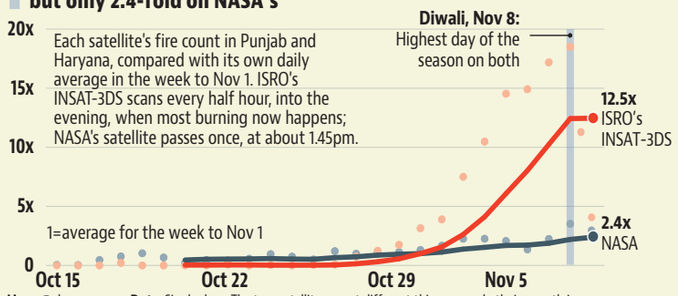
NASA's fire count, the one most often quoted, shows a far smaller rise. It too hit its season high on Diwali, at 385, but its daily average in the week to November 9 was only 2.4 times that of the week to November 1. HT compared only how fast the two counts grew, because NASA counts individual fires and INSAT-3DS counts larger hot patches of ground. (See Chart 1)

Most of the burning now happens after NASA's satellites have passed. They cross Punjab in daylight once, in the early afternoon; this season, 98% of the fires INSAT-3DS detected came between 4pm and 6pm. Jethva wrote that actual fire counts for 2022 to 2025 were "multifold lower" than the model expected because peak burning moved to the late afternoon, which NASA's fire-counting instruments, MODIS and VIIRS, do not see. (See Chart 3)

Meteosat, a European weather satellite, also stays over one spot; it scans every 15 minutes and measures fire heat, the energy that fires give off. In 2021 it saw 53% of the season's fire heat in Punjab and Haryana after 3pm; by 2025 the share was 98%. Over the same years NASA's season count fell to 6% of its 2021 level, while the area burned, by iFOREST's measure, fell only to 81%. (See Chart 4)

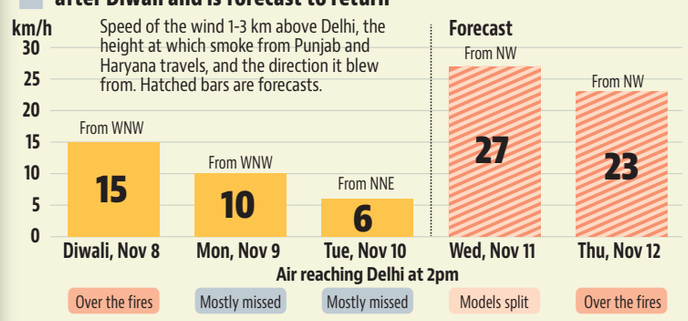
AIR WE BREATHE

1 Farm fire rose 12.5-fold in a week on ISRO's satellite, but only 2.4-fold on NASA's



Lines: 7-day averages. **Dots:** Single days. The two satellites count different things, so only their growth is compared. INSAT-3DS's count fell on Nov 9; the reason is not known
Data source: MOSDAC/SAC/ISRO (INSAT-3DS); NASA FIRMS (VIIRS, NOAA-20). HT analysis

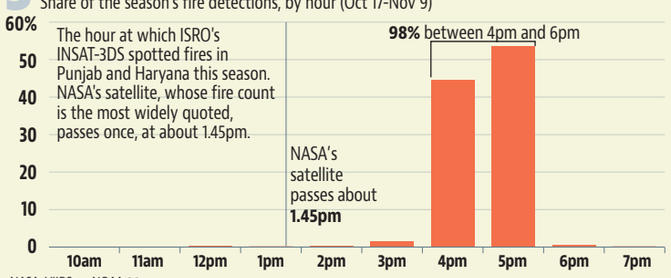
2 The wind that carries farm smoke to Delhi died down after Diwali and is forecast to return



NW: north-west. **WNW:** west-north-west. **NNE:** north-north-east. Measured by weather balloon at 4:30pm on Diwali; Nov 9-10 at 4.30am, the only launch. The air's path is traced back three days on two weather models.
Source: IMD weather balloon, Safdarjung (University of Wyoming archive); GFS and ECMWF winds via Open-Meteo. HT analysis

3 Nearly all the burning now comes after NASA's satellite has passed

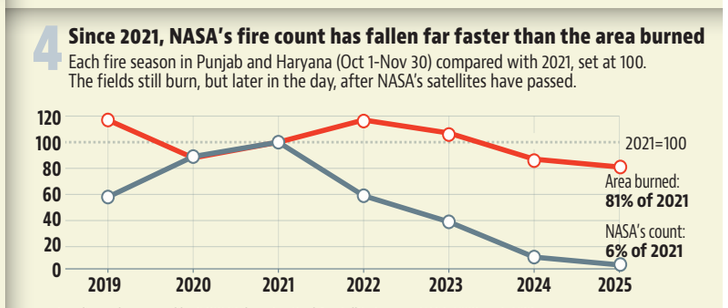
Share of the season's fire detections, by hour (Oct 17-Nov 9)



NASA: VIIRS on NOAA-20.
Source: Data source MOSDAC/SAC/ISRO (INSAT-3DS); NASA FIRMS. HT analysis

4 Since 2021, NASA's fire count has fallen far faster than the area burned

Each fire season in Punjab and Haryana (Oct 1-Nov 30) compared with 2021, set at 100. The fields still burn, but later in the day, after NASA's satellites have passed.



Area burned measured by iFOREST from Sentinel-2 satellite images. NASA: VIIRS on S-NPP
Source: NASA FIRMS; iFOREST. HT analysis

Smoke billows from an agricultural field due to stubble burning at a village in Punjab's Moga district. ANI

1,100 FIRs filed in Pb as farm fires near 2025's total

Gurpreet Singh Nibber and Karam Prakash

letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH/PATIALA: Police in Punjab have registered more than 1,100 FIRs and marked over 1,300 "red entries" in farmers' land records this paddy harvesting season, even as the number of stubble-burning incidents in the state crossed 5,000 and edged closer to last year's total.

According to the latest data compiled by the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM), Punjab reported 345 fresh farm fires, taking the cumulative count to 5,002. With 20 days remaining in the 2026 monitoring period, the figure is just 112 short of the 5,114 incidents recorded during the whole of last year.

Stubble burning in Punjab and Haryana is often blamed for worsening air pollution in Delhi-NCR. With a narrow window to prepare fields for the next crop of wheat after the October-November paddy harvest, some farmers burn crop residue to clear their fields quickly. The annual farm-fire monitoring period begins on September 15, two weeks before paddy procurement starts on October 1.

The CAQM data, based on satellite tracking by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), Punjab had recorded 4,195 incidents by November 10 last year, making this season's count nearly 20% higher. The sharpest single-day spike this season came on Diwali, when 1,152 incidents were reported.

A total of 1,155 FIRs had been registered this season under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which deals with disobedience of orders promulgated by public servants and provides for imprisonment of up to one year and a fine of ₹5,000.

Authorities have also marked 1,342 red entries in the land records of farmers who burnt crop residue. Such entries can prevent farmers from obtaining loans against their land or selling it. Environmental compensation totalling ₹79.75 lakh has been imposed in 1,574 cases, of which ₹36.50 lakh has been recovered.

The state recorded 5,114 farm fires in 2025, compared with 10,909 in 2024 and 36,663 in 2023.

The enforcement data also showed that 1,103 showcause notices had been issued to officials responsible for monitoring fires.

Officials said taking action against farmers for stubble burning remained difficult, despite pressure from central agencies.

"There is tremendous pressure from the central agencies — the Commission for Air Quality Management and the National Green Tribunal — but farmers in Punjab comprise a strong and large pressure group," said an official in the science and technology department, under which the Punjab Pollution Control Board functions, requesting anonymity.

"Farmers who face FIRs have to visit the courts repeatedly, which is an ordeal, but none have been convicted so far," said another senior agriculture department official.

Damage inside MCD House may soon cost councillors

Paras Singh
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

The move comes after a series of House meetings that have seen clashes erupting, resulting in damaged property. RAJ K RAJ /HT PHOTO

NEW DELHI: You break it, you pay for it.

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is considering recovering the cost of damage to municipal property during chaotic House proceedings directly from councillors found responsible, with the proposed recovery extending to their property tax dues if they fail to deposit the amount in the civic body's treasury.

The proposal has been made by Narendra Kumar, chairman of the MCD's Special Committee on Code of Conduct for Councillors, in a letter highlighting the destruction caused during the October 22 meeting of the House of Councillors. The mayor has forwarded the communication to the municipal commissioner, seeking action in accordance with the rules and a report on the steps taken.

The committee has argued that elected representatives cannot claim immunity from criminal or civil liability for deliberately damaging public property during House proceedings. It has maintained that the freedom councillors enjoy to speak and vote in meetings does not protect them from liability for vandalism, assault or wilful destruction of property.

Citing provisions of the Delhi Municipal Corporation (DMC) Act, 1957, and the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, 1984, Kumar said the corporation had the authority to maintain discipline in the House, but this did not absolve councillors of liability for damaging municipal property.

The proposal also cites the Supreme Court's 2021 judgment in State of Kerala v K Ajith, in which the court held that legislative privileges could not be used as a shield against criminal prosecution for acts involving the destruction of public property inside a legislative assembly. It argues that the principles of the judgment are equally relevant to municipal councillors.

The recommendation comes amid repeated disruptions of MCD House meetings, with heated exchanges often escalating into physical altercations and damage to civic property.

If accepted, it could introduce a financial accountability mechanism for councillors involved in such incidents. The BJP, too, has seen its councillors engage in ruckus during House proceedings when the party was in opposition. It regained control of the MCD on April 25, 2025.

In August 2024, HT reported that 30 House meetings in 2023-24 were marred by disruptions. Around ₹1 crore was spent on logistics, while damage to microphones, table tops and chairs cost ₹34 lakh. The disruptions also resulted in 3.1 tonnes of paper being wasted, ₹10 lakh being spent on food and snacks, and 51,000 man-hours being lost.

READ: MCD's scorecard: ₹1cr spent on logistics, ₹34L on ruckus; civic work discussed, nil

FESTIVAL SCHEME: GOVT TRANSFERS ₹141 CR TO RATION CARDHOLDERS

HT Correspondent
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Tuesday transferred ₹141.88 crore to the bank accounts of more than 15,45,000 ration cardholder families as financial assistance for liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cylinders under its festival welfare scheme.

Chief minister Rekha Gupta launched the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) at an event at Talkatora Stadium, where she said the initiative was aimed at providing financial relief to families during festivals and ensuring that welfare benefits reached eligible beneficiaries directly.

Of the 15,45,994 families covered under the scheme, 1,24,964 are beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY), who received ₹642 each. The remaining 14,21,030 non-PMUY families received ₹942 each.

The scheme was announced to provide financial assistance to ration cardholder families on the occasions of Holi and Diwali.

"Supporting families financially during festivals is the government's commitment. Ensuring that the benefits of welfare schemes reach people directly remains our priority," Gupta said.

{ CENTRE TO HC } ORDER TO VACATE

'No proposal to allot Central Secretariat Club premises'

Shruti Kakkar
shruti.kakkar@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Centre has informed the Delhi High Court that there is no proposal to allot the premises of the 107-year-old Central Secretariat Club (CSC), which was asked to vacate the property in July, to any party at this stage.

The submission was made by the Centre's standing counsel before a bench of justice Amit Mahajan on November 5, while the court was hearing an application by the club seeking a stay on the government's decision to withdraw its recognition and evict it.

"Ms Radhika Bishwajit Dubey, learned CGSC [central government standing counsel] for the respondents, on instructions, submits that there is no proposal to allot the subject premises to any party at this stage. Considering the above, no order is required to be passed. The petitioners are permitted to take away their belongings in next one week," the court said in its order.

The application was filed as part of the club's petition challenging the government's July 14 decision upholding the withdrawal of its recognition. The department of personnel and training (DoPT) had upheld its February 24 decision to withdraw the club's recognition. Three days later, on July 17, the estate officer directed the club to vacate the premises immediately.

In its application, filed through advocate Nakul Gandhi, the club argued that the government was proceeding with the transfer of possession of the land to RML Hospital, thereby creating a fait accompli before the high court could hear its petition.

Taking note of the Centre's submission, the court said no further order was required at this stage. It allowed the club's management a week to remove its belongings and listed the matter for further hearing on December 21.

In an affidavit filed on August 22, the Centre had defended its decision to withdraw the club's recognition, saying it was not prompted by any isolated allegation or incident but by cumulative material pointing to persistent constitutional violations, complaints, administrative and financial irregularities, and non-compliance with official directions.

The Centre also said that its July 14 decision was based on material relating to the club's functioning and governance, compliance with constitutional requirements and the conduct of its elections, which was considered by a three-member Representation Evaluation Committee (REC), constituted to examine the club's representation against the withdrawal.

{ CHAWRI BAZAR BUILDING COLLAPSE }

Toll rises to 7 as CM announces ex gratia of ₹10L

Hemani Bhandari
hemani.bhandari@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The death toll in the building collapse in Old Delhi's Chawri Bazar has risen to seven after rescuers recovered another body from under the debris. Chief minister Rekha Gupta, meanwhile, announced an ex gratia compensation of ₹10 lakh for the next of kin for all victims on Tuesday.

Deputy commissioner of police (central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said that the latest victim was identified as 66-year-old Luchhuman Mukhiya. He was a resident of Jakauli village in Bihar's Darbhanga district and was working at the site at the time of the collapse.

His body was recovered on Sunday during the rescue operation at the site. "It was shifted to Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Hospital," the officer added.

The rescue operation was then finally called off at 4:30am on Sunday, said a senior Delhi Fire Service official.

Announcing the compensation on Tuesday, Gupta posted on X that the "Delhi government stands firmly with the affected families and was committed to extending every possible assistance during the difficult time."

The three-storey structure, located in Gali Sitara near Chawri Bazar Metro station, collapsed in two stages around 9.30am on Thursday while construction work was under way, trapping several workers.

The building stood on a plot measuring around 70 square yards.

THE 3-STOREY STRUCTURE, IN GALI SITARA, COLLAPSED ON THURSDAY WHILE CONSTRUCTION WAS UNDER WAY

Nine people were pulled out of the site. This including two injured workers who were discharged after treatment and are stable, police said.

The victims were identified as Pankaj Sharma, Kishori, Sanjeet, Shantu, Vipin Ram and Dinesh Sah. Many of them were sole earning members of their families and had travelled from Bihar to Delhi in search of work.

A first information report (FIR), based on the complaint of an injured worker, was registered under sections 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder), 290 (negligent conduct with respect to pulling down, repairing or constructing buildings), 125(a) (negligent act with respect to buildings) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

The FIR said workers had raised concerns about the structural stability of the building and warned contractors that the newly laid lintel had not dried sufficiently to support further construction.

The complaint further alleged that the contractors ignored their warnings and asked them to continue working.

Police have arrested the building owner, Saimullah (alias Ayub), and three contractors —Siraj, Tajuddin and Furkan — in connection with the case. The contractors were arrested from Sirohi village in Faridabad's Dauj tehsil.

The municipal corporation of Delhi (MCD) is also facing scrutiny after it emerged that Delhi Police had alerted it about construction at the property nearly five months before the collapse. A subsequent civic inquiry alleged that the owner used an advisory permitting repairs as cover to clandestinely construct fresh second and third floors without the necessary permissions.

Gupta had earlier ordered the suspension of the junior engineer and assistant engineer concerned and directed a detailed inquiry into the incident.

Liquor sales rose by 13% from last Diwali

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Liquor sales in Delhi witnessed a 13.53% increase in the two weeks preceding Diwali compared to the corresponding period last year, with total sales for the current fiscal reaching ₹589.18 crore, up from ₹518.97 crore in 2025-26, according to data shared by the excise department.

The volume of sales also registered an increase, with 3.31 million bottles sold this financial year, compared to 2.96 million bottles during the corresponding period last fiscal, marking a growth of 11.96%.

The surge was more pronounced on November 7, the day preceding Diwali, when liquor sales in the city rose by nearly 25% compared to the same period last year.

"Sales of liquor usually witness a rise during festivals like Holi and Diwali. Liquor bottles are also brought for gifting purposes as well as for personal consumption," said a senior official.

Delhi recorded sales worth ₹79.25 crore on the day before Diwali this year, against ₹63.40 crore in 2025, registering a 24.99% increase. The number of bottles sold also increased by 16.58%, from 3.47 million in 2025 to 4.05 million in 2026. Diwali is a dry day every year.

Vinod Giri, director general of the Brewers' Association of India, said, "I would not read much into this increase. It is an organic growth that happens every year. I feel the growth would have been much more had the government announced its new excise policy. The government has not even increased the number of liquor stores for us to feel that it could have been a driving factor."

The increase in collections comes at a time when the government is looking to strengthen its revenue base while work on a new excise policy is underway. Currently, only 700 government-run liquor outlets operate in Delhi.

TODDLER'S BODY EXHUMED AFTER MOTHER ALLEGES MURDER IN GZB

GHAZIABAD: Investigators in Ghaziabad on Tuesday exhumed the body of a nine-month-old boy whose mother alleged the minor was murdered by her husband while she was out for work, police said.

The 24-year-old woman, a resident of Bayana village near National Highway-9, approached police with a complaint about her son, who allegedly died on Monday morning.

"She gave a complaint on Tuesday and alleged that her nine-month-old son was murdered by her husband, who later buried the body while claiming it was a case of natural death. Several persons from the village also attended the burial. The woman also told police that her husband beat her up two days ago and also threw the child in the air, and he was hit by the ceiling fan," said Priyashri Pal, ACP of Wave City Circle.

"Police are awaiting the autopsy report and will initiate suitable legal action if a murder is confirmed," the ACP added. HTC

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Nov-01 Dated: 06.11.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

SN: 1	Tender No.: 2026-Nov-01-01	Approx Cost ₹ : ₹ 20906558.26

Description of work: Agra Division - Provision of all balance facilities for divyangjans at RNKA, RBS, RDE, VRBD & SHLK Stations.

SN: 2	Tender No.: 2026-Nov-01-02	Approx Cost ₹ : ₹ 16734687.22

Description of work: Construction of relay huts for gate signaling at all non-interlocked level crossing (08 nos.) having TVU>10000 at remaining LC gates in IDH-BXN section.

SN: 3	Tender No.: 2026-Nov-01-03	Approx Cost ₹ : ₹ 16735306.07

Description of work: Construction of relay huts for gate signaling at all non-interlocked level crossing (08 nos.) having TVU>10000 at remaining LC gates in IDH-BKI & MTJ-AWR sections.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs on 27.11.2026 2553/26(AK)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

SUPPLY WORKS
E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN. 1. Tender No.: NB265854. PL Code (Group): 350203610018. Description:** Traction Motor Complete with Pinion to BHEL Model TM 4303BY without earthing brush assembly (or) Traction Motor Complete with Pinion to Cromption Greaves Model C1005TM (DEMU) as per ICF/MD/SPEC-097 REV.1. Make: BHEL / Crompton Greaves or Similar. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹2,35,820/-. **SN. 2. Tender No.: NB265863. PL Code (Group): 31670039. Description:** Micro controlled based electronic speed Indicating, Recording system type [Paperless type] confirming to RDSO Spec. No. MP.0.3700.07 [Rev.06] October, 2015. Each set consisting of following items {1} Recorder cum Indicator- 01 No. {2} Speed sensor - 01 No. {3} Junction box - 01 No. {4} Connecting cables - 01 set {5} Mounting Accessories - 01 Set. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹55,040/-. **SN. 3. Tender No.: NB265868. PL Code (Group): 326100470011. Description:** Set of ivc jumper plug type e - 8.7M as per Part No: 84200000017137 Qty-01 Nos. and socket type E assy-3M as per Part No: 84200000017132 Qty-01 Nos. for 1600HP DEMU DPC/TC, MAKE: Harting [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹68,770/-.**SN. 4. Tender No.: NB265870. PL Code (Group): 326100450012. Description:** Set of IVC jumper plug TYPE C - 8.7M as per Part No: 84200000017135 Qty-01 Nos. and socket TYPE C assy 2.5M as per Part No: 84200000017130 Qty-01 Nos. for 1600HP DEMU DPC, MAKE: HARTING. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹89,520/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender: 14:30** hrs. of **04-12-2026. SN. 5. Tender No.: NB265912. PL Code (Group): 46120002. Description:** Disconnecting and Earthing device, 8 pole, 2 Way Without off, on load 125 AMPS at 1000 V AC, 2 NO+ 2NC and with heavy handle and pad locking arrangement in one position mounted in a stainless steel enclosure suitable for AC 23 Duty Confirming to IEC 60947, Max depth including handle 480mm for LHB AC coaches as per RDSO Spec. No. RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0184-2015 (Rev.1) or latest, RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0192-2018 Rev.0 or latest & RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0200-2020 Rev.0 and RDSO letter No. EL.71.1.108/MSSBC, dt. 17-09-21 & 11-10-2022 or latest. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹94,350/-. **SN. 6. Tender No.: NB265884. PL Code (Group): 40124400. Description:** Thin walled e-beam irradiated flexible cable with copper conductor, working voltage above 750V & upto 1.8KV/3.0 KV grade, size-10 sqmm, as per rdso specification. no. ELRS/SPEC/ELC/0019 (REV-4), of feb-2018 or latest. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹1,67,090/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender: 14:30** hrs. of **07-12-2026.** The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website **www.ireps.gov.in**
Deputy Chief Material Manager, New Bongaigaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
मंडल रेल प्रबंधक, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे बीकानेर, भारत के राष्ट्रपति की ओर से इच्छुक ठेकेदारों से निम्न लिखित कार्य के लिए दर्शायी गयी तिथि में सील की गई खुली निविदा आमंत्रित करते है। **निविदा संख्या:** एस.एण्ड.टी / बी.के.एन–2026–27–32R। **कार्य का नाम व स्थान:** बीकानेर डिवीजन के आरई–एसडीएलपी सेक्शन में एलसी–78 के स्थान पर किमी 105/4-5 पर (आरयूबी) और एसएसए यार्ड के किमी 224/2-3 पर एलसी–144 के प्रावधान से संबंधित संकेत एवं दूरसंचार कार्य। **अनुमानित लागत मूल्य रू.: 9054222.92। Bid Security: 181100। निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि व समय:** Up to 15.00 Hrs. of 30.11.2026। **वेब साइट जहाँ निविदा का पूरा विवरण देखा व डाऊनलोड किया जा सकता है: www.ireps.gov.in.** 1620-MG/26
Follow us on: /NWRailways /NWRailways_

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) 25001/1505/2627
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT
IDENTIFICATION NO: RWS&S DIVN., PURI — 21 OF 2026-27
Phone : (06752) 251276 / E-mail — eerwsspuri@gmail.com
The Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Puri on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate price bids through e-procurement in double cover system according to the norms of e-procurement system, in on-line mode from eligible contractors.

Sl. No.	Nature of work:	Execution of 2 Nos Rural Piped Water Supply Schemes under BRAHMAGIRI Block including 5 years operation and maintenance under Puri district.
1.	No. of works:	: 02 (Two)
2.	Estimated Cost:	: Rs. 374.81 lakhs & Rs. 388.77 lakhs (app.)
3.	Time for completion:	: 12(Twelve) Months
4.	Cost of bidding document:	: Rs.10000/- (each)
5.	Class of Contractors eligible:	: A
6.	Availability of bids on-line:	: From 17 hour of 13.11.2026 to 17.00 hours of 30.11.2026
7.	Last date and time for seeking clarification	: 17.00 hours of 25.11.2026
8.	Date & time of opening of technical bids:	: On dt 01.12.2026 at 11.30 Hours in the office of the Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Puri (All documents should be submitted in online only. No original documents should be dropped in dropping box before opening of technical bid in Division Office).
9.	Date and time of opening of financial bids:	: To be decided.

Further details can be seen from the website https://www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Subsequent corrigendum if any shall appear in the web site.
Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Puri
OIPR - 25001/25017/1/26-27/0007

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA 25001/1512/2627
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, ANUGOLA
E-Mail - sencrwAnugola@yahoo.co.in , Phone : 06764 - 236404
NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR ROAD WORKS IN ODISHA
Bid Identification No. Road Online AGL- 29/2026-27
No.____3811_____ // **Dt. ___5/11/26____ //**

1 Name of the work : Road works.
2. Total No. of work : 12 Nos..
3. Estimated cost : Rs. 170.63 to Rs.453.84 Lakhs (Approx.)
4. Class of Contractor : 'As per annexure.
5 Period of completion. : As per annexure.
6. Other details.

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender On-line for bidding From	To	Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Angul	Road Online-AGL- 29/ 2026- 27	16.11.26 at 10.00 A.M	30.11.26 up to 5.00 P.M	27.11.26 up to 1.00 P.M	01.12.26 at 10.00 AM	Will be intimated seperately

For detailed Notice inviting Tenders, Please visit to the website www.tendersorissa.gov.in
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Anugola
OIPR - 5001/25180/1/26-27/0034

SIR: Re-verification set to begin by end of week

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Booth-level officers (BLOs) are likely to begin distributing fresh enumeration forms to nearly 4.7 million voters whose names were excluded from the draft electoral roll during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), by end of this week, officials aware of the development said. Nearly 9.5 million forms will be printed for the exercise with one copy of the submitted form will be retained by the BLO, while the other, carrying an acknowledgement of receipt, will remain with the elector.

Under the fresh outreach drive, each BLO will be required to approach around 300 voters whose names were left out of the draft roll, officials said. The exercise is expected to cover all such electors across the Capital before November 25, the extended deadline for filing claims and objections.

"The forms are being printed. They should be printed in the next couple of days. BLOs will start distributing them by the end of this week," said an official.

The move is aimed at giving voters another opportunity to establish their eligibility and seek inclusion in the electoral roll ahead of the publication of the final list.

Delhi has 14,947 BLOs, many of whom are government school teachers who have been engaged in the SIR exercise since June 30. They will have to reach out to voters whose enumeration forms could not be collected during the initial house-to-house exercise, officials said.

The draft electoral roll, published on August 31, contained around 9.75 million electors, against nearly 14.5 million at the beginning of the revision exercise. This meant that approximately 4.76 million names, accounting for 32.8% of the electorate, were excluded.

These voters were categorised as Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate (ASDD) after enumeration forms could not be collected from them during the initial house-to-house exercise.

The fresh exercise is separate from the verification of nearly 3.3 million voters who were issued notices over logical discrepancies or lack of mapping with the 2002 electoral roll. Those voters were included in the draft roll but were required to establish their eligibility through supporting documents.

The election office had earlier undertaken two reverification drives for the 4.7 million excluded electors.

However, officials said the fresh distribution of enumeration forms would provide another opportunity to those who may have been left out during the earlier exercises.

The Election Commission of India recently extended the deadline for filing claims and objections from October 31 to November 25. The disposal of claims and objections is scheduled to be completed by December 15, while the final electoral roll is now slated to be published on December 22.

5 INJURED, HEAVY DEPLOYMENT OF POLICE AFTER CLASH IN BINDAPUR

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: At least five people were injured, one seriously, after members of two families from different communities living in the same neighbourhood at a slum cluster in southwest Delhi's Bindapur allegedly clashed on Monday afternoon, police said Tuesday.

As tension prevailed following the violent clash, around 150 security personnel were deployed in the area to maintain peace and ensure the incident did not snowball into communal violence, a senior police officer said.

"No communal angle has been noticed. The situation is normal. We have registered two cases – one against each group – for attempted murder and other serious charges. Deployment of personnel in adequate numbers has been done as part of our precautionary measures," deputy commissioner of police (Dwarka) Kushal Pal Singh on Tuesday.

LG INSPECTS EAST DELHI HUB, TELLS DDA AND NBCC TO RUSH CLEARANCES

NEW DELHI: The East Delhi Hub, a 30-hectare integrated urban development project at Karkardooma, is nearing completion, with Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday directing the Delhi Development Authority and executing agency NBCC (India) Ltd to expedite pending statutory clearances and ensure its timely handover.

During an inspection, Sandhu reviewed finishing works in residential towers, civic amenities, and green spaces. He asked officials to ensure seamless coordination between agencies to avoid delays. "East Delhi shall be a benchmark in sustainable, compact urban living. Delivery must match the vision," he said.

The project is being developed under the transit-oriented development model, integrating housing, commercial spaces, civic amenities, and green areas with access to public transport. HTC

LG directs NDMC to push for indigenous tulip propagation

Paras Singh
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI : Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday reviewed the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) hi-tech nursery and tulip propagation chamber at Lodhi Garden and directed the civic body to build on indigenous tulip propagation cycle and prioritise native species.

The LG reviewed efforts towards developing indigenous capabilities for growing tulips in Delhi and reducing dependence on imported bulbs, observing that the "initiative could serve as an example for other agencies to promote local cultivation of tulips".

"Visited NDMC's hi-tech nursery at Lodhi Garden to review tulip growth chambers, year-round sapling production, modern arboricultural equipment and the tree ambulance for heritage trees...Directed NDMC to build an indigenous tulip propagation cycle, expand seasonal blooms and prioritise native species — preserving and enriching the capital's ecological heritage," the LG said in a post on X.

NDMC has stated that for the forthcoming season, it is planning to procure approximately 467,000 tulip bulbs. This will include 300,000 bulbs for NDMC and 167,000 bulbs for Delhi Development Authority (DDA). The council has harvested around 40,000 tulip bulbs from the previous season.

"The idea of growing tulips locally and gradually reducing dependence on imports began as a small step in 2022," said an NDMC official. In the previous season, the civic body harvested approximately 40,000 Tulip Bulbs of different sizes, which are now stored in the tulip growth-cum-storage chamber at Lodhi Garden.

Of these, approximately 24,000 bulbs will be planted in the NDMC area, while the rest will be utilised for trials to enhance the size of bulbs in the growth chamber, the official further said.

Tulip bulbs are generally planted in December, with the flowers typically blooming towards the end of January. The flowering season typically continues until late February to early March, adding vibrant colours to the Capital's parks, roundabouts and prominent roads.

The NDMC began tulip plantation in 2017, with a pilot project of 17,000 bulbs. It will purchase 62,800 bulbs in 2021, 140,000 in 2022, 200,000 in 2023, and 325.000 in 2024. Importing each tulip bulb costs around ₹35-40.

Delhiwale

EXPERIENCE YOUR CITY LIKE NEVER BEFORE

Mayank Austen Soofi

Dial M for Morena

A winter speciality of the street, and the magic of place-names

{PUBLIC INTEREST}

Say Murano and you think of glass. Say Morena and someone might ask how much you want.

Murano is in Italy, and Morena... well, it certainly is not in Delhi. It is in Madhya Pradesh, some hours from Delhi, in the Chambal valley, once known for its dacoits. And yet, Morena turns up in our neighbourhood bazars, around Diwali that is. Look for the banners that say "Morena." Or see this photo of Morena Gajak Bhandar, with its yellow-and-red banner, snapped this afternoon.

Gajak is a winter sweet, believed to warm the body. Morena janpad is so strongly identified with gajak that Morena Gajak even has an official sarkari tag. It is entry No. 681 in India's Geographical Indications Registry, registered in the name of the Morena Gajak Nirmata Association. The little emblem on the certificate shows a peacock (or is it a duck?) with a piece of gajak where its body would be.

The taste is only part of the pleasure. There's also the name. Few writers have described the magic of place-names as memorably as Marcel Proust does in his novel In Search of Lost Time. The name of Parma, a town in northern Italy, is for him "compact and glossy, violet-tinted, soft." As for the name Morena, it can summon you the sound of 'krak krak' that a piece of gajak makes when you bite into it.

In zila Ghaziabad, the main post office is near the railway station. On the narrow, dusty lane leading to it, vendor Maldar is seen this afternoon with his cart heaped up with gajak. It is the day after Diwali and this reporter's first gajak sighting of the season. Maldar says he started selling gajak at the end of October. His gajak, he says, is "local," not made by Morena men.

In Delhi, a modest gajak cart usually has only one kind, made with gur and til. Some stalls sell chocolate gajak too. Some gajaks come embedded with kaju or badam or both.

For a look at how gajak is made, go to Gurugram's Sadar Bazar or Jacobpura in December. At some shops, the karigars (almost all claim to be from Morena) are seen working beside the counter, sitting on their haunches. A karigar brings down his wooden balla on a hot, sticky sheet of gajak. Thak. Again. Thak. You can hear the thak-thak from the gali. The flattened sheet is folded over and over, cut into pieces, and left to harden.

By late January, gajak cooks start to leave Delhi-NCR. A year ago in Gurugram, one cook spoke of going home once the season would be over.

He would return to... guess!

READ: For more stories by Mayank Austen Soofi, scan the QR code

HT Homage

Shri Premchand Ji Sugandhi

(1922 - 1976)

Your values and principles continue to shape our path.

In fond remembrance

Dharampal Premchand Ltd.

In Loving Memory of

Prof. Shri Shyam Charan Varshney
(10th Death Anniversary)

Your loving compassionate nature and vision will always inspire us to higher achievements in life.
We remember and miss you more & more.

Fondly Remembered by:
Suman Varshney (Wife)
Shalini & Sanjay Rastogi (Daughter & Son-in-law)
Sanjay & Manisha Varshney (Son & Daughter-in-law)
Raja & Shalini Varshney (Son & Daughter-in-law)
Shubhika, Vaibhav, Ishita, Akul, Akshita, Tanvi, Khushi & Avish (Grand Children)

SOM EXTRACTS LIMITED
(Part of Som- Varshney Group)

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. Office PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala-147001
Phone No.- 96461-18774, Email id:- semeteringpatiala@gmail.com
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033813, Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-277/2026-27/PR dated 06.11.2026

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Design, Supply, Testing, Commissioning, Integration, Reading, Analysis and 5 year O&M of ISI marked LT AC 3 phase, 4-Wire CT operated Static, DLMS Compliant, Energy Meters (Category-D3) of -/5 A of Accuracy Class 0.5S (for both active and reactive energy) with 'Optical Port', AMI system & Communication infrastructure with a network platform across Punjab. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 06.11.2026, 17.00 PM onwards**.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in.
C1077/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16915

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open E- Tender
Notice No. EL/ TRD /50/ NIT
Dated 06.11.2026
The Sr.Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) West Central Railway, Kota for and on behalf of president of India invite E-tender for following works. **Name of work:** No. EL/TRD/50/04RR (2026 -27) OHE work in connection with the Provision of Model OHE in various TRD depots and Provision of anti- monkey climbing devices in Kota Division., **Approximate cost :** 1,88,97,722.70/-, **Date & Time of closing :** 30/11/2026, 15:30 hrs, **Official Web site & Address.: http://www.ireps.gov.in/** Address:- Divisional Engineer/ Senior Electrical Traction Distribution, Ist Floor, DRM Office, West Central Railway, Kota 324002., The offer is accepted only through E- tendering on website **http://www.ireps. gov.in/.** The bidder should have class III Digital signature certificate and must registered on IREPS Portal. No tender is accepted manually. Please read tender terms and condition before the tendering. **(SD)**
For Sr.Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) West Central Railway, Kota
स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE.LAST WORD.
We are with you in your difficult times.
To place an Obituary Announcement/Remembrance with Hindustan Times
Please call on:

MOHIT BERRY	:	9810978969
ABHISHEK JHA	:	9910545466
HT Direct No	:	011-66561139
Tele Booking	:	1800-103-1800

Rates Effective April 23, 2024

Publications	Rates per sq.cms.
HT Delhi (Metro Run)	₹775/-
HT Delhi (Full Run)	₹900/-
HH Delhi	₹265/-
HT Delhi (Metro Run) + HH - Delhi	₹880/-
HT Delhi (Metro Run) + HT Chd. + HH Delhi	₹970/- New
Mint Delhi	₹250/-
HT (Metro Run) + Mint Delhi	₹800/-
HT Del (Metro Run) + HT Chd. + HH Del + Mint Del	₹1000/- New
HT Del (Metro Run) + HT Chd. + HT Mum + HT Pune	₹1100/- New

*HT - Hindustan Times, HH - Hindustan Hindi *GST as applicable, T&C Apply*
The above rates are applicable for advertisement sizes of up to 320 sq. cm.
Placement of these advertisements will be on specified pages only.
Width of obituary ad will be 4 cm. and thereafter in multiples of 1 cm.*
hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE.LAST WORD.
We are with you in your difficult times.
To place an Obituary Announcement, Remembrance & Homage with Hindustan Times
Please call on
Mohit Berry 9810978969 | Abhishek Jha 9910545466
HT-Direct No 011-66561139 | Tele-Booking 1800-103-1800
hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE.LAST WORD.
EVERYONE HAS A THEORY OURS HAS THE NUMBERS
Hindustan Times NUMBER THEORY
Question assumptions. Discover insights.

LOOK FOR NUMBER THEORY IN HINDUSTAN TIMES
hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

TRUMP ON W ASIA WAR

that Iran was "militarily, effectively over", adding that the US was maintaining the status quo at the request of countries in the region.

Iran, however, said on Tuesday that the conflict could not be resolved through military action or increased sanctions. Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi urged Washington to address Tehran's demands, which he said had been outlined in a proposal submitted to the US.

"The only solution is to adopt a language of respect, engage in diplomacy, and address Iran's demands and conditions — which were outlined in the two-day proposal and remain on the table," Araghchi told the state-run IRNA news agency.

Under the proposal, Iran has offered to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within two days in return for the US agreeing to end the war on all fronts, unfreeze Iranian assets, lift oil sanctions and end its naval blockade of Iranian ports.

Araghchi said the proposal remained on the table. Iran's security chief Mohsen Rezaei said currently no negotiations are taking place between Tehran and Washington even as he urged Washington to accept Tehran's demands.

"The war on Iran has already wrecked the US government. But Washington flails like a desperate gambler. FOLD YOUR HAND. STOP manufacturing FAKE NEWS about imaginary talks," Rezaei, head of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, said in a post on X.

Trump's remarks came less than a week after his Republican Party lost control of both the House of Representatives and the Senate in the November 3 midterm elections. Vice President JD Vance acknowledged in a post on X that voter dissatisfaction with the Iran war had played a major role in the party's defeat.

Trump has also acknowledged that the war hurt his party in the elections, while maintaining that military action was necessary to prevent Iran from acquiring a nuclear weapon.

Democrats have said ending the war will be a priority when the new Congress takes office in January. Incoming Democratic lawmakers have said they would seek to investigate the administration's handling of the conflict and scrutinise funding for the war. An effort to impeach Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth, who has been a central figure in prosecuting the war, is also underway.

The fall in oil prices has continued a sharp reversal in the market this month. Brent crude had risen to a six-month high before tumbling on hopes of de-escalation and continued growth in energy exports from the Persian Gulf. Despite the recent decline, the benchmark remains nearly 50% higher this year.

US gasoline prices also fell below $4 a gallon for the first time since July. The decline could ease some of the pressure on central banks grappling with elevated inflation, even as energy costs remain high.

Oil shipments from the region have moved closer to pre-war levels over the past couple of months, despite continued attacks on ships and restrictions around the Strait of Hormuz. Saudi shipping company Bahri said on Tuesday that it was sending some tankers through the waterway in coordination with the US military.

The security situation in the region, however, remains volatile. Iran continues to attack vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz, with several ships reportedly hit each week. The US has twice launched limited strikes on Iran's Qeshm Island since early last week, saying they were defensive operations intended to help oil tankers and other vessels pass safely through the waterway.

Saudi Arabia's key East-West oil pipeline was targeted on Monday in the Medina region, causing a fire that was later extinguished, the state-run Saudi Press Agency reported, citing an unidentified energy ministry official. The pipeline carries oil from the kingdom's eastern fields to the Red Sea port of Yanbu, allowing Saudi Arabia to bypass the Strait of Hormuz for much of its exports.

The Pentagon has also ordered a third aircraft carrier, the USS Theodore Roosevelt, to the Middle East. The carrier is expected to take at least another two weeks to arrive, according to a Wall Street Journal report on Saturday.

The positions of Washington and Tehran on a possible agreement have differed. Tehran has called for an end to the US naval blockade of its ports and the lifting of sanctions as conditions for peace talks. Washington has pressed Iran to stop attacking vessels in the Strait of Hormuz and make concessions over its nuclear programme.

Bloomberg quoted an official familiar with the matter as saying that the US had signalled during Trump's meeting with the Qatari prime minister that maintaining diplomacy while applying economic pressure on Iran was its preferred approach. Negotiations were expected to continue, with no military escalation likely while diplomatic efforts were underway, the official said, declining to be named while discussing sensitive matters.

The two countries had agreed on a memorandum of understanding in mid-June that included a ceasefire and a commitment to negotiate a final peace deal. The arrangement broke down after about two weeks, with Iran resuming attacks on vessels around Hormuz and accusing the US of failing to ease sanctions and unfreeze Iranian assets as agreed.

Trump has maintained that the damage inflicted on Iran's armed forces and the country's economic difficulties would compel Tehran to end hostilities. He has also continued to threaten strikes on Iranian infrastructure.

"We have 38 bridges in our site that we can knock down in literally one hour. They'll all be down," Trump told CNN, referring to potential strikes on Iranian infrastructure.

The US and Israel began the war on February 28 with strikes that killed Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. They said the military campaign was necessary to prevent Iran from acquiring a nuclear weapon. Tehran has consistently denied seeking a nuclear bomb, although it had enriched uranium to levels far above those required for civilian nuclear power.

LADAKH HILL COUNCIL POLLS

carved out of J&K in 2019, and would empower local elected bodies in the administration of panchayat and civic bodies.

The council poll announcement follows earlier notifications issued by chief electoral officer (CEO) Rahul Sharma for local municipal and panchayat elections. General elections for the municipal committees of Leh and Kargil, along with panchayat *halqas* (areas) across the UT, are scheduled to run concurrently on November 21, concluding by November 30.

Ladakh has been in turmoil in the wake of agitation by locals over statehood demand and inclusion in the Sixth Schedule. Protests over these demands took a violent turn on September 24, 2025 when protesters clashed with police, resulting in death of four people and injury to over 80. Since then several round of talks between the Union home ministry-appointed panel and Ladakh bodies have failed to break the deadlock.

The Ladakh administration on November 5 had notified the delimitation of 100 constituencies of the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDC) in eight districts, specifying the panchayat areas and villages or wards falling under each constituency. The move was aimed at paving the way for elections in the region.

The announcement was met with resentment in some sections of Ladakh.

Shops, commercial establishments, and private offices remained shut in Kargil town as well as outlying areas such as Drass, Sankoo, and Zanskar. Public transport remained off the roads and police were deployed as a precautionary measure.

Organised by the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) —an umbrella group of political, religious, trade, and civil society organisations—the shutdown exempted medical facilities, water supply, and school buses. The KDA also scheduled an evening "Save Democracy" candle light march against the timing of the elections, alleged delimitation irregularities, and what they termed the erosion of democratic rights.

Three major organisations—the Ladakh Nambardar Association, the Ladakh Gompa Association, and the Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA)—announced a boycott of both the panchayat and municipal committee elections.

Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) leader Sajjad Kargili said the shutdown highlighted how democracy was being weakened. "Democracy is being made hollow, our lands are being stolen from us, notifications and orders are being passed by officials without seeking consent from locals. Gerrymandering is being done through delimitation," Kargili said.

LBA president Chering Dorjay Lakrook, who also heads the Leh Apex Body (LAB), cited dissatisfaction with the newly finalised 100-constituency delimitation process, unfulfilled promises regarding liquor policy reforms following protests by women's groups, and a lack of faith in the administration's sincerity.

Last week, Ladakh Lok Sabha MP Mohmad Haneefa Jan wrote to lieutenant governor Vinai Kumar Saxena, urging a postponement of all local body and council polls to spring (April-May). Jan warned that sub-zero temperatures (ranging from -20°C to -25°C), heavy snowfall, road blockages, and seasonal migration of senior citizens, traders, and students to warmer regions like Jammu, Srinagar, and Delhi risked disenfranchising a large portion of the electorate.

But the government pushed back. "I am confident that even the people of Kargil will participate fully in the elections. I can only appeal to the leaders of Kargil and Leh to participate in these elections and show the Centre that they want democracy," said Ladakh chief secretary Kundra.

NVIDIA, CEO FACE SUIT

about Nvidia's relationship with Megaspeed, which posed a "material risk" to Nvidia's reputation and business prospects.

Nvidia didn't immediately respond to a request for comment.

The complaint, filed by retail investor Mark Kistenmacher, seeks unspecified damages and a jury trial. It seeks to represent in a class-action lawsuit anyone who bought shares of Nvidia from October 9, when The New York Times first reported about the pair socializing in Taiwan, until November 8, when the company said it was investigating reports that Huang was the "target of a foreign intelligence effort."

Shares of Nvidia, one of the world's most valuable companies, fell $7.97, or 4.3%, on Monday, wiping out about $190 billion in market value. Shares were down again Tuesday before the opening bell.

"As a result of Defendants' wrongful acts and omissions, and the precipitous decline in the market value of the Company's securities, Plaintiff and other Class members have suffered significant losses and damages," the complaint said.

Had investors known the truth, they wouldn't have purchased Nvidia's shares "at the artificially inflated prices that they did, or at all," the complaint said.

The New York Times reported that U.S. intelligence determined that Alice Huang, a former executive of Megaspeed International, was gathering information for Beijing. Huang is a common Chinese surname and the two are not related.

Megaspeed bought more than $4.8 billion worth of Nvidia chips over the past two years, according to The Times.

Trump said in a White House briefing that the FBI is "looking into" the affair, but added he doesn't think Huang needs to worry, saying "he'll be in good shape."

The episode is also starting to attract congressional scrutiny, with top Democrats Sen. Mark Warner and Rep. Hakeem Jeffries saying Monday they are interested in investigating it further.

Huang is a singular figure in the technology landscape and one of the world's wealthiest people thanks to booming demand for his company's microprocessors, which are in huge demand for cloud computing and data centers that underpin the AI boom.

He apologized to his wife, family and the company for the affair in an open letter posted on Nvidia's website.

"I support the investigation and will cooperate fully. I love our country and our company. I am committed to protecting NVIDIA and supporting America's national security," Huang said in his letter.

2026 BOOKER PRIZE

"It's a grim world, and it'll keep on being grim. And it's weird. But at the end of things there may be some kind of — I wouldn't say hope, or closure, but there might be some kind of relief."

Critics have praised the book's dark humour, though some have been confused by its elusive narrative. Historian Mary Beard, who chaired the judging panel, said the book is "the politics of now seen through the lens of the future," and about a society "undergoing a catastrophe that they don't really understand."

"What he does is to say, when the catastrophe comes, you won't know what's happening," Beard said. "And there are bits where you, the reader, are with the characters in not fully understanding. Now, I think that's fantastically exciting."

Harrison spent years working for the speculative fiction magazine New Worlds, and he won the Arthur C. Clarke science fiction award for a previous novel, "Nova Swing." Although borders between publishing genres are increasingly blurred, it's still rare for a work of sci-fi to win a major literary prize.

Harrison said before he won that he had been "working for 40 to 50 years to shift the balance, both as a novelist and as a critic. Why shouldn't a well-written (work of science fiction) be considered to be literary fiction?"

He said after winning that the publishing industry had done nothing to break down barriers between categories.

"There's almost no point these days in writing your own book, because it will be framed as something else to sell it," he said. "To a degree, that's quite offensive" to the author.

He said the validation of the Booker Prize "gives you permission to be what you are, without a label stuck on your forehead."

Beard said Harrison's win was "recognition of what some people would see as the blindingly obvious, that you find great books in every genre."

Founded in 1969, the Booker Prize is open to English-language novels from any country published in the U.K. and Ireland and has a reputation for transforming writers' careers.

Its winners have included Salman Rushdie, Ian McEwan and Arundhati Roy. Last year's winner was "Flesh" by Hungarian-British writer David Szalay.

Harrison is the oldest writer to win the Booker, two years older than Margaret Atwood when she won in 2019. "The End of Everything" is his 13th novel. But Beard said the prize was definitely "not a lifetime achievement award."

"We thought this was a book that had earned it," Beard said.

She said the judges, who included poet Raymond Antrobus and singer Jarvis Cocker from the band Pulp, met for four or five hours to pick a winner, and the choice was ultimately unanimous. As for what he plans to do with the prize money, Harrison said: "I think I'll probably spend it on repairs to the house. Because being an author means your house is falling down all the time."

SOREN ORDERS CBI PROBE INTO TRIBAL LEADER'S DEATH; SHO SUSPENDED

Raj Kumar
letters@hindustantimes.com

RANCHI: Jharkhand chief minister Hemant Soren on Tuesday ordered a CBI probe into the death of 39-year-old tribal activist and leader, hours after the officer-in-charge of Pithoria police station was removed from his post following conspiracy allegations.

The tribal leader died allegedly by suicide on November 6 after going live on Facebook, accusing the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha-led government in the state and land brokers of harassing her. Her parents have alleged a conspiracy behind her death and demanded a CBI probe into the incident.

"The CBI will now investigate the Nisha Bhagat case. Orders have been issued," CM Soren announced on X.

The development came on a day the National Commission for Scheduled Tribe (NCST) directed officials to probe into the case, and submit a report within seven days, further warning of legal action in case of non-compliance, according to an official notice, seen by HT.

Taking a suo motu cognisance of the case, the NCST served the notice to Jharkhand chief secretary, director general of police, and Ranchi SSP.

The NCST has further warned that failure to comply or provide the requested information within seven days will result in legal action, compelling the officials to appear personally or through representatives before the Commission in New Delhi.

"...you are hereby requested to submit the information regarding the action taken on the related allegations/matters and information to the undersigned within seven days of the receipt of this notice by post, in person, or through any other means of communication," the ST panel's notice said.

Meanwhile, police have registered an FIR against two accused on November 7 based on a complaint lodged by the activist's father, an officer said.

"...Besides, officer-in-charge Satish Kumar Pandey has been sent to the police lines," Ranchi (Rural) SP Gaurav Goswami was quoted as saying by news agency PTI.

CHANDIGARH INSTITUTE FOR TRANSFORMATION

Appointments

CORRIGENDUM

The TORs for the posts of Team Leader, Sector Expert I and Sector Expert II, published on October 17, 2026, have been updated. The changes in experience are notified on the website: **https://www.chandigarh.gov.in/information/public-notices**. The last date of submission of forms is now November, 20th, 2026.

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Office of the Superintending Engineer, DS Circle, PSPCL, Patiala,
66 KV Grid Sub Station Colony, DCW Road, Patiala -147001 (Punjab),
96461-01201, 96461-10963, E-mail: circlepatiala1@gmail.com
Reg. Office: PSPCL Head Office, The Mall, Patiala (Punjab)

Tender Enquiry No. 43/SE/DS Circle, Patiala/2026-27 **Dated: 10.11.2026**

Superintending Engineer/DS Circle, PSPCL Patiala invites e-tender for Outsourcing of Labour Part for Erection, Testing & Commissioning of New 11KVLT/HTLines on Rail/PCC Poles, Distribution T/Fs, Augmentation/Sagging of ACSR of HT/LT Lines, Cables laying, Guarding, Stay Set for Various Works such as Releasing of T/Well Connections, GSC/ISC Connections, Deloading of Overloaded T/Fs, Shifting of Meters Outside Consumer Premises, Preventive maintenance of HT/LT lines not involving conductor replacement or insertion of extra poles Earthing of DTs/Lines or any Development Works under DS Division Rajpura under DS Circle Patiala for F.Y. 2027-28.

For detailed NIT and Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 10.11.2026, 06.00 PM onwards.**

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1079/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16920

Government of Punjab
State Health Agency, Punjab
Department of Health and Family Welfare
BSNL Circle Office, 4th Floor, Sector-34, Chandigarh
Visit us at: www.sha.punjab.gov.in, E-mail: ceo.sha.pb@punjab.gov.in

No. SHA/Admin/2026 Date:

Notice Inviting Tender
FOR HIRING OF CONCURRENT AUDIT AGENCY
(Medical Audit, Field Investigation and Verification)

Online Competitive bids are invited from eligible bidders for hiring of concurrent Audit Agency (Medical Audit, Field Investigation and Verification) at State Health Agency, Punjab.

The Tender Document shall be available on the website e-tender portal **eproc.punjab.gov.in** with effect from 11.11.2026. Bidders shall submit their Bids on this website/ e-tender portal as per the guidelines specified in the Tender Document. It shall be the responsibility of the Bidders to regularly check the website, e-tender portal for any notice/addenda issued in this regard.

All correspondence/ communications on the Tender Document should be made at the above address and at email id: **shapunjab.tender25@gmail.com**

Any corrigendum/addendum issued in connection with the tender shall be uploaded on the e-Procurement Portal and the official website of SHA Punjab **(shapunjab.gov.in)**.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
RO NO. 1957/12/2026/27/16936 **State Health Agency, Punjab**

Haryana State Council for Science, Innovation & Technology
(Directorate of Science & Technology, Haryana)
Bays 35-38, Sector 2, Panchkula-134109

PROMOTION OF SCIENCE EDUCATION (POSE) SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME 2026-27

Online applications are invited from students for availing scholarships under the scheme for pursuing courses in Basic & Natural Science subjects.

For eligibility and other details, interested students may visit and see the guidelines of the scheme on the website at link **https://dst.highereduhry.ac.in** under the "Students" tab.

Students can visit the link: **https://harchhatravratti.highereduhry.ac.in** and submit their applications online by first doing registration under the tab "Student". The web-portal will be remain open from **12.11.2026 to 12.01.2027** for online submission.

Secretary
RO NO. 1099/11/44/2027/50907/19/7 **Executive Committee**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED IMMUNO HEMATOLOGY ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	1,26,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED CHEMILUMINISCENCE (CLIA) ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	60,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATED CENTRIFUGE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	2,25,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

RO NO. 13/2027/80/50912/I/19/7 **FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in**

Grandson can't claim birthright in property after partition: SC

{ SUPREME COURT }

With the partition, the property of the grandfather of the appellant ceased to be joint family property, inasmuch as all heirs succeeded the same as tenants

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has ruled that a son cannot claim coparcenary rights in his grandfather's ancestral property after it has been partitioned among the grandfather's legal heirs, with the share allotted to his father becoming his exclusive property under the Hindu Succession Act, 1956.

Dismissing a 29-year-old partition suit filed on behalf of a minor son who claimed half of his grandfather's property, the court held that once the property devolved upon the grandfather's Class I legal heirs and was divided among them, the joint coparcenary ceased to exist. The grandson could not subsequently claim a share in the property allotted to his father merely on the basis of his birth.

A bench of justices Augustine George Masih and Sunita Agarwal, in a judgment delivered on November 6, held that the property inherited by the father under Section 8 of the Hindu Succession Act became his individual property, leaving no scope for his son to assert an independent coparcenary interest in it.

"The property of grandfather of the appellant devolved upon the Class I heirs in the order of succession specified therein, and they shall take the property simultaneously to the exclusion of all other heirs," Justice Agarwal, who authored the judgment, said.

Under the 1956 Act, Class I heirs include a deceased Hindu male's widow, son, daughter and mother who inherit the property simultaneously, ahead of all other categories of heirs.

The case originated in 1997 when the appellant, the grandson, was still a minor and his mother, acting as his natural guardian, filed a suit seeking partition and possession of half of a 1,811-square-foot property in Chennai. He claimed that the property originally belonged to his grandfather and that he had acquired a coparcenary interest in it by birth.

However, the property had already been divided among his grandfather's legal heirs following a partition suit instituted in 1993 by the appellant's paternal aunt. A compromise decree was passed on February 3, 1994, under which the appellant's father, who was one of the legal heirs, received a share measuring 1,811 square feet. He subsequently sold the property through two sale deeds executed in April 1997.

The appellant, who was born in January 1994, contended that since the compromise decree was passed after his birth, he had already acquired coparcenary rights in the ancestral property and should have been made a party to the partition proceedings. He also relied on the Tamil Nadu amendment to the Hindu Succession Act, which recognised daughters as coparceners by birth, arguing that the amendment preserved the coparcenary character of the property.

Rejecting the argument, the Supreme Court explained that when a Hindu male dies intestate, his property devolves upon the Class I heirs under the 1956 Act. A grandson whose father is alive is not included in the list of Class I heirs and cannot claim a direct share in his grandfather's property through succession.

The court relied on its earlier ruling in Commissioner of Wealth Tax Vs Chander Sen (1986), which held that property inherited by a son under the 1956 Act devolves upon him in his individual capacity and does not automatically become Hindu undivided family property as regards to his own son.

Applying these principles, the bench said that the grandfather's property had devolved upon his surviving sons and daughters as Class I heirs, each of whom became entitled to an individual share. The compromise decree of February 3, 1994, subsequently made each heir the exclusive owner of the property falling to their respective shares.

"With the partition, the property of the grandfather of the appellant ceased to be joint family property, inasmuch as all heirs succeeded the same as tenants in common and not as joint tenants, and joint coparcenary did not continue," the judgment said.

It further noted that the succession had opened upon the grandfather's death, which was before the appellant's birth, as evident from the partition suit instituted in 1993. Consequently, there was no question of any interest in the property devolving upon him subsequently.

The court also rejected the reliance on Section 29-A of the Hindu Succession (Tamil Nadu Amendment) Act, 1989, and the unamended Section 6 of the Hindu Succession Act, holding that neither provision could confer coparcenary rights on the appellant in the facts of the case.

The bench pointed out that the 1997 suit had sought only partition and possession of half the property and did not challenge either the 1994 compromise decree or the two sale deeds executed by the father in favour of the purchasers. The father, who remained ex parte throughout the proceedings, died in 2024.

The dispute travelled through the trial court and the Madras high court before reaching the Supreme Court in a special leave petition in 2011. The trial court had initially granted a preliminary decree for partition, but the first appellate court set it aside, a decision subsequently upheld by the high court in August 2010.

{ BJP CALLS MEMOIR 'WHITEWASH', CONG HITS BACK }

Sonia's book triggers political war of words

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

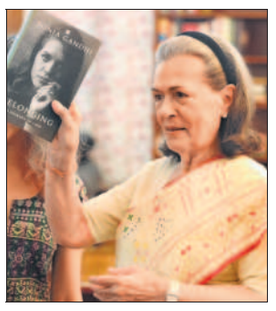
NEW DELHI: A war of words broke out between the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the Congress following the release of Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi's book, *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, while the ruling party alleged that the memoir sought to "whitewash" the wrongs committed by the Nehru-Gandhi family, the Congress rebutted the allegations, accusing the BJP of raising historical controversies for political gains.

The memoir, which recounts Sonia's childhood in post-war Italy and meeting Rajiv Gandhi at Cambridge to her life in India and her bond with the country, went on sale on Tuesday.

The BJP launched attacks referring to Sonia's accounts in the book, including the post-Operation Blue Star reflections, anti-Sikh riots, her references to the Babri Masjid, the Batla House encounter, and the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks.

Union minister Giriraj Singh took a swipe at Sonia for noting in her memoir that Prime Minister Narendra Modi tends to look away whenever he comes face-to-face with her, saying, "With how many people will he make eye contact? He has already made eye contact once."

Targeting over the reference to anti-Sikh riots of 1984, BJP leader HS Phoolka, a prominent lawyer who fought cases for Sikh victims, said in a press conference: "In her book, she (Sonia) has attempted to grant a self-clean chit to her own family—even regarding the massacre of Sikhs..." "This account is entirely contrary to the facts," said Phoolka. "...in her book, Sonia Gandhi attempts to absolve Rajiv Gandhi and their family. This stands in direct contradiction to the official record. It is an absolute lie," the BJP leader said.



Sonia Gandhi with her memoir.

BJP national spokesperson CR Kesavan criticised the memoir, suggesting it could have been titled "Whitewashing".

"...the motive of this book appears to be sugarcoating the historical wrongs perpetrated by the Nehru-Gandhi family and camouflaging the cardinal sins committed by the Congress party," Kesavan said.

Shiv Sena leader Shaina NC said in "1991, 1984 and 2004, you made the country cry, and now you speak of belonging. Is this belonging about votes? The way you rejected the chair back then, and the way you presented yourself thereafter, was portrayed as an act of sacrifice and penance..."

In her book, Sonia said she was shocked by former President Pranab Mukherjee's suggestion of a change at the top, which she understood as "a hint of his long-held desire to become prime minister".

Mukherjee's daughter Sharmistha said: "What's there to get 'shocked' about? Is it a crime to be ambitious. especially when that 'ambition' was supported by decades of experience in politics and governance, hard work & a brilliant mind?"

She added that Mukherjee came from a very humble background and whatever he achieved was through merit & hard-work. There was no-one to serve him positions, including PM-ship, on a platter due to dynastic entitlements.

Meanwhile, the Opposition parties came forward in support of the memoir, defending the accounts in the book.

Peoples Democratic Party chief Mehbooba Mufti praised the Congress leader. "Sonia Gandhi has evolved into a leader, then into a stateswoman, she has gone through a lot. I think no other woman politician would have endured as much as she did," she said in Srinagar.

Responding to the BJP's criticism over Operation Blue Star, Congress MP Pramod Tiwari accused the ruling party of "scratching old wounds" ahead of the Punjab assembly elections.

"The Sikh community was hurt and everyone apologised to the community. This is in the past. But as there are going to be elections in Punjab, out of habit BJP is scratching old wounds. They are attempting to benefit from it," Tiwari told ANI.

Congress MP Jebi Mather referred Sonia in describing the development as a "Tamasha". "...For somebody as bold as Sonia Gandhi, she has the courage to speak the truth...Let her have the right to say that. For the BJP, everything is an agenda," she said.

Govt-controlled bodies not immune from scrutiny: SC

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

This came as the SC upheld a ruling that declared NBT an instrumentality of the govt.

NEW DELHI: An organisation cannot escape constitutional scrutiny simply because the government has chosen to set it up as a society rather than a government department or statutory body, the Supreme Court has ruled, making it clear that what matters is the extent of government control over its functioning and decision-making, not the legal form it adopts.

The court said the government cannot sidestep its constitutional obligations by carrying out activities through separately registered entities. However, it clarified that merely receiving government grants, performing public functions or having some government involvement would not automatically make an organisation an arm of the state.

The observations came as a bench of justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Augustine George Masih upheld a 2012 Delhi High Court ruling that declared the National Book Trust (NBT) an instrumentality of the government and, therefore, "state" within the meaning of Article 12 of the Constitution. The trust had challenged the high court's ruling, maintaining that it was an autonomous society and not a government department or statutory corporation.

"Registration as a society does not place a body mandatorily beyond Article 12 of the Constitution," the bench said in its November 6 judgment, adding that the constitutional inquiry must focus on the substance of the relationship between the body and the government rather than the name or legal form under which it operates.

Article 12 defines "state" for the purpose of Part III of the Constitution, which deals with fundamental rights. An organisation falling within this definition is subject to constitutional scrutiny, and its actions can be challenged if they violate fundamental rights, including through writ proceedings.

The court explained that the test is whether the government exercises such "deep and pervasive control" over an organisation that its financial, functional and administrative autonomy is substantially circumscribed.

Applying this test to the NBT, the bench found that the government was involved in virtually every important aspect of the trust's functioning, beginning with its creation and extending to its management, finances and decision-making. Senior counsel Sanjay Jain assisted the court as amicus curiae.

The bench noted that NBT's chairman is appointed by the government and holds office at its pleasure and the government's influence also extends to the trust's financial affairs.

"These provisions cannot, in our view, be characterised as isolated instances of ordinary regulatory supervision," it said.

The trust had argued that it could not be treated as a government instrumentality because it was registered as a society and generated a substantial part of its income independently through the sale of books. Rejecting this argument, the court said the source of an organisation's income cannot be examined in isolation from the larger structure governing its functioning.

Financial assistance from the government is an important consideration, but not the only one, the bench said. Equally, the fact that a body earns its own revenue does not establish that it functions independently of the government.

Upholding the high court's 2012 ruling, the bench dismissed the NBT's appeal, holding that the government's involvement in the trust was sufficiently deep and pervasive to bring it within the constitutional definition of 'state'. Its actions will, therefore, remain subject to fundamental-rights scrutiny.

Fadnavis defends UCC move, says NCP merger issue rests with Pawars

Surendra P Gangan
letters@hindustantimes.com

Devendra Fadnavis

MUMBAI: Maharashtra chief minister Devendra Fadnavis on Tuesday defended the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led Mahayuti government's decision to draft a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in the state, asserting that the Constitution itself directs states to work towards its implementation.

Speaking to reporters at his official residence in south Mumbai, Fadnavis, while commenting on the NCP merger issue, said only Sharad Pawar and Sunetra Pawar, who head the rival factions, could clarify whether their parties would reunite.

"Constitution contains the Directive Principles of State Policy, which talk about the UCC. Thus, it is the constitutional responsibility of every state. The court has now stayed its implementation, but it remains the responsibility of the states," he said. The statement came in response to AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi's criticism that the proposed law was unconstitutional.

"If Owaisi had read the Constitution a little, he would not have said that we are bringing this outside its framework or considering ourselves bigger than the Constitution. The Constitution itself has directed us to do this," Fadnavis added.

Earlier in the day, Owaisi told reporters opposed the proposed UCC in Maharashtra, contending it was an attempt to impose 'Hindu Civil Code' on non-Hindus.

When asked about the issue of NCP merger, the chief minister said neither faction had informed the BJP about any such move.

"If they (Sharad Pawar and Sunetra Pawar) decide to merge (their parties), they will come and tell us, because the merger cannot happen without us. Neither of them has told us anything yet," he said.

The merger buzz gained strength last week after several leaders of the Sunetra Pawar-led NCP, including Praful Patel and Parth Pawar, met NCP (SP) head Sharad Pawar.

Fadnavis also played down the firing incidents allegedly involving the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, describing them as attempts to create fear among people, and alleging that the Opposition was trying to orchestrate street protests similar to the in neighbouring countries. "These are not big issues. The Mumbai Police force has no parallel in its professionalism. All those involved in the firing incident targeting Tiger Shroff have been arrested...," he said.

Talking about the Disha Salian death case, the CM said the Mumbai Police had found no foul play and CBI was now probing the matter in accordance with the court's directions.

He said the Mumbai Police's Special Investigation Team (SIT) had submitted its report long ago and found nothing objectionable. "The report was made on the basis of the material available with the police," he said.

"The court found certain deficiencies in the report. CBI is now probing the matter and will take it forward...," the CM said.

FORMER NCP MLA, MAHAYUTI'S RAJESH PATIL ELECTED GOKUL CHAIRMAN

Ranjan Dasgupta
letters@hindustantimes.com

PUNE: Former Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) MLA Rajesh Patil, a nominee of the Mahayuti-backed panel, was elected chairman of the Kolhapur District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union, popularly known as Gokul, on Tuesday, defeating the candidate fielded by the panel led by Congress MLC Satej Patil.

Patil, a former MLA from Chandgad in Kolhapur district, was a staunch loyalist of the late NCP chief Ajit Pawar.

In the election, Patil secured 16 votes, including those cast by four state government-nominated directors, defeating his rival Shashikant Patil Chuyekar by a margin of three votes.

The election has been marked by a political tussle and controversy over the state government's decision to nominate directors to the cooperative body's board and grant them voting rights.

NCP minister Hassan Mushrif and BJP minister Chandrakant Patil congratulated the newly elected chairman. "The new chairman will ensure smooth functioning of Gokul and work for the betterment of the 5.5 lakh (550,000) dairy farmers associated with Gokul. We did not stop our opposition from electing its chairman. But they were short of the mandatory quorum needed to elect the chairman. Had this situation continued, the state government would have been forced to appoint an administrator, which no one wanted," Mushrif said.

CRPF set to acquire kamikaze drones for anti-insurgency ops

WHILE CRPF HAS NOT SHARED THE DETAILS YET, THE DRONES COULD BE USED BY PERSONNEL IN J&K AND MANIPUR

Prawesh Lama
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Central Reserve Police Force is set to acquire kamikaze drones for counter-insurgency operations, according to a document circulated to stakeholders on Monday seeking information, by month-end, on products they can supply.

Kamikaze drones are loitering munitions designed to destroy themselves in order to destroy a specific target . If acquired soon, kamikaze drones could prove useful in new conflict areas. According to the Quality Requirements (QRs) and Trial Directives circulated to stakeholders on Monday, the drones must carry two high-explosive warheads weighing a minimum of 1.5kg. They must have a range of at least 15km and an endurance of at least 30 minutes of flight time while carrying the payload.

Their role will be "to carry out one-way missions against designated objectives, using a remotely operated aerial vehicle with a killing/impact radius of 10 metres". The document circulated to stakeholders on Monday directed them to submit information by November 25.

Meanwhile, in a separate development, the Centre has approved one more battalion of its guerrilla warfare force, CoBRA, for Manipur, and may deploy the force in Jammu & Kashmir in the future, people aware of the matter said. On Sunday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited one of CoBRA's key operational bases in Bastar, Chhattisgarh, to celebrate Diwali with commandos and other security personnel who fought Maoists.

Raised in 2008, the Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA) was deployed exclusively in anti-Naxal operations until May 2026, when, after India was declared Naxal-free, two battalions were deployed in Manipur.

People aware of the matter said sending more CoBRA battalions to Manipur and elsewhere is possible because the two battalions deployed there in May 2026 have delivered positive results.

"CoBRA teams have been successfully reoriented in Manipur. Since May 2026, CoBRA have been involved in all counter-insurgency operations in Manipur. The state requested two more battalions of the insurgency force...," an official aware of the matter said, adding that regular Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) will remain posted. "The deployment of a third CoBRA battalion in Manipur will happen very soon, while in Jammu & Kashmir, it may happen in the coming years," the official added.

Cong announces 2nd Bharat Summit in Hyd

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Tuesday announced the second edition of the Bharat Summit— an international gathering of what the party describes as progressive political leaders, policymakers and thinkers— which will bring together around 1,000 delegates from 70 countries in Hyderabad from November 12 to 14, 2026.

The summit will focus on global political and economic developments, democratic values and cooperation between countries of the Global South and Global North.

"We hope and expect that the event will reflect Shri Rahul Gandhi's vision for India," a Congress leader said.

Wrestlers failed to substantiate claims: Brij Bhushan to court

NEW DELHI: Former Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) chief and Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh has opposed the challenge to his acquittal in a sexual harassment case, telling a Delhi court that the four women wrestlers had failed to produce independent witnesses or provide consistent details of the alleged incidents during the trial.
The case will be taken up next on November 20.

Bihar govt hikes DA, DR for employees and pensioners

PATNA: Bihar Cabinet on Tuesday approved an increase in the dearness allowance for its employees and dearness relief for pensioners with effect from July 1, 2026.
The Cabinet approved the proposal by the state finance ministry that mentioned an increase from 60% to 63% under the 7th Pay Commission structure; an increase from 262% to 269% under 6th Pay Commission; and from 483% to 497% under the 5th Pay Commission.

SUVENDU HITS OUT AT MAMATA OVER 'CONCEALMENT' IN POLL AFFIDAVIT

KOLKATA: West Bengal chief minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday said he is likely to initiate fresh legal proceedings against his predecessor Mamata Banerjee, alleging that she had concealed crucial information in her election affidavits while contesting the 2026 Assembly polls.

Adhikari also said the role of the returning officer who had accepted Banerjee's nomination papers despite objections raised during scrutiny would be investigated, opening another legal front in the political confrontation between the two leaders.

"She (Mamata) concealed several important details in her election affidavit. During scrutiny, several candidates had raised objections in this regard. Despite this, the returning officer concerned rejected those objections and cleared her nomination. The discrepancies were not taken into account during scrutiny," he said.

"I plan to initiate legal proceedings over this. Such things cannot be allowed," Adhikari told reporters. **PTI**

{ SANJIT 'BUNKER' ROY } 1945-2026

Activist who redefined fight against poverty dies at 81

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAIPUR: Social activist and Padma Shri recipient Sanjit "Bunker" Roy, who transformed a village in Rajasthan into a globally-recognised centre challenging conventional notions of education and grassroots development by making rural communities agents of change died on Tuesday. He was 81.

The founder of Social Work and Research Centre (SWRC), popularly known as Barefoot College, Roy died at 6.15am at his home in Tilonia, surrounded by his wife Aruna Roy and people close to him, a statement issued by the centre said.

Born on June 30, 1945, in West Bengal's Burnpur, Roy studied at The Doon School and Delhi's St Stephen's College. A privileged education primed him for a conventional career, but witnessing the devastation during the Bihar famine of 1966-67 prompted him to work with rural communities.

In 1967, he moved to Tilonia in Ajmer, where he began working with farmer Meghraj to drill open wells to recharge groundwater in one of India's most water-scarce regions.

He established the SWRC in Tilonia in 1972. Rooted in Mahatma Gandhi's principles of self-reliance, dignity and decentralisation, it was built on the belief that rural communities had the knowledge and skills to identify and address their own development challenges, and gradually evolved into a community-led development experiment which covered education, healthcare, livelihoods, water and renewable energy.

Under its celebrated solar electrification project, women from remote villages trained as solar engineers. Popularly known as "Solar Mamas", they learnt to assemble, install, repair and maintain solar lighting systems before electrifying their own villages. The programme eventually reached across borders. "His legacy will live on in the countless lives he transformed across the world," Barefoot College said in its tribute.

Roy was awarded the Padma Shri in 1986 and was named among TIME magazine's "100 Most Influential People in the World" in 2010. Other honours included the Jamnalal Bajaj Award for the application of science and technology to rural development in 1985, the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement (2004), the Skoll Award for Social Entrepreneurship (2005) and the Blue Planet Prize (2011). He also received the Clinton Global Citizen Award in 2013.

Former Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot and Congress MP Shashi Tharoor both took to social media to condole Roy's death.

"His entire life was dedicated to empowering villages and bringing positive change to the lives of disadvantaged communities.I had known him for a very long time," wrote Gehlot.

Tharoor referred to Roy as a visionary, pioneer and educator. "His extraordinary vision of training rural grandmothers into "Barefoot Solar Engineers" illuminated thousands of off-grid homes across India and the developing world, leaving behind an indelible legacy of dignity, community empowerment, and environmental stewardship," he wrote on X.

Hasina's plan to return home will require a travel document: MEA

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday refused to be drawn on the issue of former prime minister Sheikh Hasina seeking a passport from the Bangladesh high commission to facilitate her return home next month, with the external affairs ministry only saying that such travel plans will require a "travel document".

Hasina, who has lived in self-imposed exile in India since her government was toppled in a student-led uprising in August 2024, approached the Bangladesh mission in New Delhi on Monday to seek a passport and a national identity card ahead of her planned return home in December.

The request was swiftly dismissed by Bangladesh's deputy foreign minister Humaiun Kobir, who reiterated Dhaka's demand for her extradition.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal declined to comment when he was asked about Hasina seeking a passport from Bangladeshi authorities at a regular media briefing. "The question that you asked is essentially a question

Sheikh Hasina

that you must pose to the Bangladesh high commission. This is a matter which they would be in a better position to convey to you, what is the sense they have on this particular issue," he said.

Jaiswal responded to another question on Bangladesh's demand for Hasina's extradition by repeating India's stated position that this is "a legal matter, and it will be dealt with accordingly".

When Jaiswal was asked specifically whether the extradition of a person will be possible if they did not possess a passport, he replied: "Obviously, for the travel of people, you need a travel document. That is what I understand, but it is a technical matter."

Bangladeshi authorities revoked Hasina's passport after she fled to India, and the activities of her Awami League party were banned. Her request for a passport and national identity card are being seen as preparations for her return to Bangladesh in December, since possession of the travel document will give her a greater say in deciding the circumstances of her return.

The former PM has said in several recent interviews that she intends to return home next month despite facing the possibility of arrest.

Hasina was sentenced to death by Bangladesh's International Crimes Tribunal in 2025 for crimes against humanity on the ground that she was responsible for ordering a crackdown on student-led protests that left hundreds dead and thousands injured.

She denies any wrongdoing, has rejected the tribunal's verdict, and has challenged the legitimacy of her trial.

Her presence in India has emerged as a key irritant in relations between New Delhi and the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) government in Dhaka. Bangladeshi officials have also urged the Indian side not to allow her to air her political views from Indian soil.

Fabricated, malicious, frivolous: Govt rejects lawsuit by separatist

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI/WASHINGTON: India on Tuesday rejected the case filed by Khalistani separatist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun in the US against National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and the Union government, describing such moves as "fabricated and malicious attacks" that will not stand the test of legal processes.

At the same time, the Indian side has taken up the "frivolous nature" of Pannun's lawsuit with US authorities, people familiar with the matter said on condition of anonymity. They noted that the NSA enjoys diplomatic immunity and said the legal moves by Pannun are aimed at keeping the Khalistan issue in the limelight and have no legal merit, they said.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal dismissed the case by Pannun when he was asked about it at a regular media briefing. He also made it clear that all official communications related to the issue will have to be routed through India's law ministry.

"We reject the fabricated and malicious attacks on our high officials, as also we reject the frivolous lawsuits," he said.

The US state department transmitted a civil lawsuit filed by Pannun against the Indian government to the Indian embassy in Washington through diplomatic channels, while a federal court in New York separately cleared the way for the separatist to serve summonses on Doval and former Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) chief Samant Goel through Indian courts.

The two developments mark separate steps in the process of formally notifying the defendants in the civil suit, which alleges that Indian officials conspired to assassinate Pannun at his New York home in 2023. However, neither amounts to a

Gurpatwant Singh Pannun

judicial finding on the allegations, and the latest court order does not establish any liability on the part of the Indian government or the two officials.

In a letter to the US District Court for the Southern District of New York dated October 20, the state department stated that it transmitted the summons, complaint and notice of suit to the Indian embassy under cover of a diplomatic note signed on September 30 and delivered on October 9.

The department said the transmission was undertaken in discharge of its statutory responsibilities under the US Foreign Sovereign Immunities Act (FSIA), while making clear it was not taking any position on the merits of the case or whether all legal requirements for service had been fulfilled.

The people cited above added that this was not the proper procedure for serving such documents.

They also noted that such matters come under the purview of The Hague Convention, especially the Service Convention of 1965 that governs the cross-border service of judicial documents.

India has for long taken up the activities of Pannun and other Khalistani separatists based in North America with the US side, including the threats issued by them against Indian diplomats and missions.

The Indian side has also informed the US side of the frivolous nature of legal cases filed by the separatists.

Govt: Our strong relationship has bipartisan support in US

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The India-US relationship has bipartisan support on the US side and New Delhi will continue to focus on strengthening the bilateral strategic partnership, the external affairs ministry said in its first reaction to the sweeping victory of the Democratic Party in the US mid-term elections.

The Democrats wrested control of both the US Senate and the House of Representatives, dealing a blow to the Republican Party, whose fortunes were affected by the growing unpopularity of President Donald Trump over his economic policies and the war with Iran.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal described the mid-term elections as "an internal matter of the US". "I have no specific comment on [the mid-term elections], beyond underlining that the India-US relationship enjoys bipartisan support in the US. We continue to

Randhir Jaiswal

work to further strengthen our comprehensive global strategic partnership that we share with the US," he said.

He responded to another question on the Indian government's hiring of lobbying firms in the US by describing it as a "normal practice" since 1948. Such activities are in line with relevant US laws, he said.

"It is a normal practice in the US for diplomatic missions, as indeed other entities, to hire lobby firms for their outreach and engagement with the US administration, the US Congress, and other relevant stakeholders," he said, noting that past filing records provide "ample examples" of lobbyists facilitating contacts with US administration leaders and personnel.

The lobbying firm SHW Partners LLC, led by President Donald Trump's aide Jason Miller, said in its latest disclosures under FARA that it arranged eight calls between senior White House officials and the Centre in May-June this year to discuss bilateral relations. India signed SHW Partners in April 2025 and the contract was renewed for a year in April 2026 and terminated in June after Miller joined the Trump administration.

Jaiswal responded to another question on criticism of religious freedoms in India by senior officials of the US Commission on International Religious Freedom (USCIRF) by describing the body as a "prejudiced entity". "It is particularly telling that the USCIRF and its commissioners have consistently chosen to remain silent on attacks on religious places in the US and on hate crimes and racial abuse targeted at the Indian community in the US," he said.

GOVT HITS OUT AT CHINESE VLOGGERS USING B'DESH CLIPS TO DEFAME INDIA

NEW DELHI: New Delhi reacted strongly on Tuesday to reports of Chinese influencers filming videos in Bangladesh and passing them off as depictions of India, calling on authorities in Beijing and Dhaka to take action against those involved in presenting a "distorted picture" of the country.

Reports in the Bangladesh media said scores of Chinese vloggers and influencers were involved in a campaign of shooting videos in the impoverished neighbourhoods of Uttara and Tekpara in Dhaka and passing off their broadcasts as originating in New Delhi.

"Such efforts to present a distorted picture of any country are unfortunate," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

People familiar with the matter said that there has been a surge in anti-India content on China-based platforms such as WeChat and Douyin (TikTok) recently, coinciding with a large number of Chinese influencers seeking Indian visas in Beijing, with most applications rejected, they said. REZAUL H LASKAR

Juvenile board to assess if daughter of B'luru mass murder accused can be tried as adult

BENGALURU: A 17-year-old girl accused of helping her father to kill her mother and six relatives could be tried as an adult if the Juvenile Justice Board determines that she meets the criteria under the Juvenile Justice Act, 2015, a senior police officer probing the case said on Tuesday. "Investigators are probing claims by her father that she helped bring relatives to the house, hide the killings and transport and dispose of the bodies," said the senior officer.

Woman, 4 teen girls drown during visit to lake in TN: Police

CHENNAI: A 29-year-old caretaker employed at a state-run Children's Home for Girls in Tamil Nadu's Tiruvannamalai and four girls living at the home drowned late on Monday, police said, adding that the minor victims included three sisters aged between 13 and 16 and another girl aged 16.

Officers familiar with the matter said the victims were unaware of the lake's depth, which had increased due to heavy recent rainfall in the area.

Keralam's 'best young farmer' in '22 held in drugs case

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: A 31-year-old man judged the "best young farmer" by the state-run Krishi Bhavan in Keralam in 2022 was arrested late on Monday for allegedly smuggling synthetic drugs into the state from neighbouring Karnataka by hiding them inside banana bunches, police said on Tuesday.

The accused, identified as Dhanesh S Nair, was booked under non-bailable sections of the NDPS Act and remanded to judicial custody, said officers.

MEA: Engaged with Russia, Ukraine over food corridor

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India has exchanged ideas with Russia and Ukraine on opening "food corridors" to facilitate grain exports from Black Sea ports as part of a broader ceasefire proposal and is working with other stakeholders for the return of peace in the region, the external affairs ministry said on Tuesday.

During a phone conversation with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday, Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky suggested that India can take the lead in ensuring uninterrupted food supplies through the Black Sea by mediating the establishment of food corridors. The conversation was followed by a phone call between external affairs minister S Jaishankar and his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal reiterated India's three-part ceasefire proposal focused on the safety of commercial shipping in the Black Sea, energy and grain exports and stopping attacks on infrastructure, and told a regular media briefing that the Indian side has formally taken up the issue of food corridors with Russia and Ukraine.

"On the issue of food corridors, we have exchanged ideas with both sides. India remains in touch with both sides, as well as with interested parties, to contribute towards the return of peace to the region," he said.

Jaiswal's remarks marked the first acknowledgement from the Indian side about the work on food corridors. The move is also in line with India's efforts to protect the interests of the countries of the Global South, which have been hit by food, fuel and fertiliser shortages since the start of the Russia-Ukraine conflict in February 2022.

"India has been emphasising that the way forward is to take the path of dialogue and diplomacy," Jaiswal said. "In keeping with this idea of bringing peace to the region, India has been engaged with both Russia and Ukraine and we have conveyed certain ideas to them."

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** Approx 40-45 Years, **Height:** 5'6", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Brown, **Face:** Oval, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Sky colour T-Shirt and Grey colour Lower, was found in an injured & unconscious condition at Yudhister Setu, Kashmere Gate way to Shastri Park, Delhi due to an accident and was admitted in Truma Center, Civil Line, Delhi on 28.10.2026. In this regard **FIR No. 482/26 U/s 281/125(a), Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated 29.10.2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Kashmere Gate, Delhi.**
Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870123, 9868479170

DP/16147/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found whose Left Leg only on 04.11.2026, from Railway Yard Sadar Side New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 53A, Dated 04.11.2026, U/S 194 Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023** has been lodged at **Police Station New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:
Sex: Male. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in LHMC Hospital Mortuary, Delhi for identification.
If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station
New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi-55
Ph.: 8750871305, 9868743837

DP/16160/RLY/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

unknown

The general public is hereby informed that a Male whose name, family and residence is **unknown**, whose age was about 50 years was found dead at Gate No. 2 near Old Anaj Mandi Park. In this regard, an information has been lodged vide **DD No. 38A Dated 06.11.2026 at PS Narela, Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to identify the deceased person, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the UIDB is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 50 Years, **Height:** 5'5" ft, **Complexion:** Shallow, **Wearing:** Black T-Shirt & Blue Lower. If anyone has any information about his relatives, kindly inform the SHO/ Narela, Delhi.

SHO
PS, Narela, Delhi
Ph. No. 9818330644

DP/16211/ON/2026

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** Approx 55-60 Years, **Height:** 5'8", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Maroon colour Check Shirt, was found dead in front of Shop No. 518, near Lahori Gate Chowk, Delhi-110006 on 07.11.2026. In this regard **DD No. 17A, Dated 07.11.2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Lahori Gate, Delhi.**
Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Lahori Gate, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870122, 8816080048

DP/16229/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found dead on 03.11.2026 From E-Block Park, New Seemapuri, Delhi.** In this regard **DD No. 100A/75A, Dated: 03.11.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Seemapuri, Delhi.** Physical Description of unidentified male dead body is as under:
Name: Unknown, Age: About 55 Years, Height: 5'6", Complexion: Fair, Face: Long, Built: Thin, ID Mark: A Black Mole on Left Eyebrow, Wearing: Black & White Colour Sweater, White Colour Shirt and Black & White Colour Lower.
If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Seemapuri, Delhi
Ph.: 8750919540, 7065036030

DP/16240/SHD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified male (depicted in the photo) **Name Unknown S/o** Unknown, **R/o** Unknown, Age Approx 50-55 Years. He was Found Dead Near 2189, Gaushala Yamuna Bazar Kashmere Gate, Delhi. In this regard a **DD No. 82A, Dt. 25.09.2026**. has been lodged at **P.S. Kahmere Gate, Delhi**. His physical description is as under.

Sex: Male, **Age:** Approx 50-55 Years **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Wearing:** Grey Colour Half Check Shirt. Any person is having information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address and telephone number:-

S.H.O
PS: Kahmere Gate, Delhi
Ph No.: 7891715794, 8750870123

DP/16198/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male Namely Suresh **S/o** Ramesh, **R/o** N-1118, Sec-5, Bawana Factory **Age:** About 40 years, **Height:** 5'2", **Complexion:** Fair, **Wearing:** Cream Coloured Shirt and Brown Coloured Trouser was found Unconscious on 01.11.2026 at 10:15 PM from N-1118, Sec-5, Bawana Factory & was admitted in SRHC Hospital Vide CR No. 196932/2026. In this regard a **DD No. 161A Dated 01.11.2026** has been lodged at P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi.

If any one having any clue about deceased male may kindly inform the undersigned and contact on following numbers.

SHO
P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi
Ph.: 011-27787593
Mob.: 7065036324

DP/16247/ON/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

unknown

The general public is hereby informed that a Male whose name, family and residence is **unknown,** whose age was about 40 years was found near RK Ashram Metro Station, New Delhi. The Unknown Person was shifted to Lady Harding Medical College & later he was admitted to Smt. Kriplani Hospital, New Delhi, where he died during the treatment. The Dead Body of the Deceased Person has been Preserved at LHMC & SSK Hospital for 72 hours. In this regard, an information has been lodged vide **DD No. 60A Dated 30.10.2026 at PS Mandir Marg, New Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to identify the deceased person, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the UIDB is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 40 Years, **Height:** 5'5" ft, **Complexion:** Shallow, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Long, **Hair and Beard:** Black, **Wearing:** Brown Color Trousers, **Identification:** Black Mole present over right side of sternum. If anyone has any information about his relatives, kindly inform the SHO/ Mandir Marg, New Delhi.

SHO
PS, Mandir Marg, New Delhi
Ph. No. 8750870522,
011-23364100, 9911988909

DP/16226/NDD/2026

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male person **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 35-40 Yrs. **Height:** 5'4", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Fair **Wearing:** Light Yellow Shirt & Blue Jeans **Place of Recovery:** Infront of Yes Bank, Chandni Chowk, Delhi The dead body has been preserved in Subzi Mandi Hospital Mortuary Delhi, for identification.

In this regard **DD No. 109A Dated: 28/09/2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Kotwali, Delhi** Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Kotwali, Delhi
Phone: 9958179697

DP/16306/N/2026

UNIDENTIFIED BOY FOUND

General public is hereby informed that a boy namely **Unknown, S/o Unknown, R/o Unknown has found on 22.10.2026 at Outside James Church, Kashmere Gate Delhi** In this regard **DD No. 101A, Dated 22.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station Kashmere Gate, Delhi. Details of the found boy is as under:
Name: Unknown, Age: 2 Years, Height: 3', Complexion: Wheatish, Wearing: Red Mehroon T-shirt and Beige Color Pant.
If anyone have any information or clue about this found boy the same may kindly be inform to the undersigned.
Web: http://cbi.nic.in, E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Kashmere Gate, Delhi
Ph: 8750870123, 9001117642

DP/16204/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that this Person **Named:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** Approx. 32-35 years, **Sex:** Male, **Height:** 5'6", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Wearing:** Black colour T-shirt and Black colour Pajama, **Place of Recovery:** He was found unconscious condition at near JPC Hospital Delhi on Date : 04.11.2026 and he admitted in Hospital, during the treatment Dr. declared brought him dead. In this regard **DD No. 170A, Dated: 04.11.2026,** has been registered at P.S.: New Usmanpur, Delhi.
Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.: New Usmanpur, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870722, 9625358257

DP/16269/NE/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 08.11.2026, from KM Pole No. 1518/19, TKD Junction Cabin UP Main Line, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 08A, Dated 08.11.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station, Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:
Sex: Male, **Age:** 22-25 Yrs, **Height:** 5'4", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Wearing:** Brown Sweator, Black Jeans Pant. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Subzi Mandi Mortuary, Delhi for identification.
If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station
Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station, Delhi
Ph.: 9910538490, 7303708714

DP/16296/RLY/2026

MCC also applies to retired govt servants engaged by states: ECI

Himanshi Dahiya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Restrictions under the model code of conduct for government servants are applicable to retired officials engaged by state governments, the Election Commission said.

In a November 9 letter to the chief secretaries of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, which are due to hold Assembly elections in 2027, the ECI said while there were no specific guidelines for retired employees regarding political neutrality and conduct, the restrictions and prohibitions applicable to government servants "shall similarly apply" to them.

"The Commission hereby directs that restrictions and prohibitions applicable to government servants shall similarly apply to individuals including retired government officials/officers/employees attached or engaged or employed or re-employed in various capacities by State/UT Governments, for whom there are no specific guidelines or rules relating to their political neutrality and conduct during MCC period," the letter stated.

The restrictions bar such individuals from participating in election campaigns or canvassing and require them to maintain political neutrality. They also cannot summon any election-related officer of a constituency or district where polls have been announced for official discussions, meetings or video conferences.

Any act of omission or commission contrary to the directions "shall be viewed seriously", the Commission warned.

A senior ECI official told HT that the decision followed internal deliberations.

"We noticed that several of these officials keep working with state governments even after retirement. Every election we used to receive complaints regarding their conduct. Hence, this time we decided to extend the curbs to them," the official said.

The letter referred to ECI instructions issued in 1984 and 1991, which state that government employees must not campaign or lend their names, official position or authority to help one party or candidate over another.

The provisions of the MCC apply to all organisations, committees, corporations/commissions, funded wholly or partially by the government, and their employees. The relevant Conduct Rules, in the states, prohibit government servants from taking part in political activities and elections, the letter said.

The ECI has previously restricted the role of re-employed officials. Its 2022 pre-poll instructions to the same five states said officials on extension of service or re-employed in various capacities, except those in the office of the chief electoral officer, would not be associated with election-related work. A similar clarification was issued in the Commission's January 2019 transfer guidelines.

The ban on summoning election officials was earlier framed around ministers. The ECI's FAQ states that no Union or state minister can summon an election-related officer for official discussions.

The issue of political neutrality of retired officials engaged by state governments has also been raised by political parties. Before the 2024 Lok Sabha elections in Haryana, a complaint was filed against Rajesh Kumar Khullar, a former IAS officer and the chief principal secretary to the chief minister, alleging "blatant violation" of ECI guidelines on re-employed officials. The state government defended his continuation as procedurally compliant.

More recently, ahead of the April 9 elections in Assam, opposition parties led by the Assam Congress questioned the legality of re-engaging a retired All India Service officer in a senior post with full administrative and financial powers, calling the appointment "political" and "invalid". An activist also approached the ECI, arguing that the re-engagement order was linked to the previous Cabinet and should not continue once the MCC came into force. Officials, however, argued that governance cannot be paralysed during elections.

The latest directive follows the Commission's October 27 order asking the five states to transfer election-linked officers. Officials posted in their home districts or who have served in a district for three years or more are to be transferred, with March 31, 2027, as the cut-off for Goa, Manipur, Punjab and Uttarakhand and May 31, 2027, for Uttar Pradesh.

EVMs, VVPATs in Pjb to undergo first level checking on Nov 12

CHANDIGARH: The first level checking (FLC) of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) and voter-verifiable paper audit trail (VVPAT) machines will commence in all districts of Punjab from November 12, Chief Electoral Officer Anindita Mitra said on Tuesday.

The Punjab assembly elections are due early next year.

The Punjab CEO said the first-level checking of EVMs and VVPATs is an essential process prescribed by the ECI to ensure that only fully functional and election-ready machines are used during the elections.

She said that as per the guidelines of the ECI, the checking of EVMs and VVPATs to be used in every general election and bye-election is conducted under the supervision of the District Election Officer by authorised engineers of Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL).

The CEO stated that only those EVMs and VVPATs which successfully pass the First Level Checking will be used in Vidhan Sabha elections. PTI

EC IN HC: REPORT ON ALLEGATIONS AGAINST AMRITPAL PARTY AWAITED

Shruti Kakkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) has informed the Delhi high court that it is awaiting a verification report on allegations concerning Waris Punjab De's alleged separatist links and past affiliations, including claims that it was founded by individuals detained under the National Security Act (NSA) for activities prejudicial to India's sovereignty, unity and territorial integrity.

Waris Punjab De, was founded by actor-activist Deep Sidhu in 2021 and is now being headed by jailed pro-Khalistan legislator Amritpal Singh.

In an affidavit, ECI stated that during the pendency of Akali Dal Waris Punjab De's petition to register it as a political party, it received sensitive information concerning these allegations on July 9. ECI further submitted that it forwarded the objections to the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Punjab on July 14, 2026, directing him to conduct a comprehensive background inquiry and submit a detailed verification report. The affidavit further stated that reminders had been sent to the Punjab CEO and the verification report was still awaited. It added, "The commission cannot be compelled by a writ of mandamus to bypass this inquiry..."

Sugar output increases but prices remain high

Pallavi Singhal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Sugar prices are refusing to budge from their record highs even though production has risen.

According to data released by the Indian Sugar and Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA), sugar production in India reached 1.285 million tonnes as of November 5, nearly four times the 320,000 tonnes produced during the corresponding period last year, as more mills began crushing operations earlier this season to increase availability during the festive period.

However, domestic sugar prices continued to remain elevated, with the average modal retail price at ₹60 per kg on Monday, up 36% from ₹44 per kg a year ago.

The average modal price was also higher than the ₹55 per kg recorded a month ago, according to data from the Department of Consumer Affairs (DOCA).

According to the ISMA release, 184 sugar mills had commenced crushing operations across the country as of November 5, compared with 154 mills during the same period last year. The higher early-season production has been driven largely by Maharashtra, where crushing operations began earlier than last year.

Sugar production in India reached 1.285 million tonnes as of November 5.

Maharashtra accounted for 1.078 million tonnes of sugar production, with 136 mills operational as of November 5, compared with 123,000 tonnes produced by 101 mills during the corresponding period last year.

In Uttar Pradesh, 19 mills have started crushing operations in western and central regions, producing 20,000 tonnes of sugar. Most of the remaining mills in western Uttar Pradesh are expected to begin operations over the next few days, while factories in central Uttar Pradesh are likely to start after Diwali.

In Karnataka, seven mills continuing operations from the special season have produced 90,000 tonnes of sugar. The state's main-season crushing is expected to begin shortly following the resolution of farmer-related issues. Seven mills in Tamil Nadu have produced 64,000 tonnes, while 12 mills in Gujarat and three in Telangana have also started operations.

ISMA Director General Deepak Ballani said the industry was in a comfortable position to meet domestic demand, with around 3.6 million tonnes of carryover stocks from the previous season and fresh production gathering pace. "The country is in a comfortable position to meet its domestic sugar requirements," Ballani said, adding that production would increase substantially in the coming weeks as more mills begin operations in Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka.

ISMA said the combination of carryover stocks and higher early-season production would ensure adequate supplies for domestic consumption.

However, the increase in production at the start of the season has not yet translated into lower retail prices. The average modal price of ₹60 per kg on Monday was ₹5 higher than a month ago and ₹16 higher than a year earlier, indicating that sugar prices remain elevated despite expectations of improved availability.

Akhilesh takes swipe at Yogi's '80-20' claim

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Tuesday turned Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath's '80-20' formulation against the BJP, saying it meant the BJP-led NDA would be capable of contesting a maximum of 80 seats in the 2027 assembly elections.

In a post on X, Akhilesh said that by '80-20', the chief minister meant that the BJP alliance would be able to contest only 80 seats, while the PDA alliance would prove superior to the NDA. "PDA gathbandhan NDA ke muqable bees sabit hoga," he said. The Hindi expression 'bees sabit hona' means to prove superior to someone.

The remark came weeks after Adityanath reiterated his '80 versus 20' formulation following the Rajya Sabha elections in October. He had said the results had set the tone for the 2027 assembly polls, adding that "the 80 versus 20 fight has returned. Eighty per cent is with the NDA, and 20 per cent with the PDA."

PDA, a term popularised by Akhilesh, stands for Pichhda (backward classes), Dalit and Alpsankhyak (minorities). The SP chief has projected the social coalition as the principal challenger to the BJP-led NDA in Uttar Pradesh.

Akhilesh also took a dig at the BJP government over the situation in Ayodhya ahead of his December 12 visit to the temple town, saying his party would restore the city's dignity and honour if voted to power in 2027.

Akhilesh Yadav

BJP dismissed Yadav's wordplay as a sign of nervousness and mathematical confusion.

Dinesh Pratap Singh, state BJP spokesperson, said, "Akhilesh Yadav has deliberately twisted a formulation about voter sentiment—80% for nationalism and development versus 20% for appeasement and mafia raj—into a seat-sharing joke because he has no answer on governance, SIR and Ayodhya."

Reiterating the CM's line, Singh said the 80-20 fight is not about how many seats the NDA will contest—the NDA will contest all 403 seats—but about how 80% of Uttar Pradesh stands with the NDA's politics of Ram, nationalism, security and development, while only 20%, represented by the PDA, stands for caste division, appeasement and criminal patronage.

U.P. LOSES OUT IN INSPIRE GRANT AS DST OVERHAULS ALLOTMENTS

Sanjay Maurya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A change in how the Union government allocates scholarships under its flagship INSPIRE-Scholarship for Higher Education (SHE) scheme has sharply reduced the number of awards available to school boards of several states, including Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan, while boosting quotas for students from other state and central education boards, according to official data for 2024 and 2025.

In 2025, the Department of Science and Technology (DST) introduced quotas by school education board based on the number of Class 12 examinees rather than the number of applications received from students of each board. This change led to a nearly 66% drop in the number of Uttar Pradesh Madhyamik Shiksha Parishad (UPMSP) students cleared for the science scholarship.

Anindita Bhadra, professor at IISER Kolkata, questioned the revised allocation model. "It is rather stupid to change the board-wise allocation. The earlier rule made sense, and was less biased. A state with a higher population is now likely to see more candidates with the fellowship, while more eligible students from other states will lose out," she said.

6 MONTHS OF TVK GOVT: OPPN HITS OUT AT VIJAY OVER LAW AND ORDER

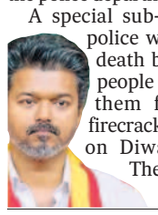
S Vijay Karthik
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHENNAI: The Opposition Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) on Tuesday slammed the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) over its alleged failure to ensure law and order in Tamil Nadu even as the C Joseph Vijay-led party completed six months in power in the southern state.

DMK legal wing secretary I Paranthanaman questioned the TVK government's record on public safety while mentioning the murder of a police sub-inspector on Diwali. Slamming chief minister Vijay, Paranthanaman told reporters, "Did you read the newspapers? We are getting information that neither the chief secretary M Sai Kumar nor the DGP Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal were able to reach you. Is this true?".

The AIADMK echoed DMK's allegations. It said, "Degenerate criminal behaviour is rising in society. It is incumbent upon the government to have a visible show of force, increase patrolling and random checks."

The TVK rejected attacks by the opposition as a planned bid to defame the party's government. Minister and TVK's deputy general secretary A Rajmohan said that it was only after the TVK assumed office that a ruling party has given full freedom to the police in maintaining law and order. "Only after the formation of the TVK government, an administration has been established that places no pressure on the police department," he said.


A special sub-inspector of police was beaten to death by a group of people for rebuking them for bursting firecrackers on a road on Diwali night in Theni district.

Golden hues at Nishat Mughal Garden

A tourist walks through Nishat Mughal Garden as autumn colours adorn the surrounding Chinar trees on the outskirts of Srinagar on Tuesday. Several people flock the garden to enjoy the scenic golden-yellow view during this time of the year. WASEEM ANDRABI/HT

President's guard shot during Diwali clash with neighbours over crackers in Baghpat

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW: A security personnel posted at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in Delhi, who had returned home to Baghpat in Uttar Pradesh for Diwali holidays, was shot in the head and injured during an altercation with a neighbour over bursting firecrackers, police said on Tuesday.

Baghpat superintendent of police (SP) Purnendu Singh said the bullet hit a wall before striking the personnel, reducing its impact. Doctors have removed the bullet, and he is now stable, Singh added.

The injured personnel, identified as Saurabh Kumar, is part of the specialised service responsible for the President's security at Rashtrapati Bhavan, the SP said. The elite President's Bodyguard was raised in 1773 and is one of the army's oldest regiments.

According to a complaint lodged by their father, Janak Raj, at Ramala police station, the incident took place around 9pm on Diwali day (November 8) in Gopalpur Khadana village. Kumar was bursting firecrackers outside his house with his brothers Vineet and Mintu when Dheeraj, who lives 100 metres away, allegedly arrived and began abusing them.

"An argument broke out when Dheeraj objected to Kumar's family bursting crackers. Although some villagers intervened and initially pacified both sides, the dispute escalated again when Saurabh protested," the complaint alleged.

Dheeraj allegedly opened fire with a country-made pistol, and the bullet hit a wall before striking Saurabh in the head. The accused's brother Monu, alias Praveen, allegedly attacked Vineet with a stick. The accused fled after threatening the family, according to the complaint.

Police booked Dheeraj and Monu on the basis of Raj's complaint. The family alleged that the accused had a longstanding enmity with them, the SP said.

Ramala station house officer Rakesh Kumar Sharma said three police teams had been formed to arrest the accused. Police personnel have also been deployed in the village to maintain law and order. SP Purnendu Singh directed the teams to ensure their early arrest.

THE BULLET HIT A WALL BEFORE STRIKING THE PERSONNEL, REDUCING ITS IMPACT, SAID SP PURNENDU SINGH

CISCE Class 10 boards from Feb 15; Class 12 from Feb 9

Sanjay Maurya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations (CISCE) on Tuesday announced the timetable for its 2027 board examinations, with Indian Certificate of Secondary Education (ICSE) (Class 10) exams scheduled to begin on February 15 and the Indian School Certificate (ISC) (Class 12) exams on February 9.

The Class 10 examinations will conclude on March 31, while Class 12 examinations will continue till April 8, according to the detailed schedules issued by the council on November 10. The results of both examinations are expected to be declared in April or May 2027.

A significant change in this year's schedule concerns the starting time of ICSE examinations. The writing time for most papers has been advanced by 45 minutes compared with the 2026 examination schedule. The reading time, which earlier began at 10.45 am, will now start at 10 am, with writing scheduled to begin at 10.15 am instead of 11am, and candidates must be seated in the examination hall by 9.45 am.

For ICSE students, English Language (English Paper 1) will be the first examination on February 15 at 10.15 am. This will be followed by Art Paper 4 (Applied Art) on February 16 at 9 am and Literature in English (English Paper 2) on February 18 at 10.15 am.

For ISC students, the examinations will begin on February 9 with Environmental Science and Western Music Paper 1 (Theory), both scheduled for 2 pm. English Paper 1 (English Language) will be held on February 10.

The Mathematics examination is scheduled for March 1, while Chemistry Paper 1 (Theory) will be held on February 24.

India, US vow to combat illicit drugs trade amid crackdowns

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The top officials of India's Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) and the United States Office of National Drug Control Policy (ONDCP) met in New Delhi on November 2 and 3 to strengthen bilateral counter narcotics cooperation, joint intelligence sharing and coordinated action. Both sides on Tuesday issued press statements confirming the development.

The meeting was held in the backdrop of Indian and US drug law enforcement agencies conducting joint crackdowns in India and the US to bust members of the same cartel operating in the two countries and across different continents.

The Indian delegation was led by Anurag Garg, NCB director general, and the US delegation was headed by Debbie Seguin, ONDCP acting deputy director.

"Pursuant to the terms of reference of the India-US Drug Policy Framework, the meeting reviewed bilateral cooperation in combatting illicit drug trafficking and identified priority areas for strengthening intelligence sharing, coordinated law enforcement action, precursor control, pharmaceutical supply chain integrity and drug demand reduction," NCB stated.

Garg spoke about India outlining a three year roadmap which outlines a comprehensive strategy to combat the illicit narcotics trade, emphasising network-centric investigations, precursor control, financial investigations, prevention and rehabilitation.

ONDCP director Sara Carter, US Drug Czar, said in a statement, "The Executive Working Group and bilateral cooperation between the United States and India is vital to disrupting transnational drug trafficking networks and preventing the diversion of synthetic drugs and chemical precursors into global markets."

'38.6mn Indians living with undiagnosed diabetes'

Rhythma Kaul
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Around 38.6 million adults in India are living with undiagnosed diabetes, which is 43% of the 89.8 million adults living with the condition, according to a new survey commissioned by the International Diabetes Federation.

Yet, the survey results showed that many adults in India who are at increased risk of type 2 diabetes underestimate the risk of their condition and are unsure how to access testing services.

Released ahead of World Diabetes Day on November 14, the research by the International Diabetes Federation surveyed 502 adults, aged between 25-64, in India as part of a six-country study. It reveals a clear gap between belief in checks and personal risk. While 84% agreed that a diabetes risk check is worthwhile even when they feel healthy, only 14% believed they were likely to develop type 2 diabetes, even though almost every respondent reported at least two known risk factors. Three in four (75%) incorrectly believed that people with pre-diabetes — when blood glucose levels are higher than normal, but not high enough to be diagnosed as type 2 diabetes — usually experience noticeable symptoms, the highest misconception from all six countries.

Nearly half (48%) of the total 502 people said they would not feel confident arranging a diabetes risk check, the highest share of the six countries surveyed. Fear of what the results might show (35%) was the most cited barrier, followed by not thinking they were at risk (25%) and difficulty getting a clinic appointment (22%). Practical and emotional barriers sit side by side: 18% cited embarrassment about discussing a check with a clinician and 12% cited language or communication difficulties.

Survey released ahead of World Diabetes Day on November 14. SHUTTERSTOCK

"India cannot close a diagnosis gap of this size by waiting for people to come forward. For many people at risk, a check means facing their fear of the result and, for some, an uncomfortable conversation with a doctor. We need to make getting checked feel ordinary, through community campaigns, local pharmacies, evening and weekend clinics and information in people's own languages, so that a diagnosis becomes the start of care rather than something to dread," said Dr Banshi Saboo, chair of the IDF South-East Asia Region.

IDF's diagnosis scorecard for India, based on data from the IDF Diabetes Atlas 11th edition, shows that 57% of adults with diabetes in India have received a diagnosis, against the World Health Organization's (WHO) global target of 80% by 2030. Reaching that level would require around 20.7 million additional diagnoses, equivalent to roughly 13,700 every day until the end of 2030.

The online survey was conducted by Global Health Strategies form late June to late July 2026 in India, Brazil, Kenya, Saudi Arabia, Spain, and the United States, all with known type 2 diabetes risk factors and no diagnosis.

3 killed in TN while cleaning wastewater treatment tank

HTC and PTI
letters@hindustantimes.com

KRISHNAGIRI DISTT COLLECTOR CONFIRMED THAT ASPHYXIATION DURING SLUDGE REMOVAL WAS PRIMARY CAUSE OF THE DEATH

CHENNAI: Three contract workers died of suffocation while desilting an effluent treatment plant (ETP) operated by Nalco Water at a Tata Electronics factory in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, which makes components for Apple iPhones, police said on Tuesday.

The three who died in the incident on Monday night were identified as Kaveri (30) of Hosur and B Akmal (28) and M Sarathi Kumar (28), both from Dharmapuri district. All three workers were engaged by a sub-contractor of Nalco Water.

According to the police, one worker collapsed while peering into a storage tank; the other collapsed while checking on him. A fourth worker who witnessed the incident alerted staff at the facility. Rescuers pulled all three from the tank and rushed them to a private hospital in Hosur, where doctors declared them dead on arrival, an officer said, adding that the bodies were transferred to the Government Medical College Hospital in Krishnagiri for post-mortem examinations.

Krishnagiri district collector C Dinesh Kumar confirmed that asphyxiation during sludge removal was the primary cause of death. The Tamil Nadu government said it will investigate the incident and take appropriate action. "Deeply saddened by the tragic loss of three precious lives at Tata Electronics' facility near Hosur," minister for industries S Keerthana said in a post on X, extending condolences to the bereaved families. "The safety and dignity of every worker must remain paramount. This tragic incident will be thoroughly investigated, and appropriate action will be taken based on the findings."

There was no official statement from Tata Electronics or Apple till going to print.

In a statement, Nalco Water said the deceased were engaged by one of its sub-contractors and that it is working with local authorities in the probe.

"We are deeply saddened by the tragic incident that resulted in the deaths of three workers engaged by a sub-contractor of Nalco Water, an Ecolab company, at the Tata Electronics site in Hosur, India," the statement said.

{ RAMPUR }

2007 CRPF camp terror attack case accused shot dead in UP

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

8 CRPF PERSONNEL HAD DIED AND FIVE WERE INJURED IN THE ATTACK ON THEIR CAMP IN RAMPUR ON THE NIGHT OF DECEMBER 31, 2007

LUCKNOW: Mohammad Sharif, one of the accused in the 2007 attack on the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) Group Centre in Rampur whose death penalty was set aside by the Allahabad High Court, was shot dead by two unidentified motorcycle-borne assailants near Khajuria police station on Tuesday, officials aware of the matter said.

According to police, Sharif was returning home with his son on a two-wheeler after marking his attendance at the police station when the assailants intercepted them barely 20 metres from the police station around 7pm. They said, one of them allegedly shot him in the temple before both fled.

His son collapsed in shock after witnessing the attack.

Sharif was rushed to a nearby hospital, where he succumbed to his injuries during treatment, officials said.

Rampur police, in a post on X, said inquest proceedings and other legal formalities are underway in the matter.

Sharif was among five accused sentenced by a Rampur court in 2019 for the attack, which left seven CRPF personnel and an unidentified rickshaw puller dead. He and three others — Sabauddin, Imran Shahzad and Mohammad Farooq — were awarded the death penalty, while Jang Bahadur Khan was sentenced to life imprisonment.

However, the Allahabad high court, in October 2025, acquitted all five of the principal charges, citing serious shortcomings in the investigation, including lapses in the handling of evidence and inconsistencies in witness accounts. It held that the prosecution had failed to establish the charges beyond reasonable doubt.

The high court, however, upheld their convictions under the Arms Act and sentenced them to 10 years' imprisonment. After adjusting the period already spent in jail against his sentence, Sharif was released in November 2025.

The Uttar Pradesh government challenged the high court's verdict in the Supreme Court, which issued notices to the accused on February 11, 2026. The state's appeal was pending in the top court when Sharif was killed.

The attack took place on the intervening night of December 31, 2007 and January 1, 2008, when armed assailants stormed the CRPF Group Centre in Rampur, killing seven personnel and a civilian.

30001/145/2627

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001,Odisha
CIN:U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in

OMC ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

E-auction Notice (20.11.2026 — 221st & 222nd E-auction)
IRON ORE CLO & FINES

The Odisha Mining Corporation Ltd intends to sell various grades of Iron ore CLO & Fines produced at Daitari and Gandhamardan Iron Ore Mining Lease and Guali, Jilling Langalota, Tiringpahar, Khandbandh, Banspani, Unchabali (Mahaparbat), Roida 'C' & Dubuna - Sekradihi Iron and Manganese Mines of Barbil Region in Keonjhar District and Khandadhar/Kurmitar Mines under Koira Region in Sundargarh District, Odisha through e-auction which will be conducted by MSTC Ltd. The e-auction shall be held from **11.00A.M to 2.00 P.M on 20.11.2026**

"Traders are not allowed to participate in National e-Auction of Iron Ore CLO and Fines w.e.f. April, 2026 onwards."

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Chief General Manager (S&M)
OIPR - 30001/30005/1/26-27/0111

आर.सी.वी.पी.नरोन्हा प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधकीय अकादमी
1100 क्वाटर्स, अरेरा कालोनी, भोपाल (म.प्र.)
दूरभाष क्रं. 0755-2445058, 0755-2445299

अकादमी मैस केटरिंग कार्य हेतु निविदा विज्ञप्ति

क्रमांक /11413/अका/छात्रावास/मैस/2026 **भोपाल, दिनांक: 05.11.2026**

आर.सी.वी.पी. नरोन्हा प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधकीय अकादमी, 1100 क्वाटर्स अरेरा कालोनी, भोपाल (म.प्र.) स्थित अकादमी छात्रावास क्रमांक 01 एवं 02 व गेस्ट हाउस में मैस केटरिंग कार्य हेतु GeM Portal आगामी दो वर्ष 2026-2028 की अवधि के लिये निविदा प्रस्ताव **https://gem.gov.in/ पर Bid Number: GEM/2026/B/8237982 के द्वारा दिनांक 25/11/2026 को सायं 16.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित किये जाते है। निविदा की समस्त शर्तों एवं अन्य विस्तृत विवरण** GeM Portal पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा सूचना में कोई भी संशोधन समाचार पत्र में न दिया जाकर GeM Portal की वेबसाइट पर ही जारी किया जाएगा।

मैस केटरिंग कार्य हेतु निविदा प्रपत्र केवल अवलोकन हेतु अकादमी की वेबसाईट **www.academy.mp.gov.in** पर भी उपलब्ध कराया गया है।

प्रभारी अधिकारी (छात्रा./मैस)
आर.सी.वी.पी. नरोन्हा प्रशासन अकादमी
मध्यप्रदेश, भोपाल

कृते/- संचालक
आर.सी.वी.पी. नरोन्हा प्रशासन अकादमी
मध्यप्रदेश, भोपाल

G-21243/26

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB PANCHKULA	ENGAGEMENT OF TECHNICAL AGENCY FOR END TO END SYSTEM REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS, SYSTEM DESIGN, DEVELOPMENT, IMPLEMENTATION, INTEGRATION, TESTING, DEPLOYMENT, TRAINING, MAINTENANCE AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT FOR DEVELOPING INTEGRATED MARKET DIGITALIZATION AND MARKET INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM A STATE LEVEL CENTRALISED ONLINE PLATFORM FOR HSAMB, COVERING GATE ENTRY, WEIGHMENT & QUALITY, AUCTION & SALE, STATUTORY FORMS, BAGGING, DISPATCH & EXIT GATE PASS, SETTLEMENT & CLOSURE, PORTALS, DASHBOARDS, ANALYTICS, MOBILE APPLICATIONS AND INTEGRATION WITH THREE CENTRAL OPERATIONS AND MANAGEMENT CENTRES (COCS) AT HSAMB HEADQUARTERS, FOR A PERIOD OF THREE (03) YEARS. INCLUDING HANDING OVER & TECHNOLOGY TRANSFER, WITH ALL DEFECTS IN THE PLATFORM TO BE RECTIFIED BY THE AGENCY AT ITS OWN COST DURING THE ENGAGEMENT PERIOD	CLOSING DATE 25.11.2026	EMD 1,50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8646850000 officecmeo2026@gmail.com

RO NO 13/2027/100/50893/I/19/7 **FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH UV DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,65,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH PDA DETECTOR, FLUORESCENCE AND RI DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	75,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF DISSOLUTION MACHINE AUTOSAMPLER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	15,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
4	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ELECTRICAL AUTOPSY SAW STAND WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	22,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
5	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF AUTO REFRACTOMETER WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	4,38,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
6	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ND YAG LASER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,05,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

RO NO. 13/2027/120/50888/I/19/7 **FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW ROAD FROM VILLAGE BHIDUKI TO VILLAGE BHAINDOLI RD 0.00 TO 2.30 KM HAVING CONSOLIDATION PATH MORE THAN 6 KARAM UNDER HODAL CONSTITUTION IN PALWAL DISTT. (WITHOUT GST)	07.11.2026 16.11.2026	237.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	CONTROLLER, PRINTING & STATIONERY, DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	PURCHASE OF DELUXE DIARY, POCKET DIARY, VISITING CARD CASE & ORDINARY DIARY FOR THE YEAR 2027.	CLOSING DATE 07.12.2026	65 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9872020766 opbranch06@gmail.com
3	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (CAP. NITROFURANTOIN 100MG, TAB. RANITIDINE 150MG, SYP. ZINC 60ML ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	16.11.2026 23.11.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
4	ZILA PARISHAD, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF COMMUNITY CENTER DHAMMAR + 1 WORKS	05.11.2026 12.11.2026	51.53 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01262254150 prexeeng.roh@hry.nic.in
5	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF THE MATERIAL FOR REPAIR OF 325 HP & 200 HP ATS STARTER AT PUMP HOUSE NO. 3 OF LOHARU CANAL UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 1, CHARKHI DADRI & 10 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 20.11.2026	10.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	MANDI DABWALI STP:- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 16.50 MLD STP MANDI DABWALI DISTT. SIRSA. CH. TO:- MANDI DABWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/ UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT`S AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 16.50 MLD STP AT DABWALI TOWN DISTT. SIRSA	06.11.2026 25.11.2026	149.58 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
7	DIRECTORATE OF STATE TRANSPORT HARYANA, CHANDIGARH	SHORT TERM TENDER NOTICE FOR PROCUREMENT OF NEW STEEL RADIAL TUBELESS TYRE OF SIZE 295/80R22.5-16PR, NEW NYLON TYRE SETS OF SIZE 7.50X16-16PR WITH TUBE AND FLAP AND NEW STEEL RADIAL TYRE SET OF SIZE 10.00R20-16PR WITH TUBE & FLAP FOR MEETING REQUIREMENT FOR THE BUSES OF HARYANA ROADWAYS FOR NEXT ONE YEAR.	11.11.2026 25.11.2026	29.52 CRORE	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709809 dtcstore22@gmail.com

RO NO 11/2027/140/50914/I/19/7 **FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.etenders.hry.nic.in**

SEARCH FOR MISSING FEMALE

Ruchi Kumari

General Public is hereby informed that one female (depicted in the photo) namely Ruchi Kumari **W/o** Deepak Kumar **R/o** H.No. A-117, Holi Chowk, Village Khichripur, Delhi **Aged**-24 Years has been reported missing since 02.11.2026 at about 6:30 PM from her residence vide **FIR No.526/2026 Dated 03.11.2026 u/s 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita** registered at Police Station Kalyanpuri, Delhi. Her physical description is as under:-

Complexion: Shallow, **Height:** About 5'2", **Face:** Round, **Built:** Medium, **Clothing:** Green Coloured Saree, Light Green Coloured Blouse and Chocolate Coloured Ladies Slipper in feet.

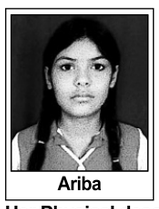
If anyone gets any information or clue about the missing female, please contact the below mentioned :-

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 24368639
Tel.: 24368638/24368641

SHO, Kalyanpuri, Delhi
Tel.: 011-22772251, 22772287
8750871830

DP/16054/ED/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING


Ariba

General public is hereby informed that one girl (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Ariba, D/o. Md. Salim, R/o: H. No.K/272, Gali No.19, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110080** has been Missing/ Kidnapped from her house since **08.11.2026** around **9.00 P.M.** In this regard a missing report case vide **FIR No.459/2026 dated 09.11.2026 U/S 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,2023** has been lodged at **P.S. Sangam Vihar, South District, New Delhi.**

Her Physical description is as under:-

Sex: Female, **Age:** 11 Years, **Height:** 4' 5", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** Green T-Shirt, Black Dupatta, Light Green Color Trouser and Pink Color Slippers on her foot.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing female but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone having any information about this female please inform to the following.

Phone No. : 011-24368638, 011-24368641 | **Fax no. :** 011-24368639

Email id : cic@cbi.nic.in | **Website :** http://cbi.nic.in

SHO
P.S – Sangam Vihar, New Delhi
Phone : 6205973736, 8750870833 & 7065569303

DP/16278/SD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Shivanshi

General Public is hereby informed that one girl namely **Shivanshi D/o Sarvesh R/o** Uday ka Makan, Village Singhu, Alipur, Delhi has been missing from her house since 05.11.2026 at 02:00 PM. In this regard a case vides **FIR No. 645/26** Dated **05.11.2026** has been registered at PS. Alipur, Delhi. The description of missing girl is as under:

Name : Shivanshi, **Father's Name** : Sarvesh, **Age** : 13 years, **Height** : 5', **Face:** Round, **Built:** Medium, **Complexion** : Fair, **Wearing** : Black Color Suit & Salwar and Chappal in feet.

If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
e-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax : 011-24368639
Ph. : 011-24368638, 24386641
DP/16223/ON/2026

SHO
P.S., Alipur, Delhi
Ph.: 011-27202290
27202256, 7065036325

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: https://ujvnl.uk.gov.in

Letter No: 1067 **e-Tender Notice** Date: 09/11/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G), Sharda Power House, Lohiahead, Khatima invites sealed tenders from interested Firms. Brief summary of tenders is given below:

Tender No.: 17/EE(M&G)/SPH/2026-27

Name of work/supply/Service- "Major maintenance of Generating Unit no. #1 of Sharda Power House, Lohiahead, Khatima" as per technical specifications.

Estimated cost - Rs. 6,90,75,000/- (Rs. Six CroreNinety Lacs Seventy Five Thousand only) plus GST extra as applicable.

Date of availabilityof bid document on website- 12/11/2026 (From 16:00 Hrs)

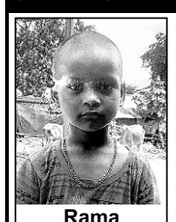
Last date for submission of tender on website- 03/12/2026 (Up to 16:00 Hrs)

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website e-procurement portal **"https://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (M&G)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED


Rama

General Public is hereby informed that one person namely **Rama S/o Vikram Mahldar R/o** Rohit Doctor Ka Makan Holambi Kalan, Delhi has been missing/kidnapped since 05.11.2026 at 11:00 AM from Delhi. In this regard a case vides **FIR No. 635** Dated **09.11.2026 U/s 137(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023** has been registered at PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi. The description of missing person is as under : **Age** : 07 years, **Height** : 4'5", **Built:** Thin, **Face** : Round, **Complexion** : Shallow, **Wearing** : Black Pant and Shirt

If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
e-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax : 011-24368639
Ph. : 011-24368638, 24368641
DP/16286/ON/2026

SHO
P.S., Narela Industrial Area, Delhi
Ph.: 011-27787593, 7065036324

ABANDONED CHILD FOUND

Vakeel

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Boy (depicted in the photo) namely **Vakeel S/o** Salamu **R/o** Unknown, **Age**-12 Yrs, was found Roaming on 14.10.2026 in area of Police Station Adarsh Nagar, Delhi. The Boy has been kept in CHB Alipur as per directions of CWC Alipur, Delhi on 14.10.2026. In this regard an **DD No. 09A, Dated 14.10.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Adarsh Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi.** His physical description is as under:

Sex: Male, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Height:** 4'5", **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Long, **Identification Mark:** Old Scar Mark Present Over Left Forehead Region, **Wearing:** Orange T-Shirt, Brown/Khakhi Pant and Slipper in his Feet.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the family of this boy found but no clue has come to light so far. Any person having information or clue about this boy found, may kindly inform to the following telephone numbers.

Website: https://cbi.nic.in
DP/16264/NW/2026

SHO,
Police Station Adarsh Nagar, North-West Distt., Delhi
Ph.: 8750870229, 8512892592

SEARCH FOR MISSING

General public is hereby informed that a Boy namely **Munna Kumar, S/o: Madan Mehto, R/o: H.No. 114, Gali No. 3/5, Ambika Vihar, karawal Nagar, North-East, Delhi has been missing since 05.11.2026 at about 08:00 AM from his home.** In this regard **FIR No. 317/2026, U/s: 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 05.11.2026,** has been registered at P.S. **Karawal Nagar, Delhi.** The description of missing Boy is as under:

Name: Munna Kumar, Age: 17 Years, Height: 5'3", Complexion: Wheatish, Face: Round, Built: Medium, ID Mark: A scar from an old injury on the forehead , Wearing: Blue Colour T- Shirt, Blue Colour Jeans Pant and White Colour Slippers in Feet. (Mentally Abnormal)

If anyone have any information about this missing Boy please inform P.S. **Karawal Nagar, Delhi.**

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, Email: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Karawal Nagar, Delhi
Ph: 8826408944, 9205832616

DP/16272/NE/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. PUJHS-DYCSTEJHS-3-2026 Date : 06.11.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

CSTE/P/Co acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites open e-Tenders from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability, for the following work on Single Packet System up to **11:00** Hrs. On the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. If date of opening is declared a holiday or offer could not be opened due to Technical issue, the offers shall be opened on the next working day. The details of the tender are as under:

E-Tender No. : PUJHS-DYCSTEJHS-3-2026
Name of Work : Reliability improvement by Provision of Dual Detection of Track circuit with Axle counter at MRA & RRU stations under Sr DSTE/ML/JHS
Estimated Cost of work : ₹ 83204221.55 Only
Earnest Money : ₹ 1664100.00 (Rs. Sixteen Lakhs Sixty Four Thousand One Hundred Only).
Tender Form Cost : NIL | **Completion Period :** 12 Months
Availability of tender form : Tender form shall be available on website, **www.ireps.gov.in**, 24 Days prior to date of opening of tender.
Pre-Bid meeting Date & Venue : NA
Closing Date/Time of tender : 30.11.2026 11:00 Hrs.
Tender Opening Date/Time : 30.11.2026 11:00 hrs.
Place of Opening : Through Online E-Portal **www.ireps.gov.in,** in the Office of Dy. CSTE/PU/JHS, DRM Office Campus, Jhansi
Validity of Offer : 60 Days from date of opening.
Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the right to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons.
Tenderers who wish to participate in tenders invited on **www.ireps.gov.in** have to register on the website mandatorily. Please refer to website for more details. Further particulars can be obtained from the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

2549/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

Prince

General Public is hereby informed that one person, **Namely: Prince S/o**: Surya Bhusan Singh, **R/o:** A-777 Gali No. 18, Kotla Vihar Phase-2 Delhi Ranhola Outer District, Delhi, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 28 Years, **Height:** 5.9Ft, **Built:** Thin, **Complexion:** Shallow, **ID-Mark:** Blade cut mark of right hand, **Wearing:** Dark Green Colour Shirt & Blue Colour Pant and Shoes in his feet, has been missing from Balaji Action Hospital, Paschim Vihar Delhi. Since 31.10.2026. In this regard a missing report, **FIR No. 329/26, U/s: 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita Dated: 01.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Paschim Vihar, East Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local Police to trace out the missing person, but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this the missing person, please inform to the following.

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641
DP/16140/SE/2026

SHO
PS: Paschim Vihar, East Delhi
Mob. 8700945250

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

Kapil Kohli

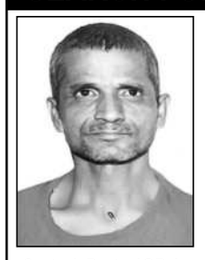
General public is hereby informed that a Male **Namely: Kapil Kohli S/o** Lt. Sudarshan Kumar Kohli **R/o** H.No. 343 Ground Floor, Indra Vihar, Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi has been missing/kidnapped from his home Since: 02.11.2026. In this regard a **FIR No. 450/2026, Dt. 02.11.2026, U/s: 140 (3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023,** has been registered at **PS:. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi**. The description of the missing Male as under.

Age: 45 Years, **Height:** 6'0" **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Normal, **Identification mark:** Red Mark Near Right Eye, **Wearing:** Orange Colour T-Shirt and Blue Colour Lower. Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace out him but no clue has come to light so far. Any person is having information or clue about this missing Male may kindly inform to the following.

Ph. No. 011-24368638, 24368641
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax No. 011-24368639
DP/16018/NW/2026

S.H.O
PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi
Ph: 8750878480, 8750870231

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED


Santosh Rastogi@Raju

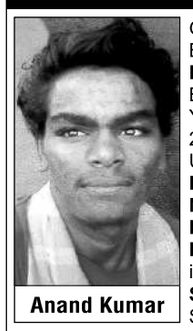
General Public is hereby informed that one person, **Namely: Santosh Rastogi@Raju S/o**: Shri Rame Narayan Rastogi, **R/o:** H.No. 387, Maharathi Colony Jwala Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 60 Years, **Height:** 5.4Ft, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Round, **Complexion:** Shallow, **ID-Mark:** The big toe on the left foot is missing, **Wearing:** Blue colour pajama & purple t-shirt and slipper in his feet, He is mentally ill and has been missing from his residence. Since 11.10.2026. In this regard a missing report, **FIR No. 475/26, U/s: 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita Dated: 03.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Vivek Vihar, Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local Police to trace out the missing person, but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this the missing person, please inform to the following.

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641
DP/16207/SHD/2026

SHO
PS: Vivek Vihar, Delhi
Mob. 7065036021

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED


Anand Kumar

General Public is hereby informed that one Boy (depicted in the photo) namely **Anand Kumar S/o** Kristo Yadav, **R/o** Purav Tola Bathuria, Distt.-Bhagalpur, Bihar, **Age**-17 Yrs, has been reported missing since 24.10.2026 from 4th Pusta New Usmanpur, Delhi, vide **FIR No. 696/2026, Dated 04.11.2026, U/S 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023,** registered at **Police Station New Usmanpur, North-East Distt., Delhi.** His physical description is as under:

Sex: Male, **Height:** 5'2", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Face:** Round with Marks, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Red T-Shirt, Red Half Pant.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing boy but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing boy please inform to the following.

Website: https://cbi.nic.in
DP/16202/NE/2026

SHO,
Police Station New Usmanpur, North-East Distt., Delhi
Ph.: 9958716998

HT Classifieds {Wednesday}

SCAN THE CODE TO BOOK YOUR ADS ONLINE→

www.htclassifieds.com

PROPERTY

SOUTH DELHI

DEFENCE COLONY 325 Sq. Yds Third Floor, 4 Bedroom @ 12 Cr. Contact Mohan Singh 9667248263

EAST OF KAILASH Kailash 500 Sq. Yds Second Floor 4 Bedroom, New Height @ 12 Cr. Contact Mohan Singh 9667248263

VASANT VIHAR 400 Sq Yds, First Floor 4 BHK , Separate Gate Asking 13 Cr. Contact Nayan Singh 9811109597

SARVODAYA ENCLAVE 217 Sq. yds, 2nd Floor, Park Facing, Separate Gate Parking 2 Car, New Height Ready to Move. Contact Nayan Singh 9811109597

SARVPRIYA VIHAR. 240 Yds. Corner Ind. Bungalow Park Views. 5 BHK+ Basement & 3 Floors.+ Terr. Garden. Lift & Parking Ready 2 Move in Hi End Specifications # 999-000-00-50

LAND FOR Sale 200 Bigha Land, ideal for Residential and Farm House Projects at Garh Mukteshwar, Uttar Pradesh. 120071 Contact number 9811527999

SOUTH DELHI

DEFENCE COLONY - Third Floor. 1/3rd Terrace. 2 Car Parkings . With 600 sq.ft Basement @12cr Vastu Perfect....!

DLF – SUSHANT LOK

FOR SALE– R Zone Land Area: 1/2 Acre (2420 Yards) Location- Sec- 70, on 24 Mtr wide road CLU can be taken in various projects. Price on Call. For More Information Cont: 9810980800

SUSHANT LOK-1 confirm deal, 950 sq yds plot, 4 storeyed+ basement naksha pass , 18 metre road facing more details call 9811072035 Desraj, 9811078877 Lokesh Bhardwaj

NOIDA/GREATER NOIDA

1100 SQMTR. Industrial Plot for Sale in Ecotech-11, in a Premium, Fast-Scaling Setup on a 24m Road in a High-Growth Zone, Price - 6.90 Cr. # Call Raghu 9228812243

PLOT FOR Sale in Omicron 3, Area-60 mtr, Near Depot Metro Station. Demand- 1.25 Cr. and 500 mtr Kothi for sale Sigma 2, Greater Noida. Call: 9643-2222-39

FARIDABAD

KANT ENCLAVE, Green Fields Faridabad, Sale/Purchase Plots, Houses & Builder Floors. Contact Lovely Real Estate 9999292524, 9811470200

CHANGE OF NAME

I, HITHERTO known as Punam W/o Kamlesh Kumar, R/o Flat No. 80C, Pocket-B, HIG Flats, Tower-8, PO-Maharishi Nagar, Sector-105, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201304, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Punam Kumar for all future purposes.

I, HARJEET Kochar, W/o Late Mr. Jaspaul Singh Kochar, R/o A-153, The Belaire, DLF-5, Sector-54, Gurugram, Haryana-122011, hereby declare that I have changed my name to Harjeet Kaur Kochar.

I, RAM Gopal, S/o Basant Ram, born in 18/10/1962, R/o: 30-C, Una Enclave Mayur Vihar Phase-1, Delhi-110091. I have changed my name to Ram Gopal Sharma, affidavit dated-27/01/2026. Sworn before notary Ram Krishna Gupta, Delhi

I, RAJ Kishore Kumar son of Shri Ramprit Prasad resident of 207/22, Gali No.5, Prakash Mohalla, Garhi, East of Kailash, New Delhi-110065 I confirm that Raj Kishore Kumar and Raj Kishor Kumar both names are one and Same person.

I, NO-15732922P Nk Sanchu D R/o 427/B S J Bhavan, Moongodu, Vill-Amboori, PO-Thekkupara, Dist-Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala-695505, have changed my name from Leora J S to Leora S J for all purposes vide Public Notary Delhi affidavit dt 07-11-2026.

I, HITHERTO known as Jitender Kumar, S/o Late Sh. Dhani Ram Aggarwal, R/o B-3/16, First Floor, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi-110029, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Jitender Aggarwal for all future purposes.

I, JATISH S/o Sanjay R/o 51, Ganga Apartments, Alaknanda, Kalkaji, South Delhi, Delhi-110019, have changed my name to Jatish Pruthi for all future purposes.

I NESAR Ahmad S/O Abdul Hamid R/O C - 136, 4, Mulla Colony Gharoli Delhi, 96 have changed my name to Nisar Ahmad for All Future Purpose.

I, AVNEET Kumar Mishra S/o Arvind Kumar Mishra, declare our names are incorrectly recorded in my Class 10 documents as Avneet Kumar Msihra and Arvind Kumar Mshra. Our true and correct names are Avneet Kumar Mishra and Arvind Kumar Mishra, as correctly recorded in my Class 12 documents, these correct names shall be used for all purposes.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, YOGESH Rao S/o Shri Jaipal Rao R/o H.No.804, Sector-19,Kheri Kalan (113) Faridabad, Haryana-121002 have changed my name from Yogesh to Yogesh Rao for all future purposes.

I, CHANCHAL Bhutani, D/o Tilak Raj Bhutani, R/o N 5 B, Mohan Garden, ND - 110059, have changed my name from Chanchal Bhutani to Mansi Chawla. Chanchal Bhutani and Mansi Chawla is same & one person.

I ANKIT S/o Rajesh pratap singh R/o 308, Narmada Apt., Tower-1, DDA Flats, Sector-D, Pocket-6, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070, have changed my name to Ankit Somvanshi for all future purposes.

LOST & FOUND

LOST ORIGINAL Allotment Letter, Possession Letter, Demand Letter, Site Possession & Electricity No Objection Certificate of Office / Shop No.3, First Floor, CSC, Block-D, Anand Vihar Rly Board Colony CHBS Anand Vihar, Delhi of Peerless Financial Products Distribution at B.K Roy Court Daryaganj, Delhi - 110002 Finder Contact: 9830076079.

IT IS notified for the information that I, Rajeev Bhatnagar S/o Swarup Bhatnagar R/o Flat No.C-4/1, Hanuman Mangla Apartments, Plot No. 53, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi -110092 have lost my original Share certificate in the name of R.K Bhagat, Vide membership No. 137, in Respect of Flat No.C-4/1, Hanuman Mangla Apartments, Plot No. 53, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi - 110092. Finder Kindly contact Above the said Flat.

LOST & FOUND

I, ANITA Beniwal, R/o 102, Kewal Kunj Apartment, Sector 13, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have lost my educational certificates (B.A. and M.A. Political Science of University of Delhi and B.Ed. and M.Ed. of Jamia Milia Islamia University), near DD Club, Delhi, on 04.11.2026. Delhi Police Report LR No. 7770/98/2026 dated 05.11.2026 has been registered. Finder please contact me at the above address.

LOST ORIGINAL Allotment Letter, Possession Letter, Demand Letter, Site Possession & Electricity No Objection Certificate of Office / Shop No.2, First Floor, CSC, Block-D, Anand Vihar Rly Board Colony CHBS Anand Vihar, Delhi of Peerless Financial Products Distribution at B.K Roy Court Daryaganj, Delhi-110002 Finder Contact: 9830076079.

PUBLIC NOTICES

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Naresh Kumar Gauba, have lost the original DDA documents relating to Plot No. C-2/47, Ashok Vihar, Phase-II, Delhi-110052, including Allotment Letter Issue by DDA , Possession Letter, Possession Certificate letter, Occupancy Certificate(Building Section) letter, DDA Site PlanMap.all documents issued by DDA.

I haven't misused these paper in any form.

Anyone finding the same may contact me at 98100 35745.

Email: nareshgauba000@gmail.com

HT Classifieds

FOR PROPERTY RELATED ADS

Please Contact
Abhishek Tiwari
9899865804
Gaurav
8630242501
Direct Line : 011-6656-1139

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala-147001
Phone No. 96461-18774, Email Id: semeteringpatiala@gmail.com
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033813, Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-271/2026-27/PR dated 06.11.2026

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Procurement of 4-in-1 Polycarbonate Meter Boxes (Cabinets) for incorporating Single Phase Energy Meters For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 06.11.2026, 17.00 PM onwards.**

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

C1078/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16917

NORTHERN RAILWAY

e-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Name of work with its location	Part-A: Replacement of overaged PSI assets in NDLS section inconnection with Design, supply, erection, testing & commissioning for Augmentation/Replacement of overaged PSI assets in DLI area of Delhi division.
Approx. Cost of work	Rs.2,50,25,570.61/-
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.5,00,500/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission period	19.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 03.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	03.12.2026 (15.00 hrs)
Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 38-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 10.11.2026 3940/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location	Part-F: Provision of feeder wire for enhancement of existing OHE capacity to cater increasing load requirements of GHH/TSS of DLI Division.
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 14,75,17,157.71/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 29,50,400/-
4	Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time	20.11.2026 (11.00 hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	23.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 07.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
6	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	07.12.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
7	Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
8	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-TENDER No.: 35A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 10.11.2026 3941/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. SIG-WS-CONTRACT-586 Dated : 06.11.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

E-Tender Notice No. SIG-WS-CONTRACT-586 Dated:-**06.11.2026** Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Construction/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj GM Office, Betwa Building, Subedarganj, Prayagraj for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tenders on the prescribed form upto **15:00 Hrs**. on **03.12.2026** for the under noted work, which will be opened on the same day at **15:30 Hrs.**

Tender No.: SIG-WS-CONTRA CT-586

Name of work : Infringement removal /Utility shifting of Signalling & Telecom cables and equipment's in connection with Double line work in CAR-CPU section in Prayagraj division of North Central Railway.

Approx Cost of work (Rs.): Rs. 2,79,34,116.38 (Two crore Seventy Nine Lakh Thirty Four Thousand One Hundred Sixteen and Thirty Eight paise only).

Earnest Money (Rs.): Rs. 5,58,700/-(Five Lakh Fifty Eight Thousand Seven Hundred only.

Completi on of period: 12 Months

Date & time of Closing /Opening of Tender: Up to 03.12.2026 15:00 Hrs. and will be opened at 15:30 Hrs. on the same day.

Web site particular and Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen.: Web site www.ireps.gov.in Notice Board provided in the office of the Dy Chief Signal & Telecomm Engineer/Construction/North Central Rialway/Prayagraj, GM office, Betwa Building, Subedarganj, Prayagraj. **2556/26 (D)**

North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ncrtc NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION TRANSPORT CORPORATION LTD.

(A JV of Govt. of India and participating State Governments)

E-TENDER NOTICE

Bid No. DM/REB/COR-OF/331 Tender ID: 2026_NCRTC_296241_1

Online bids are invited for Property Development at Sarai Kale Khan Namo Bharat Station of Delhi-Meerut Namo Bharat Corridor.

For detailed information and subsequent addendum/corrigendum (if any), please visit NCRTC's website **www.ncrtc.in** or CPP Portal **www.etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app** from **11.11.2026 to 28.12.2026 (upto 1500 Hrs)** Sd/- ED/Procurement

UJVN LTD.

H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

Letter No 1063 **Corrigendum** Dated 09.11.2026

The clause No. 16 "Class-A Electrical Contractor license" of S. No.3 of Eligibility Criteria of Section-1 Instruction to Tenderers and Eligibility criteria is hereby completely deleted and stands withdrawn from Tender No. : e-22/EE(M&G)/DKN/2026-27 for "Annual Maintenance Contract for various O&M activities at Dhakrani Power Station" invited by the Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G), Dhakrani Power House, Dhakrani, Dehradun. Bidders are instructed to ignore this clause while preparing and submitting their bids

All other terms and conditions shall remain unchanged.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (M&G)

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:-

1	Name of Work with its Location	Part-B: Replacement of overaged PSI assets in PTNR and FDB section inconnection with Design, supply, erection, testing & commissioning for Augmentation/Replacement of overaged PSI assets in DLI area of Delhi division.
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 3,72,77,205.79/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 7,45,600/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	20.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 04.12.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	04.12.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 39-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 10.11.2026 3939/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE.LAST WORD.

EVERYONE HAS A THEORY OURS HAS THE NUMBERS

Hindustan Times NUMBER THEORY

Go beyond opinions with evidence- backed insights that uncover hidden trends, challenge assumptions and reveal a deeper understanding of the stories shaping India and the world.

LOOK FOR NUMBER THEORY IN HINDUSTAN TIMES

hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF, WATER RESOURCES, ODISHA, SECHA SADAN, BHUBANESWAR 32001/1296/2627

e-Procurement Notice No. RFP CE MKS 02 of 2026-27
Bid Identification No. RFP CE MKS PRD 02 of 2026-27
e-maii id :- celmbbbsr@yahoo.co.in

Sl. No.	Description	Details
1	Name of RFP	Engagement of Project Management Consultant (PMC) for Irrigation Projects (ISS Projects) under Chief Engineer and Basin Manager, Mahanadi Kathajodi System, Bhubaneswar, Water Resources, Department, Govt. of Odisha
2	Type of RFP	Open Tender
3	Mode of Tendering	Online
4	Amount put to tender	197.07 Lakhs
5	Tender Paper Cost	Rs.10,000.00 (Online)
6	EMD(To be paid online)	Rs.19,70,700/-
5	Class of Contractor	Consulting Firms (Consultants/Bidders)
6	Period of Completion	15 calendar months
7	Bid Start Date (Online)	13th November 2026 from 11:00 AM
8	Bid Due Date (Online)	9th December 2027, up to 5:00 PM
9	Last date for receiving queries (To the official mail ID - celmbbbsr@yahoo.co.in)	21st November 2026 up to 11:00 AM
10	Pre-Bid Meeting - hybrid mode (in the conference hall of DOWR, Secha Sadan)	25th November 2026 at 3:30 PM (link will be shared through e-mail in due course of time)
11	Authority response to queries latest by	27th November 2026 at 5:00 PM
12	Opening of Technical BIDs	10th December 2027 after 11:00 AM
13	Opening of Financial BID	To be intimated later
14	Validity of BID	90 days

Further detail conditions can be seen from the Govt. website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
The Corrigendum / cancellation of Tender. if any. will be uploaded and can be seen from the above website only.

Chief Engineer & Basin Manager , Mahanadi Kathajodi System, Bhubaneswar
OIPR - 32001/32252/1/26-27/0010

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1.	THE PANIPAT CO-OP. SUGAR MILLS LTD., PANIPAT	SALE OF PRESS MUD FOR CLUSTER SUGAR MILL DURING SEASON 2026-27.	07.11.2026 14.11.2026	160 LACS	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	9996161393 panipatsugarmills@ gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO. 13/2027/40/50913/I/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./ AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	DNIT NO. 180212 (EPC-D-147/PD&C) DATED 22.09.2026	"OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 1700 HRS."	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN. ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	DNIT NO. 180205 (EPC-D-149/PD&C) DATED 22.09.2026	"OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 1700 HRS."	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN. ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/40/50885/I/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR	CONSTRUCTION OF IPS ON MC LAND NEAR JMIT AT CHOTA BANS IN MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 2 WORKS	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	9,21,19,062/-	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	9050970239 secymcradaur@ gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/40/50895/I/19/7

बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

सोन उच्च स्तरीय नहर प्रमण्डल, भभुआ

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 01/SBD/2026-2027

(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

1. कार्य का विवरण –

क्र० सं०.	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू० में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू० में) (ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय)	परिमाण – विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणी) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू० में	बेल्ट्रॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यर्पणी) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू० में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	अभियुक्ति
01	सोन उच्च स्तरीय नहर प्रमंडल, भभुआ अन्तर्गत कोहिरा बाँध में रिसाव (सीपेज/लीकेज) रोकने हेतु मरम्मति कार्य।	287.28798	5.74600	10000.00	10000.00	12 महीना	

2. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, सोन उच्च स्तरीय नहर प्रमंडल, भभुआ।मो0–7463889388/9304561983
3. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– 06.11.2026
4. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि :– 27.11.2026 से 07.12.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराह्न तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5. प्री–बिड मीटिंग का समय स्थान एवं तिथि :– दिनांक 03.12.2026,समय 03:00 बजे अपराह्न में, मुख्य अभियंता का कार्यालय, सिंचाई सृजन, जल संसाधन विभाग, डिहरी कार्यालय कक्ष में।
6. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक 09.12.2026 समय 3:30 बजे अपराहन। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. वित्तिय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
8. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :– www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
9. निविदा की वैधता अवधि :– 120 दिन

विशेष जानकरी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाहट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं wrd.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

(ई० अखिलेश कुमार)
कार्यपालक अभियंता
सोन उच्च स्तरीय नहर प्रमण्डल, भभुआ
मो0–7463889388/9304561983

PR. No. 0015178 (WRD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

Office of the Principal
Govt. Polytechnic, Darbhanga

Govt. of Bihar

Tender Notice No: GPD/01/2026-27

Notice Inviting Tenders

1. Government Polytechnic, Darbhanga has been constituted under the Department of Science, Technologyand Technical Education, Government of Bihar to cater to the needs of technical education. The Government Polytechnic, Darbhangaintendent to invite bids from eligible entities supply of Mechanical Lab Equipment's for Mechanical Engineering Department.
2. The contract will be offered by Government Polytechnic, Darbhanga to the successful agency/bidder.
3. To participate in the e-tendering process, the bidder/agency are required to get themselves registered with eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
4. **Schedule of Events:**

Sn.	Event Description	Timeline
4.1	Bid Submission Start Date	11/11/2026 at 10:00 AM on the www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.2	Last date & time of downloading the RFP	Till 30/11/2026 up to 04:00 PM, on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.3	Pre-bid meeting	18/11/2026 at 11:30 AM
4.4	Submission (upload) of online bidding document.	01/12/2026 till 04:00 PM, on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.5	Submission of EMD	Offline by 27/11/2026 to "Principal office Government Polytechnic, Darbhanga"
4.6	Opening of Technical Bid	02/12/2026 on the www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4.7	Opening of Financial Bid	After technical Evaluation
4.8	Pre- bid meeting venue	Government Polytechnic, Darbhanga, P.O. -LalBagh, Darbhanga, Bihar, Pin - 846004
4.9	Contact person	Principal, Government Polytechnic, Darbhanga Mobile no: +91 8827210677 Email ID: gpdbg2020@gmail.com
4.10	Method of Selection	Least Cost Selection (LCS)

Principal
Government Polytechnic
Darbhanga

PR- 015103 (Science & Tech.) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

BIHAR STATE POWER TRANSMISSION CO. LTD., PATNA

Govt. of Bihar

(GST No.: - 10AAFCB2393H1Z1, CIN –U74110BR2012SGC018889)
Head Office, Vidyut Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna- 800021
(Department of Project-II of BSPTCL)
Email address- project2@bsptcl.bihar.gov.in
Mob. No. 7763816743 Website- www.bsptcl.in

Tender Notice (NIT) NO.- 45/PR/BSPTCL/2026
(Through e-procurement mode only –www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Online-Tenders are invited by Chief Engineer (Project-II) for the following: -

Description of work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	E.M.D. (Rs.)	Cost of B.O.Q.(Non-Refundable) (Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee (Rs.)	Completion period
Construction of 132 kV D/C GSS Tarapur – GIS Haveli Kharagpur Transmission Line along with 02 Nos. 132 kV GIS Line Bays at 220/132/33 kV GIS Haveli Kharagpur and 02 Nos. 132 kV Hybrid Line Bays at 132/33 kV GSS Tarapuron Turnkey basis.	50.57Cr	50.57 Lakh	11,800	11,800	15 (Fifteen) months from N.O.A.

Bid submission Start Date and Time	From 15:00 Hrs. of 12.11.2026
Date of Pre-bid meeting	On 11:00 Hrs. of 25.11.2026
Bid submission due Date and Time	Up to 17:00 Hrs. of 04.12.2026
Date of opening of Techno-Commercial Bid (Part-I):	After 16:00 Hrs. of 07.12.2026

विवादों के निष्पादन के लिए लोक अदालत का लाभ उठायें परस्पर सहमति से न्यायिक निर्णय प्राप्त करें समय एवं खर्च की बचत करें।

1. "Bid Processing Fee is mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet Payment Gateway (Credit/Debit Card), Net Banking, NEFT/RTGS".
2. The Cost of EMD may be paid through either Online or Offline mode. In case, Cost of EMD is opted to be paid through Offline mode, Bank Guarantee/Demand Draft for EMD in favor of "Accounts Officer, BSPTCL, Patna" must be submitted to Chief Engineer, Project-II, BSPTCL, Vidyut Bhawan I, Patna positively up to 18:00 Hrs. of 04.12.2026 failing which the tender shall be summarily rejected. For online submissions of Cost of EMD, bidder shall must submit details of intimation to this Office by 18:00 Hrs. of 04.12.2026
3. "Bid along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment portal https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in/ before the date & time specified in the NIT. The department doesn't take responsibility for the delay/ Non-submission of Tender/ Non-Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non-availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason".
4. Eligibility Criteria, tender documents along with General/Special condition, bids and any corrigendum/ addendum of the tender are available only at websitewww.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

E-tendering introduced in BSPTCL for tenders above Rs. 25 lacs. For registration log in to www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and e-Procurement Help Desk Toll free No: 1800 572 6571 , Email Id: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in
Working Hours: 8AM to 7PM (All days in week except few selected state holidays).
While participating in e-tendering process, the contractor shall have to get them registered to get user ID, Passwords and digital signature. This will enable them to access the Website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only.

Chief Engineer (Project-II)

PR- 015246 (B & C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

यातायात निदेशालय, उत्तर प्रदेश

उत्तर प्रदेश पुलिस मुख्यालय (सिग्नेचर बिल्डिंग) चतुर्थ तल, टावर–4, गोमतीनगर विस्तार, लखनऊ
दूरभाष– 0522- 2390468 ई-मेल-dirtraffic@nic.in

पत्र संख्याः डीटी–30(1)2026/5051 दिनांकः नवम्बर 10, 2026

निविदा सूचना

वित्तीय वर्ष 2026–27 में उ0प्र0 सड़क सुरक्षा कोष के अन्तर्गत प्रस्तावित अनुदान से क्रय किये जाने वाले यातायात उपकरण 78 अदद Interceptor four Wheeler के क्रयार्थ भारत सरकार की ई–मार्केट प्लेस (GeM) पर दिनॉक 06.11.2026 को कस्टम बिड संख्याः GEM/2026/B/8241942 अपलोड की गयी है, बिड बन्द होने की तिथि 26.11.2026 समय 14:00 बजे है। निविदा के सम्बन्ध में विस्तृत जानकारी भारत सरकार की ई–मार्केट प्लेस (GeM) से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

पुलिस उपमहानिरीक्षक
यातायात निदेशालय, उ0प्र0, लखनऊ

UP 260802 Dt. 10.11.2026, Website: www.upgov.nic.in

HTLS 2026 | NEW RULES. NEW REALITIES

JOIN THE CONVERSATION
SCAN TO EXPLORE #HTLS2026

In the run-up to Hindustan Times Leadership Summit 2026, thought leaders and experts share their views on the theme of this year's event

US midterm polls have opened the door to global climate cooperation

Navtej Sarna

On the landscape of our discontent, several craters pose immediate challenges: Conflicts without end, struggling multilateral institutions, trade handcuffed by tariffs, the looming AI takeover, and so on. It is easy, and often profitable, to turn one's face away from the challenge of climate change. Performative grandstanding – as we will no doubt see at COP 31 in Antalya, Turkiye — or superficial greenwashing is considered sufficient. This deliberate downplaying or ignoring of the climate crisis now has a name: Climate hushing.

But monsters don't go away with a finger on their lips. While the world is looking elsewhere, the Earth's climate system is hurtling headlong into uncharted waters. Several vital markers of the climate crisis are at record extremes: Carbon dioxide levels are higher now than at any time in the last two million years; extreme heat, droughts, floods and wildfires are common occurrences; glacier thickness and Greenland ice mass are at record lows. Staying below the 2015 Paris goal of 1.5 degree Celsius warming is no longer possible. Further, the climate crisis is intersecting with biodiversity loss, freshwater stress, food shortages, pathogens and geopolitical instability. Most of these trends are anthropogenic, driven by unsustainable human activity, particularly fossil fuel dependence. The consequences are inequitable in the extreme: while the rich grow richer, Global South communities and the small island States, historically the least responsible for emissions, bear the most severe consequences. Yet the gap between climate science and societal response continues to widen, even as the risks escalate.

The US under President Donald Trump has been particularly culpable. Trump believes climate change is a hoax and a conspiracy by China to make US manufacturing uncompetitive. He has withdrawn twice from the 2015 Paris Agreement, saying "I was elected to represent the citizens of Pittsburgh, not Paris." By early 2027, the US will have withdrawn from the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and the Intergovernmental Panel of Climate Change (IPCC), the leading authority on climate science. The absence from these forums of the world's largest economy and historically the largest contributor to greenhouse gas accumulation weakens the already fragile international climate cooperation; other countries find it easier to blunt their own climate ambitions. International climate financing and technological assistance for mitigation, adaptation and energy transformation all lose steam. Trump's policies have expanded fossil-fuel production (represented by the slogan, Drill, baby, drill) while exposing, through his misguided war on Iran, the deep vulnerabilities of a fossil-fuel based global economy. He has reversed and defunded Biden-era clean energy initiatives, rolled back regulatory constraints protecting the environment and forests, and stopped offshore wind projects. In the process, he has handed over the central position in solar manufacturing, battery supply chains and several clean-energy technologies to China.

The dramatic results of the recent midterm polls present a slim hope for the repair of the US's climate policies, with both domestic and international impact. While climate was not on the ballot – Democratic candidates were advised to practise climate hushing -- climate policy was very much there by implication: A war that exposed the vulnerability of fossil fuel dependence, rising energy costs, climate disasters and wildfires, and the acne-like breakout of data centres across the country made up the affordability crisis that agitated the voters.

Climate-forward Democrats have won the first round against oil companies, Big Tech and Big Money but it remains to be seen how effectively they can mend specific climate policies. While Trump's veto powers will hamper major legislative changes, Democrats are likely to exercise greater budgetary oversight, resist further deregulation and encourage clean energy investments. Fully reversing many of Trump's acts may have to await a change in the Oval Office or a significant bipartisan consensus. Opposition to data centres is one issue that has bipartisan appeal.

COP31 president Murat Kurum (third from left) poses with former COP presidents Alok Sharma (extreme left), Laurent Fabius and COP31 president of negotiations Chris Bowen (extreme right) in Antalya on Tuesday. REUTERS

Data centres are unpopular because of higher energy bills, shrinkage of water resources, noise and air pollution, an increased carbon footprint and a general scepticism towards artificial intelligence. Tougher regulation, or even a moratorium, on data centres could soon be on the cards. State-level climate policies could be another positive development: Several of the newly elected Democratic governors are strong climate advocates: The first female Native American governor Deb Haaland (New Mexico), the first female Black governor Keisha Lance Bottoms (Georgia), Amy Acton of Ohio and Gina Hinojosa of Texas.

Any signal emanating from the US on climate policy will be a welcome impetus to global climate efforts. While there will be no federal delegation from the US at COP 31, the presence of a 19-member delegation of Congressional Democrats at the Conference will send a significant diplomatic message indicating renewed US interest; another large delegation consisting of mayors, governors and a cross-section of representatives at state and city level will also demonstrate engagement at the sub-national level.

Once the new US Congress convenes in January 2027, climate and clean energy issues should form a vital part of India's outreach on the Hill. India has a good story to tell on clean energy, having crossed 300 GW of installed non-fossil fuel capacity; renewables are over 50% of installed electricity capacity with solar capacity being the third highest in the world. This story should get a more receptive hearing as climate advocates try to balance out the Trump administration's focus on energy access and fossil fuel exports from the US. The scaffolding for bilateral cooperation in this field already exists; a more coordinated approach that accelerates technology cooperation and more public as well as private climate finance would assist India's efforts in generation, manufacturing, storage and transmission of renewable energy. Going beyond the bilateral, India is in a convincing position to play a role as a bridge to the Global South and lead efforts to unblock climate finance and climate technology for developing countries, in particular for adaptation and climate resilience programmes in vulnerable communities.

The door to global climate cooperation is once again open, if only by just a crack. Given the existential nature of the threat posed by global warming, the only choice is to push through.

Navtej Sarna is a former ambassador of India to the United States and high commissioner to the UK. The views expressed are personal

Illustrations: HUIDROM BIKASH

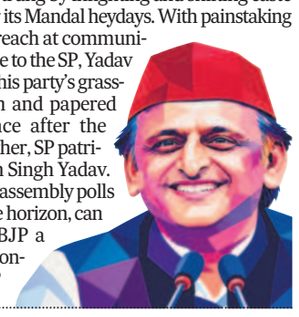
ADITYA BIRLA GROUP
A FORCE FOR GOOD
Hindustan Times
LEADERSHIP SUMMIT
NOVEMBER 14, 2026
NEW RULES. NEW REALITIES.

SPEAKER PROFILES

{ AKHILESH YADAV } SP CHIEF

Mandal warrior's fresh challenge

In Indian political adage, it is often said that the road to Delhi goes through Lucknow, a metaphor for Uttar Pradesh's outsized importance in national politics. If the Opposition has any hope of denting the Bharatiya Janata Party in India's most populous state, it rests on the shoulders of Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav. The 53-year-old has done it once before, becoming the single largest party in the state in the 2024 general elections. A former CM — one of the youngest occupiers of the position who focussed on big-ticket infrastructure projects during his tenure — Yadav has successfully reoriented his regional outfit that was hamstrung by infighting and shifting caste dynamics after its Mandal heydays. With painstaking effort and outreach at communities once hostile to the SP, Yadav has expanded his party's grassroots coalition and papered over dissidence after the death of his father, SP patriarch Mulayam Singh Yadav. With the 2027 assembly polls looming on the horizon, can he deny the BJP a historic third consecutive term?



{ ANANYA PANDAY } ACTOR

Talent, candour, fearless ambition

Ananya Panday is the face of young India. The 28-year-old combines talent with candour and an intense work ethic with charm. She pairs this with memorable roles in stories about heartbreak, alienation, the eternal hustle, and the specific perils young people face in the social-media age. Panday debuted with Student of the Year 2 (2019) and quickly made her mark with projects such as Gehraiyaan (2022) and Kho Gaye Hum Kahan (2023). This was followed by Season 1 of the streaming series Call Me Bae (2024), about an influencer from a wealthy family who suddenly finds herself broke and friendless, and is surprised to learn just how much she is capable of on her own. Known for her candour, Panday has been outspoken about issues within her industry, for fairer turnaround times for crew members, and for greater transparency with regard to pay.

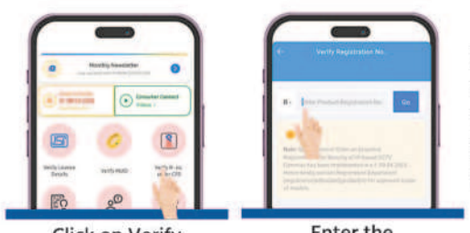
Department of Consumer Affairs
Bureau of Indian Standards
National Standards Body of India

BRAND CHECK ✓
FEATURES CHECK ✓
SAFETY ??? ✓

You Must Check
BIS MARK

How to verify BIS Quality Mark?

Scan to Download BIS CARE APP
Google Play App Store



Click on Verify R-Number
Enter the Registration Number

Register complaints regarding safety of Product of or misuse of BIS marks by using 'Complaints' feature.

Follow us on: @Indianstandards

CBC 08103/13/0008/2627

ऑफिस ऑफ़ इन्शुरन्स आम्बड्समैन
OFFICE OF THE INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN
CIO
काउन्सिल फॉर इन्शुरन्स आम्बड्समैन
Council for Insurance Ombudsmen

11TH NOVEMBER
INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN DAY

Now you can lodge your complaint online from the comfort of your home:
https://cioins.co.in/complaint/online

INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN
There are 18 Insurance Ombudsman across the country to listen to your unresolved grievances.
Every insurance company operating in India (Life, General & Health) has a well organized Grievance Redressal System. If you have any grievance against your insurer/ insurance broker related to your insurance policy, first approach your insurer. If you are not satisfied, then you may contact Office of the Insurance Ombudsman for redressal of your grievance in an impartial manner and without any cost.

Your complaint:*
- Should pertain to Life Insurance, General Insurance or Health Insurance policies issued by insurance companies in India.
- Should pertain to personal lines of insurance, group insurance policies or personal line policies issued to sole proprietor firms and micro enterprises.
- Can be made by the policy-holder himself/herself or by his/her legal heir or assignees or nominees as recorded in policy.
- Must be related to the grievance that has been rejected entirely or partially by the insurance company.
- Must be made within one year from the date of rejection by the insurance company.
- Cannot be on a matter that is or has been under litigation in any other forum.

*Conditions apply

For more information, please visit www.cioins.co.in
Office of Insurance Ombudsman / Council for Insurance Ombudsmen does not involve directly or through any representative in selling any insurance policy nor does it announce any bonus for insurance policies, nor does it make any kind of payment. Beware of fraudsters impersonating as employees of Bima Lokpal / CIO / ECOI / GBIC.

E-mail ids of 18 offices of Insurance Ombudsman are as follows:-

Ahmedabad: oio.ahmedabad@cioins.co.in
Bengaluru: oio.bengaluru@cioins.co.in
Bhopal: oio.bhopal@cioins.co.in
Bhubaneswar: oio.bhubaneswar@cioins.co.in
Chandigarh: oio.chandigarh@cioins.co.in
Chennai: oio.chennai@cioins.co.in
Delhi: oio.delhi@cioins.co.in
Guwahati: oio.guwahati@cioins.co.in
Hyderabad: oio.hyderabad@cioins.co.in
Jaipur: oio.jaipur@cioins.co.in
Kochi: oio.ernakulam@cioins.co.in
Kolkata: oio.kolkata@cioins.co.in
Lucknow: oio.lucknow@cioins.co.in
Mumbai: oio.mumbai@cioins.co.in
Noida: oio.noida@cioins.co.in
Patna: oio.patna@cioins.co.in
Pune: oio.pune@cioins.co.in
Thane : oio.thane@cioins.co.in

Scan QR
Issued in public interest
CBC 15227/13/0003/2627

The Hindustan Times
ESTABLISHED IN 1924

{ OUR TAKE }

New Delhi's goals, and peace in Kyiv

India leveraging its dependability as a neutral peacebroker is in sync with its priorities at home, and affirms its place at the global high table

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent telephonic conversation with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and a call thereafter from external affairs minister S Jaishankar to his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov highlight New Delhi's accelerated efforts to facilitate peace and operational agreements between the two warring countries. Washington, Kyiv and Moscow have resumed trilateral peace talks in Abu Dhabi on Tuesday.

After giving a peace proposal last month that Ukraine deemed the most comprehensive one, India, a neutral party in the ongoing conflict, has reiterated the importance of safe food corridors in the Black Sea region. This is a key concern since India has faced an upward trajectory in retail inflation — though still within the RBI's tolerance band of 4±2% — driven largely by rising food prices. With a combination of hostile factors, from El Niño effects on rainfall to conflict-driven volatility in fuel prices, the outlook on food inflation seems worrying in the near term. A workable agreement between Ukraine and Russia, at least on Black Sea food corridors, would therefore be welcome.

Geopolitically, India's initiative comes at a time of a possible shift in the US-Israel-Iran conflict. Benjamin Netanyahu is almost set to demit office, and his rival Gadi Eisenkot may be not be in favour of escalating hostilities against Tehran if he is able to form the government. Additionally, on the American side, it is expected that the Republicans' midterm rout will, eventually, have a sobering influence on further war efforts in the region. Washington has already indicated that military action may be effectively over though President Donald Trump has been inconsistent with his stand on the issue.

If the West Asian crisis subsides and coincides with some form of Russia-Ukraine rapprochement, economic pressure on the energy front could also ease. While India has secured transit concessions from Tehran in the Strait of Hormuz on the one hand and bought LNG stocks from the US on the other, any escalation there will undermine these hedging efforts.

While India's initiatives to leverage its dependability as a neutral peacebroker align closely with its domestic interests, they are also a reiteration of its place at the global high table.

Hundred Grandmasters later, India poised to rule

It has taken nearly 40 years since Viswanathan Anand first earned the title for India in 1988 to reach a century of Grandmasters (GMs). The initial years were a slow crawl; by 1997, India had three GMs, and in the next decade the number rose to 23 (2010). These pioneers, however, opened the doors for the next generation. By 2019, with 65 GMs, India's chess revolution gathered pace. But even that didn't prepare the world for the surge that came after the pandemic.

The internet provided Indian chess players with a somewhat level playing field — access to chess literature, exposure to some of the best players in the world on the phone or computer, and early scouting opportunities.

For many in the chess world, Anand remains synonymous with Indian chess, but every generation needs its own heroes. Today's crop of young chess players has found them in classical world champion D Gukesh, world No. 7 R Praggnanandhaa, world No. 12 Arjun Erigaisi, and world No. 19 Nihal Sarin. The average rating of India's top 10 is now 2706. A player with an ELO rating of 2700 is widely considered a Super GM, which truly indicates India's current strength on the chessboard.

The challenge for India today is different from what Anand faced in 1988. It is no longer about reaching the top but about being the best. Magnus Carlsen has ruled the chess world since 2013; so India's first quest must be to hone a Grandmaster who can dominate like he did, and then nurture a dynasty that rivals the Russian masters who reigned for most of the 20th century.

Policy predictability key to more foreign investment

Currently, the message investors get from India is that a position settled by one pillar of the State can be junked by another

To attract FDI, India needs clear rules and predictable outcomes across its legislative, executive and judicial institutions. PTI

The US midterm elections showed that rhetoric aside, the economy matters. Cracks are visible in the western and Chinese economies. Capital has already started to flow back to Indian markets. However, what India needs is patient, long-term capital. Schemes like foreign currency non-resident (FCNR) deposits are a palliative measure at best. While they may attract short-term capital flows, these concessional swaps will cost the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). The solution is to attract long-term, stable foreign direct investment (FDI) and build exports.

To attract sustainable foreign investment, India needs clear rules and predictable outcomes across its legislative, executive and judicial institutions. Take the recent approval to disinvest IDBI Bank. It is India's largest FDI in the financial sector and reinforces market confidence. Yet, in the same week, the Supreme Court dismissed appeals by YES Bank, RBI and the Union government, upholding the quashing of YES Bank's Additional Tier-1 (AT1) bond write-off because the bank's administrator had acted beyond their authority under the reconstruction framework. This demonstrates a lack of predictability and certainty for both debt and equity investors and, indeed, the financial system. SMBC Bank had invested substantial amounts in YES Bank. After Daichi and NTT Docomo, this is the third case of Japanese investments impacted in India.

In the case of Tiger Global, the Supreme Court denied treaty relief despite the investors' Mauritian tax-residency certificates, holding that the certificates did not preclude scrutiny for tax avoidance. This order rewrites the fundamental basis of tax treaties. It also shook investors' understanding that grandfathered investments were protected. In March, the government amended the rules to clarify protection for income from transfers of investments made before April 2017.

Aircel's resolution plan had been cleared by its creditors and the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT). Spectrum-use rights were recognised as intangible assets in the operators' accounts. Yet the apex court held that spectrum could not be subjected to proceedings under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code.

Amitabh Kant

Such moves have a chilling effect on FDI and foreign portfolio investment (FPI) in India. Collectively, the message investors get is that a position settled by one pillar of the State can be junked by another. Institutions created for a purpose lose effectiveness when they are superseded. We talk about the long pendency of cases in our judicial system, but the fact also is that collectively, the Union and state governments, and public sector undertakings (PSUs) are the biggest litigants. Nearly ₹30 lakh crore is tied up in various tax disputes.

Uncertainty is a risk, and it raises the discount on the return that firms expect when evaluating investments in India. Delays further compound the damage. When a question of law takes six to eight years to answer, this clouds decisions to invest in India. The following decisions are critical for restoring investor confidence.

First, attract 100 electronics and data centre companies to manufacture or set up units in India. The Apple instance shows what is possible: Smartphones are now a top export category for India. Global hyperscalers have made $200 billion in investment commitments. We are already a nation that is importing compute. We must not import the components for data centres. We must manufacture high-speed networking switches, AI server racks, storage systems, printed circuit boards, chassis, enclosures, and storage, compute and switch trays. Schemes must be designed specifically for such companies. This handholding is critical.

Second, overhaul the model bilateral investment treaty (BIT) framework. The 2015 framework severely stifled investor confidence. Importantly, the exhaustion of the local remedies clause must be reworked and brought in line with international standards. We must not overcorrect by shutting ourselves off from global capital in the name of protecting sovereignty.

Third, asset monetisation through real estate investment trusts (REITs) and Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) can attract a deep pool of global capital. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi)'s recent move to allow for Global Depositary Receipts (GDRs) to be issued against listed REITs and InvITs is an important first step. Expanding the pool of REITs to include data centres and government land will deepen markets. Exit rules and taxation rules must be clarified. The 20% cap on under-construction projects must be raised to allow capital to flow in at the construction stage.

Fourth, complete promised disinvestments and create a disinvestment pipeline. The 2021 Budget promise to privatise two public sector banks and one general insurance company, in addition to IDBI Bank, must be fulfilled. The same Budget announced a New Public Sector Enterprise Policy, calling for a bare minimum government presence in four strategic sector groups and privatisation or closure of commercial PSUs in non-strategic sectors. This must be implemented at the earliest. To start with, the disinvestment of The Ashok must be completed at the earliest. A hotel is not strategic, and the government has no business running a hospitality brand.

Fifth, tariffs on critical inputs must be brought down to zero. We must embrace competition and not hide behind quality control orders (QCOs). The digital trading experience in India must be seamless. Several separate government portals must be integrated at the backend. The full Customs Integrated System must be operationalised as soon as possible. Risk management must truly be risk-based. Authorised Economic Operators (AEOs) must evolve into a trusted-trader framework recognised by every agency. At the same time, we must not prescribe high levels of domestic value addition before scale. Insisting on high domestic value addition before firms achieve scale can discourage the investment needed to build that scale.

Finally, tax policy must align with international standards. Long-term capital gains tax (LTCG) should be removed for international investors. The securities transaction tax (STT) should be removed for all investors. In June of this year, a series of reforms were undertaken to strengthen FPI participation in G-Sec markets. A similar set of reforms to enhance participation in broader debt markets is necessary.

Fixing India's issues needs making the law clear before capital is committed and resolving disputes swiftly thereafter. Policy predictability is the key. No number of reforms can compensate for its absence.

Amitabh Kant is chancellor, NIIT, former G20 Sherpa, and ex-CEO, NITI Aayog. The views expressed are personal

India's defence export boom must close its quality gap

Recent conflicts have delivered a blunt correction to conventional defence planning: Advanced platforms matter, but long-drawn wars are decided by the capacity to sustain the rate at which ammunition is being consumed, through commensurate industrial ability to replenish the arsenal. Russia's artillery expenditure in Ukraine, Europe's scramble to expand shell production, and the US's depletion of interceptor stocks in the Iran campaign, all point to one conclusion: Stockpiles built for peacetime evaporate in weeks, and production lines calibrated for commercial demand of peacetime cannot be scaled up at will during wars.

For India, this crisis presents an opening — and is a test of whether India can convert export demand into durable industrial capacity for handling surges rather than simply selling and being content with rising defence exports for the time being. India has already moved from the periphery to the centre of the global ammunition trade. Since the Russia-Ukraine war began, India has supplied European countries with ammunition worth roughly ₹8,271 crore, becoming one of the largest suppliers to Eastern and Central Europe. Indian defence exports have surged by 1,600% during this period. Indian firms sell to European governments rather than directly to Ukraine, preserving diplomatic deniability while monetising the war market.

Shashank Ranjan

Israel, unsurprisingly, has also become a significant buyer: In last couple of years, India has shipped about ₹630 crore worth of artillery shells, mortar rounds, and explosives to Israel — roughly equal to its exports to Israel over the preceding six years combined.

Saudi Arabia on October 28 reportedly approached New Delhi with an urgent request for an additional 10,000 rounds of 155mm artillery ammunition, as security concerns rise amid the conflict with the Houthis. The Saudi demand reinforces India's position as a supplier to both European and West Asian buyers simultaneously, diversifying away from dependence on any single export market while keeping multiple production lines active.

The more consequential development for India is the entry of private firms into the artillery ammunition manufacturing sector that was long dominated by the government-run ordnance factories. The government's ambition is to shape India into a global production hub for ammunition, with the private sector's role in defence manufacturing targeted to reach 50% or more. India's cost advantage is the single-most disruptive element in the global ammunition market. In India, the production cost of a 155mm artillery shell is about $300-400 per unit, compared with European equivalents selling for upwards of $3,000. This is not merely a function of lower labour costs. India inherited a sprawling ordnance infrastructure from the British and expanded it during the Cold War. When European governments shut down their production lines after the Cold War, India kept many of its lines ticking. The embedded capacity of India is now a commercial asset. European buyers are desperate to supply Ukraine without draining their own already thin stocks. As a result, India is the source that is affordable, available, and politically expedient. For India's own strategic position, vibrant exports keep order books full and production lines running. This lowers the cost of India's reserve replenishment by offering more value for money.

Yet the same trap that caught Europe and the US, can catch India: Peacetime production growth does not necessarily imply wartime surge capacity. Ukraine's western backers discovered that stockpiles built over decades of relative peace were exhausted within months, and production lines took years to scale. In the war against Iran, the US expended over half its interceptor stockpile in a matter of weeks, with replenishment measured in years. India's ammunition manufacturing capabilities are calibrated to export order books and for domestic peacetime consumption. Surge demand during a conflict is a different ball game.

The caveat accompanying cost-effectiveness has always been quality. Indian-manufactured 155mm shells have been linked to barrel bursts and failures in India as well as with international clients. These accounts come from sources with their own biases, and India's defence ministry has consistently defended its quality control. But the pattern matters for understanding the limitations of cost advantage. European buyers purchasing Indian shells for transfer to Ukraine may be less sensitive to quality failures than a country equipping its own soldiers. If Indian ammunition is to move from a discount commodity to a trusted supply, the quality gap must close.

The window for India is real but narrow. Europe is actively seeking to diversify supply chains away from sole dependence on the US, and Saudi Arabia's urgent request signals that West Asian demand is equally acute. India offers a non-western, non-Chinese source of ammunition, with NATO-certified quality in some cases and a political system not aligned with any active belligerent. But the cost advantage is unlikely to sustain permanently. Western firms such as BAE and Rheinmetall are gearing up to enhance their capabilities manifold. This shall eventually bring prices down as volumes rise. India's window to exploit the price gap is, therefore, finite.

The strategic play should not be to sell cheap shells forever, but to use the current demand surge in building the industrial depth that will enable Indian firms to compete on reliability rather than only on price when the emergency premium fades. Revenues earned from soaring exports of ammunition must be re-invested in the quality and surge capacity. That is a far more important objective than export order books alone. In the end, India's ammunition exports to Europe and Israel also represent a high-stake geopolitical balancing act, which cannot be ignored.

THE PLAY SHOULD NOT BE TO SELL CHEAP SHELLS FOREVER, BUT TO USE THE CURRENT DEMAND SURGE IN BUILDING INDUSTRIAL DEPTH

Colonel Shashank Ranjan (retd.) is associate professor of practice and director, Pankaj Kumar Jha Centre for Security Studies, OP Jindal Global University. The views expressed are personal

{ SIMON STIELL } EXECUTIVE SECRETARY, UNFCCC

No COP has a magic wand that can solve these multiples crises overnight. But each recent COP has delivered significant steps forward and COP31 must too... by focusing on practical solutions

HT

In DGP appointments, a sorry tale of police reforms

A protest by Delhi Police personnel against summary transfers — the orders came after a clash with lawyers over a minor issue escalated — underscores the challenges police reforms face in India. A Supreme Court judgment from 2006 issued seven directives on police reforms, and Delhi Police has complied with one relevant in the present instance: The formation of a Police Establishment Board (PEB) to handle transfers and postings. The transfers in the present instance was ordered by PEB; but, the resistance from the aggrieved officers and their supporters shows that procedural safeguards intended to insulate police decision-making are often followed in letter but not in spirit.

The suspension of the assistant commissioner of police leading the protests also highlights the absence of effective formal grievance redressal mechanisms for police personnel. In October, the Supreme Court sought a status report on the implementation of its 2006 reforms (*Prakash Singh vs Union of India*, (2006) 8 SCC 1). This time, the trigger was the Centre's appeal against the appointment of Tadasha Mishra as director general of Jharkhand Police. Mishra has been appointed less than six months before her superannuation — a clear violation of the Supreme Court's directive. Jharkhand's case is neither unique; nor is the vexed subject of police reforms.

Siddharth Lamba

Valay Singh

A scrutiny of 275 DGP tenures across nine states over 1986-2026 shows that just about 1/4th or 25% DGP tenures completed 23 months. The 2006 reforms dictated a minimum 2 year tenure for DGPs. In the two decades since 2006, barring Rajasthan and Maharashtra, the seven remaining states showed more compliant DGP tenures. In Maharashtra, the average DGP tenure fell from about 17 months between 1986 and 2006 to just 10 months in the two decades that followed.

In these nine states, 154 DGP tenures were served by 142 officers between 1986 to 2005, of which 28 tenures were for two or more years. In the next 20 years (2006-2026), there were 121 tenures served by 112 officers, and only 42 completed the minimum tenure mandate.

DGP tenures have increased, but only marginally; before 2006, not only were minimum tenures not mandated but also the selection for the top police post was at the state's exclusive discretion and premature removal was not limited to specified grounds as laid down by the Court. Uttar Pradesh, which has the largest police force in the country, appointed 45 DGPs (48 tenures) in the last four decades, and consequently had the most unstable tenures among the nine states studied. No DGP completed two years in office between 1986 and 2006. And between 2006 and 2026, only three have served for two years.

West Bengal has offered more stable tenures. The state saw 27 DGP tenures over the last four decades, of which only 10 reached at least two years. In Uttar Pradesh, ruling parties changed frequently between 1986 and 2006, while the state has the shortest average DGP tenure (about 10 months). This period also saw its fair degree of trouble, with President's Rule imposed in 1992, 1995, 1996, and 2002. Juxtapose this with the state with the highest average tenure (17 months) — West Bengal — where the ruling dispensations then held strong for decades.

There is also a stark absence of women holding the top police post. In the nine states examined, only two women were appointed as DGPs of a state in the last 40 years. In other states, the situation is not vastly different: The first woman DGP in India was appointed in 2004, and since then, only a handful have made it to the top post.

Policing is in the State List; so, despite the Supreme Court's directives and periodic monitoring, ruling dispensations are hesitant about, if not fully opposed to, implementing the reforms.

Several states have passed legislation or adopted practices to dilute the spirit of Supreme Court's 2006 judgment, be it on sending a list of eligibles to the Union Public Service Commission or the practice of appointing acting or officiating DGPs that has been repeatedly forbade by the courts.

When the dispensations at the state and central level are political opponents, friction over procedures turns into discord. However, when it is the same dispensation in power in a state and the centre, compliance is conspicuous in its breach. Both situations need urgent correction.

Siddharth Lamba is researcher, and Valay Singh is lead, India Justice Report. The views expressed are personal

R. N. I. No. 503/1957 ● Postal Reg. No. DL(ND)-11/6058/2018-19-20 'Licensed to post without prepayment' LICENCE No. U(C)-113/2006-08, AIR SURCHARGE: Raipur and beyond by Rail or Road - Rs. 5/-, Ahmedabad, Bangalore, Coimbatore, Chennai, Cochin, Goa, Hyderabad, Khajuraho, Mumbai, Trivandrum, Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada and beyond by Rail or Road - Rs. 10/-;

PRINTED & PUBLISHED BY MANHAR KAPOOR for and on behalf of HT Media Ltd. 18-20, Kasturba Gandhi Marg, New Delhi-110001 and printed at HT Media Ltd. Presses at Plot No.-8, Udyog Vihar, Greater Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar. (UP). Pin-201306.
BOARD: (011) 23361234 ● EDITORIAL: (011) 66561234 Extn. 1254, 1268 ● CIRCULATION: (011) 66561111 ● ADVERTISING: (011) 66561389 ● FAX: (011) 66561270.

EDITOR: JOSE MARTIN THARAKAN - Responsible for selection of news under PRP Act, @ All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission of Publisher is prohibited.

FBI probing Nvidia CEO: Trump

Reuters & Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump said on Monday the FBI was looking into Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's affair with a Chinese businesswoman alleged to be a spy for Beijing.

Trump said he "was amazed" by allegations about Huang, among the president's closest allies in Silicon Valley. Trump said he had spoken to the CEO, who told him that he had no idea that the woman was a spy.

"I know the FBI is looking into it," Trump said. "I think that he'll be in good shape," he added.

"I did speak to him today just to see if he's feeling all right, how you're doing," Trump said. "He said he had absolutely no idea that the person in question was a spy."

The probe, announced on Sunday, has put a spotlight on 63-year-old Huang's future given Nvidia's status as the world's most valuable chipmaker and the CEO's role as the most prolific salesman of the AI boom. Huang told Nvidia's employees that he had been unfaithful to his wife, without disclosing details of the relationship.

The leather-jacketed Huang enjoys rock-star status worldwide, particularly in Asia, where he often mingles freely with fans, taking selfies and signing autographs for his devoted followers.

He is Nvidia's fifth-largest shareholder with a roughly 3.6% stake, according to LSEG data, and keeps a tight grip on the company through an unusually flat structure in which dozens of executives report directly to him.

But unlike Mark Zuckerberg's Meta Platforms or Elon Musk's SpaceX, Nvidia has no dual-class shares that would give co-founder Huang majority voting control.

The New York Times reported that Trump was briefed on Huang's relationship with the woman and that she was giving information to the Chinese government, and that the president chose not to act on the information.

"The so-called Chinese spy narrative is purely a groundless accusation, slander, and a smear," Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun told reporters in Beijing.

The episode also is attracting congressional scrutiny, with top Democrats Sen. Mark Warner and Rep. Hakeem Jeffries saying on Monday they are interested in investigating it further.

Jeffries said the Nvidia issue came up during a closed-door session with the CIA director and the Director of National Intelligence that was primarily about Iran.

US President Donald Trump shakes hands with Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang at the White House in Washington on September 29. REUTERS

MOONSHOT RENTING NVIDIA'S TOP A.I. CHIPS IN CHINA: DOCUMENTS

WASHINGTON : Moonshot AI accessed a trove of Nvidia Corp.'s most advanced chips this summer, according to documents filed with Beijing regulators, highlighting the Chinese artificial intelligence champion's reliance on American hardware despite US export restrictions.

The firm behind one of China's most advanced AI models signed a contract in August to rent 32 Super Micro Computer Inc. servers equipped with Nvidia's B300 GPUs, the most powerful AI accelerators on the market, documents reviewed by Bloomberg News show.

The online filings valued the servers at 432 million yuan ($64.8 million) and said they were located in China, indicating a possible breach of US rules that forbid sales to the country without an explicit licence.

After Bloomberg News contacted the company for comment, there were no longer references to Moonshot in the documents. BLOOMBERG

Firefighters at the site of a Russian missile attack in Kyiv. REUTERS

Russia-Ukraine talks: Rubio says 'very productive'

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

ABU DHABI: Russia and Ukraine on Tuesday held their first US-mediated talks in nine months on ending their war, with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio calling the meeting "very productive" and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky saying the session was "constructive and quite substantive".

Hopes of ending Europe's biggest conflict since World War II are tempered, however, by the absence of any significant breakthroughs in three previous rounds of talks earlier this year.

There's nothing to suggest a new posture that would lead to a breakthrough, but circumstances surrounding the talks have been changed by the outcome of the US midterm elections as well as increased pressure on Russia's wartime economy. Moscow also is seeking to break Ukrainians' will as winter sets in by ramping up its battering of the country's power grid.

Neither Rubio nor Zelensky attended the talks in Abu Dhabi, the capital of the United Arab Emirates. The session lasted four hours and another is scheduled for a second day Wednesday.

US-mediated meeting

Delegations from Moscow and Kyiv met as Washington, represented by US President Donald Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner and envoy Steve Witkoff, renewed its push to stop the fighting.

"It looks like the talks in Abu Dhabi were very productive," Rubio said in Paris at the Group of Seven meeting, though he urged patience. "There's a lot of work to be done in that regard. It's not like something that's on the verge of being solved in the next 24 hours or anything like that."

Zelensky said the talks were largely about humanitarian issues, including prisoner exchanges and returning Ukrainian civilians in captivity, as well as children taken from the country. Security guarantees also were discussed, he added during an appearance at the University of Copenhagen in Denmark.

Major prisoner swap

A senior Ukrainian official who spoke on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to comment publicly said Ukraine and Russia talked about a large scale prisoner swap, although the details will be discussed in the coming days.

The two-day session is the first such meeting since February on the war, which analysts and humanitarian organisations say has killed hundreds of thousands of soldiers and thousands of civilians.

Kushner said he believed there were "some good ideas how to bridge" the differences between the two sides.

Trump, whose stance on the war has varied, must reckon with Democrats taking over the US Congress in January following the U.S. elections. Democrats could demand more support for Ukraine.

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz told ZDF television on Monday night that "I don't have overly high expectations" for the talks.

There are no signs the fighting is abating, and the talks come against a backdrop of new long-range strikes by both Russia and Ukraine. The two armies are largely deadlocked on the front line.

Russia launched 162 drones of various types and a ballistic missile at Ukraine overnight, Ukraine's air force said.

Russia's Defence Ministry said its forces downed 155 Ukrainian drones overnight in eight Russian regions, as well as over the Crimean Peninsula, which Moscow illegally annexed from Ukraine in 2014.

Nvidia intervened in probe of chip smuggling, questioned US role in Alice's S'pore detention

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: Nvidia Corp's general counsel intervened in a US government probe of suspected smuggling of AI chips by Megaspeed International, questioning whether the Trump administration played a role in detaining an executive from the Singapore-based firm who's now at the heart of a scandal threatening Jensen Huang.

In late summer 2025, Nvidia's Tim Teter called Commerce Under Secretary Jeffrey Kessler, who oversees US chip export curbs, to ask about the Megaspeed investigation, according to people familiar with the matter.

Specifically, Teter wanted to know whether Kessler's Bureau of Industry and Security (BIS) was involved in the Singapore government's recent detention of Alice Huang, a Megaspeed executive, according to the people. Singapore police had brought Alice in for questioning and restricted her from leaving the country. BIS was not involved in that action, said the people, who spoke on condition of anonymity owing to the sensitivity of the matter.

Jensen on Sunday admitted to having an affair with Alice after previously lying about the nature of their relationship, which is now the subject of an investigation by Nvidia's board. An Nvidia spokesperson said that Teter was unaware of the affair at the time he called Kessler about Alice's detention in Singapore.

Alice Huang with Jensen Huang in Taipei, on May 22, 2025. REUTERS

It's unclear whether Teter made any specific requests of Kessler related to his agency's investigation into Megaspeed, which was separate from Singapore's. But in the weeks that followed, BIS staff were muzzled in their ability to look into the company, including a mandate that they route all requests of Nvidia through Kessler or seek his approval for outreach — a highly unusual step that remains unique to the chipmaker, the people said. They were also told not to mention Megaspeed or Speedmatrix, the company's Malaysian subsidiary, in external communications.

In late 2025, the justice department, which was working on the case with BIS — standard practice for any BIS investigation that turns into a criminal probe — requested that BIS pause its efforts, the people said. BIS has not made any progress since then, despite the agency having enough evidence to move forward.

It's an extraordinary episode that raises questions about Nvidia's ability to influence US investigations into breaches of China chip curbs, as well as what exactly Teter sought to do with any additional information about Alice's detention in Singapore.

An Nvidia spokesperson, asked about the company's intervention in BIS's Megaspeed probe, said that Nvidia consults with government officials "to answer their questions, provide information we have gathered from the field, request their guidance and instructions and ask whether they have any follow-ups".

"We work to resolve any allegations of 'diversion' promptly, to help government and our partners halt any would-be smugglers while serving the critical market of lawful customers that help America win worldwide," the spokesperson said. "Unresolved questions about lawful business undercut longstanding US policy and hurt American economic and national security."

Despite that stance, in the months after Teter's initial call with Kessler, Nvidia gave BIS an incomplete account of its business with Megaspeed. After several visits to Megaspeed's data centers — 12 facilities owned by eight companies across three countries in Southeast Asia — Nvidia had sent inventory checks to the agency and declared to Bloomberg News in mid-November 2025 that everything was where it should be.

The company also said at the time that it had asked the US government whether it needed to cut off business with Megaspeed, and was told no.

But Nvidia's tabulations, as relayed to the US government, undercounted the number of chips it had sold to Megaspeed via hardware partners by 50,000 units, according to trade records analysed by Bloomberg. That's worth billions of dollars. After being pressed about the gap, Nvidia told Bloomberg in December 2025 that it had checked additional Megaspeed warehouses that contained the missing hardware, while declining to state exactly how many chips it found in those facilities or provide any further details.

Around three months ago, Nvidia's Teter had a call with someone else on Trump's team — an official at the White House. He told this official, according to a person familiar with the call, that Alice is not as important in Megaspeed as she makes herself out to be, a likely reference to her statement on LinkedIn that she is the company's CEO even though she doesn't hold and has never held that role on paper. Still, because of the bad publicity surrounding Alice, Teter continued, Nvidia had stopped doing business with Megaspeed.

That bad publicity began in October 2025, when The New York Times first reported that the US government was looking into the company.

In November 2025, Malaysian trade records show, Megaspeed imported at least 17,544 of Nvidia's GB300s processors, at the time the most advanced and sought after AI chips on the market, worth some $787 million.

Ex-PM Hasina will be executed if she returns: Prosecutor

DHAKA: The Bangladeshi prosecutor who secured the death sentence against ousted leader Sheikh Hasina said on Tuesday she will be executed if she returns home. "Sheikh Hasina has no option but to face the execution of the verdict," Md Aminul Islam told reporters, responding to reports she planned to return from self-imposed exile in India. AFP

US FDA adds rare vision-loss warning to GLP-1 drugs

WASHINGTON: Popular weight loss drugs including Ozempic and Wegovy will carry a new warning about a possible rare side effect that can sometimes lead to permanent vision loss, US health regulators announced on Monday. AP

12 killed in pileups on foggy Bulgarian motorway

SOFIA: Thick fog on a motorway in eastern Bulgaria caused two major crashes that killed at least 12 people and injured dozens on Tuesday. Dense fog on the motorway linking the capital Sofia with the Black Sea port of Burgas led to two pileups. AP

Eisenkot targets Netanyahu's legacy in new Israeli parliament

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

JERUSALEM: Israeli ex-army chief Gadi Eisenkot and his allies launched a legislative onslaught against caretaker Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's legacy on Tuesday, as a new parliament convened in a heated first session.

Though questions still linger as to who can form a government, Eisenkot's broad left-to-right bloc wasted no time in setting the agenda of the new Knesset with a green light from Israeli-Arab lawmakers, whose role has stirred up heated opposition from Netanyahu's base and even right-wing supporters of Eisenkot.

Eisenkot's Yashar party said it submitted a slew of proposals before the new parliament, including establishing an independent commission to investigate security failures that allowed the Hamas attack on October 7, 2023, the deadliest day in Israel's history.

Netanyahu has long opposed such a probe, denying any wrongdoing and calling instead for a politically appointed commission.

Eisenkot's party also moved for a sweeping repeal of a judicial overhaul implemented by Netanyahu's government, which had triggered some of Israel's largest-ever protests before being overshadowed by three years of war.

Setting the stage for legislative action, Eisenkot's bloc announced it had secured the votes to install a new parliament speaker, Matan Kahana, also a former senior military figure. But neither Eisenkot nor Netanyahu — Israel's longest-serving prime minister with nearly two decades in power — have the 61 votes needed to form a government.

Gadi Eisenkot (centre), leader of the Yashar party, at the Knesset in Jerusalem, Israel on Tuesday. AP

> You [lawmakers] must do everything to avoid a repeat election. Reach out a hand for compromise, even between rivals.
>
> **ISAAC HERZOG,** Israeli President

Netanyahu, speaking after the inaugural session, made a new push for a national-unity government, saying Israel needed to confront a threat from Iran's clerical government, which has survived two major Israeli bombing campaigns the premier ordered with support from US President Donald Trump.

With his political survival on the line — and facing potential jail time if convicted on corruption charges after he is out of power — Netanyahu appeared to acknowledge a shifting diplomatic reality after US Democrats soundly defeated Trump in midterm elections last week on the back of anger over the war. "In the very near future, we're going to be confronted by international pressure to accept a nuclear-armed Iran and the preservation of this terror regime that seeks to annihilate us," Netanyahu said.

Iran denies seeking nuclear weapons and both Netanyahu and Trump have previously boasted that its nuclear programme was devastated.

Gulf Arab states signal military integration in wake of Iran war

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

KUWAIT CITY: The Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), a bloc of US allies including Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates, approved a joint forward-command centre, signalling their desire to deepen military integration in the wake of the Iran war.

The Unified Military Command will be headquartered in Kuwait and forces will be allocated to it, GCC secretary-general Jasem AlBudaiwi said in a statement on Tuesday. The announcement followed a meeting of GCC defence ministers in Bahrain.

The six GCC states, which also include Qatar and Oman, have been attacked thousands of times this year by Iranian drones and missiles, in retaliation for US-Israeli attacks. Tehran said its counterstrikes were aimed at US assets, including bases in the GCC, though many targeted civilian sites such as ports and cities. The strikes from Iran — as well as from Tehran-backed militias in Iraq and Yemen — have given the Gulf Arab countries impetus to coordinate more closely to improve their security.

It's unclear if the new command centre will integrate the air defence systems in the six countries, which many analysts have said is necessary to fend off any future strikes.

AlBudaiwi criticised the "sinful Iranian attacks" and praised the level of cooperation among the armed forces of the GCC.

Rubio: No need for major Iran ops as sanctions, blockade working well

PARIS: Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Tuesday that he told G7 allies that the US economic sanctions and naval blockade are working so well that President Donald Trump does not need to conduct major combat operations in Iran.

Speaking to reporters in Paris after two days of meetings with G7 allies, Rubio repeatedly pushed back on the assertion that not returning to military action would amount to a stalemate or status quo.

"The economic pain that is being inflicted on Iran right now is extraordinary and it compounds. It's growing every day," Rubio said. He added that Trump has also received input from regional allies in the Middle East confirming this assessment. "We don't need to conduct military strikes if we're achieving the same objective through economic means and economic pressure. That's not stalemate," he said. "Never has Iran ever faced the inability to sell energy in the global market like they are today."

The G7 diplomats said Rubio had used strong language to describe the Iranian authorities. Two said he had referred to them as "lunatics". The diplomats quoted Rubio as saying that, rather than resuming the war or accepting Iran's demands, Washington's current policy of tough economic sanctions is working and is limiting Tehran's ability to fund its regional activities and proxies. REUTERS & AFP

Marco Rubio REUTERS

THREE OIL TANKERS ON FIRE IN HORMUZ: IRAN

TEHRAN: Iran's Revolutionary Guards said on Tuesday that three oil tankers were on fire in the Strait of Hormuz, where the country regularly targets ships that transit without its authorisation.

Later in the day, the Emirati state oil company ADNOC said one of its vessels had "sustained damage following an attack in the UAE's territorial waters" in the Gulf. It was unclear whether it was one of the ships mentioned by Iran's Revolutionary Guards. AFP

HEGSETH DEFIANT AS EFFORTS TO IMPEACH HIM GAINS GROUND

Shashank Mattoo
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US Secretary of War Pete Hegseth struck a defiant note on Tuesday after efforts to impeach him over his conduct in office gained ground this week. Republican Congressman Thomas Massie introduced articles of impeachment in the House of Representatives on Monday, which included 3 charges of waging war against Iran illegally in violation of a long standing War Powers Resolution.

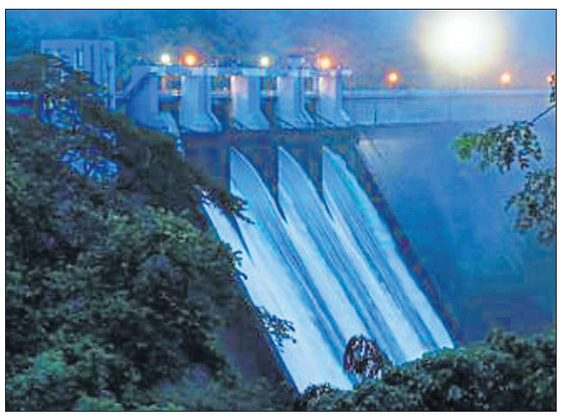
Speaking at a press briefing, Hegseth argued that no previous holder of his office had ever been impeached for carrying out "lawful military operations".

"In 250 years of our American republic, no Secretary of War or Secretary of Defence has ever been impeached for carrying out lawful military operations — not once. Not under Reagan in Lebanon. Not under Clinton in Kosovo. Not under Obama in Iraq or Syria. Not under Biden in Iraq or Syria. That is the standard. The history is clear and one disgruntled Congressman wants to shred it over policy disagreements," said Hegseth, referring to Congressman Massie, who has been an opponent of the Trump administration within the Republican Party.

Depleting dams foretell distress for farms, power

Farm output, hydropower may suffer as reservoirs that were over 90% full last year are less than two-thirds full

Vijay C. Roy and Rituraj Baruah
vijay.roy@livemint.com



Water levels at India's 178 reservoirs supplying irrigation, hydropower and drinking water are down 27% from a year ago. AFP

NEW DELHI: Scanty rains of the southwest monsoon have left India's key reservoirs severely depleted, threatening irrigation, agricultural output and hydropower generation. Reservoirs that were over 90% full last year are now not even two-thirds full, official data showed, following one of the driest monsoon seasons in decades.

Water levels at India's 178 reservoirs supplying irrigation canals, hydropower units and municipal drinking water are down 27% from a year ago to 121.9 billion cubic metres (bcm), official data showed. The dry spell is already rippling through the rural economy, where six states have declared drought, rabi crop sowing has dropped, and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has warned of mounting risks to food inflation.

Apart from the central region where levels were marginally above last year's, storage was lower in all other regions, data from the Central Water Commission showed.

The water scarcity was worst in the southern region, where reservoirs are only 42.6% full (against last year's 89.97%), compared with north having 56.62% (86.32%), west 76.17% (96.10%), east 75.74% (81.66%) and central 84.23% (92.01%). While the southwest monsoon that brings most of India's rains has concluded, the northeast monsoon remains active in the southern peninsula, raising hopes of further rains in catchment areas.

Not surprisingly, sowing has slipped. Crops were sown across 11.7 million hectares till 6 November, 2.43 million hectares below last year's 14.1 million at this time. To be sure, rabi sowing is still on, and typically continues till end of December. India's average rabi acreage in the FY21 to FY25 period was 70.1 million hectares.

Less water for irrigation may impact sowing and harvest, experts pointed out.

"Low reservoir levels, particularly in the western and southern regions, could affect rabi crop cultivation, as farmers in these areas depend heavily on reservoir water for irrigation. Crops such as wheat, paddy, pulses and oilseeds could face irrigation constraints if water availability remains limited during critical growth stages," said Sudhir Panwar, a farm policy expert and former member of Uttar Pradesh Planning Commission.

Wheat acreage has slipped 12% to 1.97 million hectares, rice 3.10% to 673,000 hectares, and pulses 14.4% to 3.2 million hectares, agriculture ministry data showed.

However, some said the impact will be limited in the northwestern region.

"The impact of lower reservoir levels on rabi crops is likely to be negligible in northwestern India, as the region is well-irrigated. Moreover, wheat, a major rabi crop in the region, requires relatively less water and all the growing areas are irrigated. The impact is likely to be concentrated in areas where farmers depend heavily on reservoir water for irrigation," said AK Singh, former director, Indian Agricultural Research Institute(ICAR).

The World Meteorological Organization (WMO) warned in September that the 2026 El Niño could be unprecedented in strength, potentially taking Pacific Ocean temperatures 3.8°C above average, with its peak expected towards the end of 2026 and climate impacts extending well into 2027. For India, it means below-normal rainfall, higher temperatures and prolonged drought conditions. India's southwest monsoon rainfall in 2026 stood at 87% of the 50-year average, making it the fourth-lowest since 2001 and the 13th-lowest since 1901, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD). October rainfall saw a deficit of 31.4%.

In late October, Maharashtra expanded drought relief to 305 of the state's 358 talukas and approved a ₹7,500-crore package, including ₹5,000 aid for eligible farmers.

While coal dominates India's power sector, hydropower plays a critical role in supporting solar and wind power. Turbines can be quickly turned on and off; so, hydropower can step in or dial down when the sun doesn't shine and the wind doesn't blow.

"In the case of run-of-the-river hydro projects, the lesser discharge of water may impact hydropower generation and the decline in reservoir levels would also bring hydro power generation below what is generally witnessed during these months," said Raj Kumar Chaudhary, former chairman and managing director, NHPC Ltd.

India has 20 reservoir-based hydropower projects, monitored by the CWC. Gobind Sagar dam in Himachal Pradesh, with a generation capacity of 1.3GW as of 5 November had storage of 56.87% of the full reservoir level (FRL), compared to 85.09% in the corresponding period last year. It is also way below its 10-year average of 73.52%. Similarly, the reservoir level in the Koyna dam (1.9GW) in Maharashtra is currently at 87.67% of the full reservoir level, while last year it stood at 100%. The current level in Tehri dam (1GW) in Uttarakhand is 92.91%, compared to 95.28% last year.

Chaudhary added that heating demand may add to overall consumption. The former NHPC chief noted that although solar and thermal would play a key role in these winter months, pollution and heavy smog in northern states could impact solar power generation in the region, affecting overall power supply.

JSW to skip latest airport bids on viability concerns

Dipali Banka
dipali.banka@livemint.com

MUMBAI: Billionaire Sajjan Jindal-led JSW Group has ruled out bidding in the government's latest airport privatization round, at least for now. The airport sector was seen as an area of interest for the conglomerate as part of its diversification push beyond steel.

JSW's decision came after an internal review concluded that airports are "a quasi-real estate play". It, however, remains open to reconsidering its stance if bigger city airports, including Kolkata and Chennai, are opened up for private participation.

"We set up a small team to study the airport business. We evaluated the pros and cons, the investment required, and the returns. We realized it is a kind of real estate investment. We felt it doesn't fit into any of our existing businesses," Parth Jindal, managing director of JSW Cements and JSW Paints, told *Mint*.

The team, that was formed under JSW Infrastructure and included Ashwin Noronha, former chief operating officer of Mumbai International Airport Ltd, concluded that the small assets are not profitable.

In the latest privatization round, 11 airports of the Airports Authority of India (AAI) will be offered to private operators under the public-private partnership model in five bundles: Amritsar-Kangra, Varanasi-Gaya-Kushinagar, Bhubaneswar-Hubballi, Raipur-Aurangabad and Tiruchirappalli-Tirupati. Bidding is likely to start next month, and the government expects to get at least ₹8,600 crore from this round, Mint reported on 25 August.

Parth Jindal, managing director of JSW Cements and JSW Paints. PTI

Jindal said the smaller airports could make business sense for existing operators looking to expand portfolios. "The major airports are taken. The 11 airports that are coming up (for auction) are smaller in size. It is not viable for us, so it doesn't make sense... If and when Kolkata and Chennai airports come to play, we may review our decision," he said. India's private airports are operated by two major conglomerates, led by the Adani Group that runs eight airports, including Mumbai and Navi Mumbai, and GMR Airports, which operates six including Delhi, Hyderabad and Goa. Government-owned AAI manages 137 airports, including 24 international ones.

India's top six airports hosted 60% of the air traffic in FY26. They were led by New Delhi that handled 78.7 million passengers, followed by Mumbai (55.3 million). Bengaluru (44.47 million), Hyderabad (30.48 million), Chennai (23.3 million) and Kolkata (22 million) were the others.

"Airport entry has a credible strategic logic. JSW's port experience provides relevant capabilities in financing, project execution, concession management and government coordination," said Saptarshi Purkayastha, professor of strategic management at the Indian Institute of Management Calcutta.

JSW Infrastructure is India's second-largest private port and terminal operator.

"However, metropolitan airports require additional expertise in passenger services, airline relationships, security compliance and commercial revenues. Dedicated airport leadership, an experienced operating partner and carefully phased commitments would strengthen the case. The attractiveness of airports ultimately depends on terms of entry and the capabilities JSW builds," he said.

Entering the airport sector was part of JSW's broader search for opportunities beyond its traditional steel business. It has expanded into power, infrastructure, cement, paints and real estate. "I see this as an acceleration of JSW's evolution into a diversified industrial group, with steel continuing as its anchor," said Purkayastha. He said success will depend on how well the group manages its expanding portfolio.

US OFFICIALS VISIT INDIA TO HOLD TALKS ON PROPOSED BTA

Rajeev Jayaswal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A team of US officials visited India earlier this month for talks on the proposed bilateral trade agreement (BTA), as New Delhi and Washington remain engaged for an early conclusion of the first tranche of the deal, an official said on Tuesday.

The two sides discussed issues related to customs and trade facilitation during meetings in New Delhi last week, the official said, requesting anonymity.

Indian officials remain positive about the proposed mutually beneficial agreement and ruled out any disruption to the negotiations following the outcome of the recent US midterm elections. The US and India have a very consequential relationship which, apart from trade, draws strengths from economic, political and security imperatives, an official said, asking not to be named.

According to trade experts, uncertainty created by Washington's frequent trade measures and the use of tariffs as a negotiating tool had been major hurdles to signing an interim BTA, even though a preliminary draft is almost ready. The two countries issued a joint statement on February 7 outlining a framework for an interim BTA. However, the agreement was not signed after the US Supreme Court invalidated the legal basis for the preferential tariff mechanism Washington had offered, the experts said.

Blackstone to buy 15.5% in IIFL Finance for $532 mn

Blackstone Inc. will acquire a 15.57% stake in mid-sized Indian shadow lender IIFL Finance Ltd. for about ₹5,000 crore ($532 million), deepening its push into the country's financial sector as global investors increase their exposure to its fast-growing economy.

The world's largest alternative asset manager will make the investment through Singapore-based Ingot SG Pte. Ltd., which will subscribe to about 83.1 million compulsorily convertible preference shares at ₹602 apiece, according to an exchange filing on Tuesday. Each preference share will convert into one IIFL Finance equity share.

Bloomberg News reported in September that Blackstone was among global investment firms considering an investment in IIFL Finance.

The move comes after Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd., which held about 13.6% of IIFL Finance at the end of September, acquired a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank Ltd. for ₹52,878 crore in October. That marked the biggest foreign investment in India's financial-services sector to date.

Founder Nirmal Jain will subscribe to 15 million warrants worth ₹903 crore, while R. Venkataraman will subscribe to 4.5 million warrants worth ₹271 crore. Founder Ardent Impex Private Ltd. will subscribe to another 1.5 million warrants worth ₹90.3 crore. BLOOMBERG

Jobless rate eases to 5.1% in Sept quarter

Abhishek Jha
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's headline unemployment rate was 5.1% in the quarter ended September, compared with 5.2% in the same quarter a year ago, according to the quarterly bulletin of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Tuesday. To be sure, the unemployment rate increased among the youth, a trend anticipated from the monthly data for the quarter.

The headline unemployment rate decreased despite more people seeking work in the quarter ended September 2026 than in the quarter ended September 2025. The labour force participation rate (LFPR) – or the share of people working or looking for a job – was 42.3% in the quarter, up 70 basis points (one basis point is one hundredth of a percentage point) year-on-year.

The decline in headline unemployment alongside a rising LFPR has also been evident in the monthly bulletins. The quarterly bulletins, however, reveal that the quantitative improvement was accompanied by a qualitative improvement. The share of workers in agriculture declined 70 basis points year-on-year to 41.7%, while the share in the secondary sector – which includes industries such as manufacturing, construction and mining – increased 50 basis points to 24.7%. The share of workers in services sector remained nearly flat at 33.5%.

As expected from a decline in agriculture's share, the share of unpaid family workers (a kind of self-employed worker in the PLFS, usually found in agriculture) decreased somewhat. Their share declined by 10 basis points to 14.2%. The share of casual labour also decreased 50 basis points to 18.4%. On the other hand, the share of salaried/regular wage workers increased 40 basis points to 25.8% and the share of own-account workers increased 30 basis points to 40.9%. While the labour market conditions appear to be improving overall, they are deteriorating for the youth.

The unemployment rate for the 15-29 age group (the only separate age group for which the bulletins provide data) increased 50 basis points to 15.3%.

International air traffic outpaced domestic growth in FY26: DGCA

Neha LM Tripathi
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's international air passenger traffic rose to 78.7 million in 2025-26 from 74.7 million in the previous financial year, while domestic traffic grew by just 1.1% to 167.4 million, according to annual data released by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA).

The growth in international traffic came amid geopolitical conflicts and airspace closures that forced Indian carriers to reroute westbound flights and, at times, cancel services following last-minute Notices to Air Missions (NOTAMs) restricting access to airspace in conflict zones.

Indian airlines accounted for 44.4% of international passenger traffic during the year, while foreign carriers held the remaining 55.6% share. IndiGo had the largest share among individual operators at 20.8%, followed by Air India at 12.9%, the DGCA data showed.

Domestic passenger traffic rose to 167.4 million in the financial year ended March 2026, from 165.5 million in 2024-25, registering year-on-year growth of 1.1%.

Indian airlines accounted for 44.4% of overseas traffic. MINT

Taken together, passenger traffic on all airlines operating in India increased 2.7% to 246.1 million in 2025-26, from 239.7 million in the previous financial year.

IndiGo continued to dominate the domestic market, accounting for 63% of passenger traffic, followed by Air India at 13.6% and Air India Express at 6.3%.

The DGCA data also showed an increase in aircraft accidents, from six in calendar year 2024 to 11 in 2025.

One of the accidents involved a scheduled airline, while five each involved non-scheduled operators and flying training institutes.

The number of serious incidents, however, declined from nine in 2024 to six in 2025. Of the six serious incidents recorded in 2025, three involved scheduled operators and three involved foreign operators.

Revenue passenger kilometres (RPK), a measure of passenger demand, rose 2.4% to 164.3 billion, while available seat kilometres (ASK), which measures airline capacity, increased 3.8% to 192.9 billion, according to the DGCA data.

Cargo traffic also recorded strong growth. Domestic cargo carried by scheduled airlines rose 24% to 9.78 lakh metric tonnes in 2025-26, from 7.89 lakh tonnes in the previous financial year.

International cargo traffic increased 20.6% to 21.3 lakh tonnes, compared with 17.66 lakh tonnes in 2024-25. The international cargo figures include freight only.

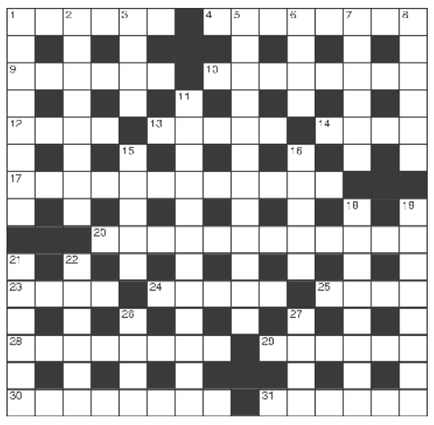
{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS
1 Girl with fish to sell down the river (6)
4 Branch is not on fire (8)
9 Bill comes back with a new coil of fabric (6)
10 Prior is a clergyman in a religious setting (8)
12 Freight unopened in Jason's ship (4)
13 Figure it looks like a quiet copy (5)
14 Father to the French wife of a German husband? (4)
17 Telephone booths? (12)
20 Unstable gambling den? (5,2,5)
23 Still equal (4)
24 Ancient characters around Omagh? (5)
25 Course for an ethnic group (4)
28 I respect newly presented evidence of settlements (8)
29 Policeman determined to evade responsibility (3,3)
30 It's inclined to lie low if troubles intervene (8)
31 Pastel composition used in the dining room (6)

DOWN
1 Through luck perhaps (2,6)
2 Reg gets entangled with metal wire (8)
3 Chief means of support (4)
5 A company offer of a certain kind? (4,8)
6 Husband to rescue (4)
7 Do sour ingredients make scents? Yes! (6)
8 Sit out with a girl in gauzy fabric (6)
11 Limited in one's outlook (5-7)
15 Rose paid for the drinks (5)
16 The length a boxer will go to (5)
18 Rash action of convicts? (5-3)
19 It will contain a fire (8)
21 Examine closely for fallen arches (6)
22 Eyebrow-raising writer (6)
26 They went to market on foot (4)
27 Sort of music showing spirit? (4)

PUZZLE 17640 © Gemini Crosswords 2018 All rights reserved



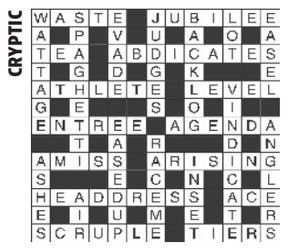
QUICK CLUES

ACROSS
1 Pester (6)
4 Duplicitous (3-5)
9 Simple, unsophisticated (6)
10 General handyman (8)
12 Unite by treaty (4)
13 Intimidated (5)
14 Massive breakwater (4)
17 State of affairs (6,2,4)
20 Compensate for a painful necessity (5,3,4)
23 Distinctive atmosphere (4)
24 Stipulations (5)
25 Catch sight of (4)
28 Supercilious (8)
29 Formal proposal for debate (6)
30 Revealing (8)
31 For the time being (3,3)

DOWN
1 Buildings to house soldiers (8)
2 Forlorn (8)
3 Film of heroic scale (4)
5 Very enjoyable experience (5,2,1,4)
6 What becomes of a person (4)
7 Sewing thread (6)
8 A discouraging influence (6)
11 Active Mexican volcano (12)
15 Finely ground meal (5)
16 Plant with daisy-like flowers (5)
18 Locate precisely (8)
19 A precious metal (8)
21 Wealthy tycoon (3,3)
22 Make a journey (6)
26 Lacking effervescence (4)
27 Morose (4)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17639)

CRYPTIC



QUICK

{ SUDOKU }

DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★

		4	1					8
8		6		4			9	
			8					2
		8		9	1		6	
	4						2	
	6		5	7		9		
6					7			
	1			8		5		6
9					5	2		

Fill in all the squares in the grid so that each row, column and each of the 9X9 squares contains all the digits from 1 to 9.

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

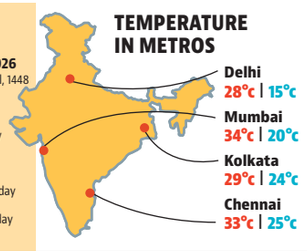
{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ■HIGH ■LOW

WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
Fog or mist would occur in early morning	Fog or mist would occur in early morning	Fog or mist would occur in early morning
28°c | 15°c	28°c | 16°c	29°c | 16°c

ALMANAC
Today is
11th November 2026
- 30 Jumada Al-Awwal, 1448
- 17, Kartika, Shukla Paksha, 02
- Samvat 2083
- **Sunset:** Wednesday at 05:29 p.m.
- **Sunrise:** Thursday at 06:41 a.m.
- **Moonrise:** Wednesday at 08:31 a.m.
- **Moonset:** Wednesday at 06:42 p.m.

TEMPERATURE IN METROS



Delhi 28°c | 15°c
Mumbai 34°c | 20°c
Kolkata 29°c | 24°c
Chennai 33°c | 25°c

SOFTBANK SWINGS TO $7.1-BN LOSS ON DATA CENTRE BETS

SoftBank Group Corp. reported its first net loss in almost two years after swallowing a $3.7 billion writedown over its US data-center projects amid rising fears around the sustainability of AI growth. The Tokyo-based backer of OpenAI tumbled to a ¥1.12 trillion ($7.1 billion) loss in its fiscal second quarter after shouldering non-refundable advance payments related to power generation at projects including an ambitious Ohio data center push. Analysts on average expected a profit of ¥129 billion.

After reserving manufacturing capacity for power generation equipment for AI data center projects in the US, the company revised its procurement strategy. That follows a sharp revision in the global AI outlook after the victory of Democratic candidates running on anti-data-center platforms during the US midterm polls. BLOOMBERG

Govt makes EVs default staff cars

Manas Pimpalkhare and Dhirendra Kumar
manas.pimpalkhare@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: The finance ministry has made electric vehicles (EVs) the default choice for government staff cars, signalling a shift away from petrol and diesel vehicles in official fleets as India seeks to cut oil imports and vehicle emissions.

In a notification on Tuesday, the department of expenditure said ministries and departments should ordinarily procure EVs when replacing or retiring their existing internal combustion engine (ICE) staff cars. Departments seeking to buy an ICE vehicle instead will have to justify the decision through a detailed proposal to the expenditure department. A senior government official confirmed the development to *Mint*. The move is aimed at promoting electric mobility, reducing dependence on fossil fuels and taking into account prevailing vehicle prices and lifecycle costs, said the notification, seen by *Mint*. The government has also set a procurement ceiling of ₹20 lakh for EVs, higher than the ₹10 lakh limit for ICE and hybrid vehicles.

The government has also set a procurement ceiling of ₹20 lakh for EVs. ISTOCKPHOTO

The decision comes as India seeks to become a net-zero carbon emitter by 2070. Transport accounts for 12% of the country's carbon emissions, according to the International Energy Agency. The shift to EVs could also help reduce India's dependence on imported oil, with the country meeting about 90% of its oil requirements through imports. It may also help curb vehicular pollution.

"Making EVs the default for government staff cars is a welcome step. Zero-emission vehicles cut tailpipe pollution, keep India's auto industry competitive as global markets electrify, and reduce our reliance on imported oil," said Amit Bhatt, India managing director of the International Council on Clean Transportation, a global think tank.

However, government fleets have so far seen limited EV adoption. A 2022 Lok Sabha disclosure showed that of 847,544 government vehicles, only 5,384 were electric, accounting for 0.63%. The EV share was 0.58% in Union government fleets and 0.31% in state government fleets.

Email queries and calls to the department of expenditure spokesperson seeking confirmation and comment had not received an immediate response.

CHINA'S TRADE SURPLUS TOPS $1 TN FOR 2ND YEAR

AP
feedback@livemint.com

HONG KONG: China's trade surplus exceeded $1 trillion for a second straight year, according to official data released Tuesday, as pressure mounts for greater balance in trade with Beijing.

Exports in October surged 35.2% from a year earlier, the customs agency said. Exports have grown rapidly this year, supported by high-tech goods like semiconductors and autos.

Imports rose 41.6% year-on-year.

Between January and October, China logged a $1.04 trillion trade surplus, even as the trade surplus narrowed last month to $105.3 billion from $133.5bn in September as imports picked up pace. That puts China on track for surpassing last year's record $1.2 trillion trade surplus in 2026.

Emerging in New Zealand: Axar as India's anchor spinner in ODIs

A pairing with Washington still in the offing, Patel could be key in the middle overs in next year's ODI World Cup

Somshuvra Laha
somshuvra.laha@htlive.com

KOLKATA: For much of his career, Axar Patel has lived in the shadow of Ravindra Jadeja. The comparison was inevitable. He was, by all means, the closest India had to a like-for-like replacement for Jadeja. But as India begin shaping their plans for the 2027 ODI World Cup in South Africa, that description is set to get an upgrade.

Axar isn't simply being groomed to take Jadeja's place, Patel could be asked to anchor India's slow bowling attack in the World Cup.

Jadeja's omission has already prompted talk of a changing philosophy. India appear increasingly attracted to the prospect of a spin attack built around containment rather than sustained aggression. Patel operating alongside Washington Sundar — both are capable of squeezing opposition batters through the middle overs — rather than relying on Kuldeep Yadav as the principal attacking threat seems to be emerging as a logical strategy.

South Africa in October and November is unlikely to offer pitches where spinners would get grip and turn. Pace, bounce and carry could make fast bowling the primary weapon, particularly in the early stages of an innings. The value of a spinner, therefore, may lie less in extracting turn and more in denying batters freedom. This is where Axar's strengths become important.

Like Jadeja, his bowling too has always been built around accuracy, a skiddy trajectory and the ability to maintain a relentless line. He doesn't need turn to be effective. By attacking the stumps and denying batters room, he can make scoring difficult even when the pitch offers little encouragement. And though the sample size isn't large, the ongoing New Zealand ODI series — Axar is the only spinner used by India so far — has provided an interesting illustration of that.

Axar returned figures of 0/12 from five overs in Auckland and 2/28 in nine overs in Wellington. Across the two completed matches, that works out to 40 runs at an economy rate of 2.86 and a bowling average of 20. These are encouraging numbers, particularly given that conditions in New Zealand, like South Africa, aren't designed to reward spin bowling.

There is an important distinction between the two performances. In Auckland, Axar was primarily a restrictive presence, allowing the seamers to operate around him without the opposition being able to exploit his overs. In Wellington, he demonstrated that the defensive approach need not mean an absence of wickets. His dismissal of Daryl Mitchell was particularly valuable because it removed the one batter who looked settled.

With only two ODIs possible in New Zealand till date, Patel's effectiveness is yet to be entirely ascertained. But the indications are quite revealing.

Jadeja's value was never confined to his bowling. He could score quickly and provide India with an additional frontline bowling option, apart from fielding like a superhuman. But at this stage of his career, the selectors appear to be looking beyond reputation and past achievements. Minus the scintillating fielding — though Patel has a safe pair of hands as well — he offers a younger alternative without necessarily reproducing everything Jadeja did.

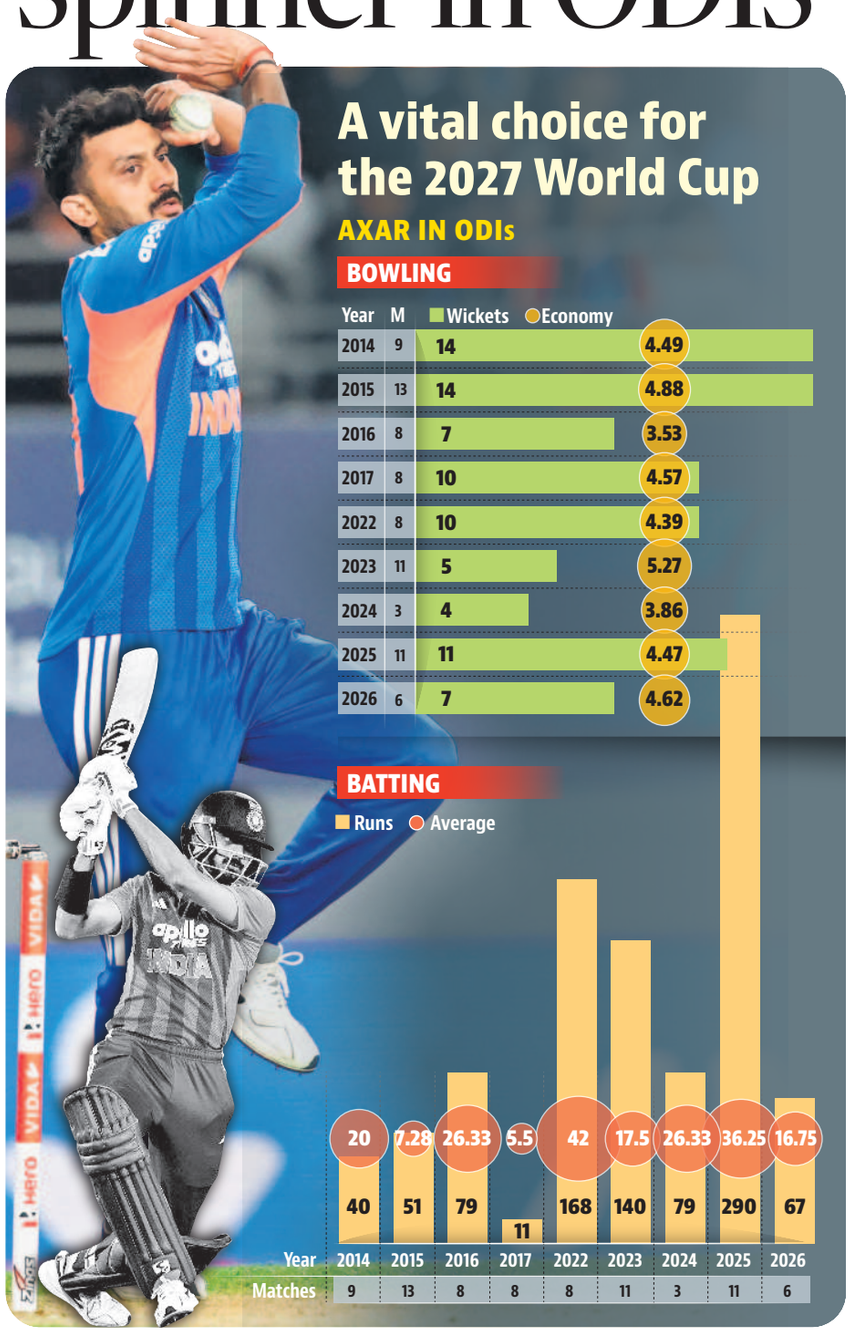
The possible partnership with Washington is an intriguing subplot. Washington's off-spin brings an added dimension, and his batting can strengthen the lower middle order. Together, the two could give India some leverage in the middle overs, particularly against teams looking to consolidate after the Powerplay. However, the team management is yet to see returns from pushing Axar to No.5, ahead of KL Rahul — 0 and 7 in the first two ODIs.

If Axar settles down in his bowling role, it would also allow India to retain Kuldeep as a tactical alternative rather than making him the automatic choice. That isn't necessarily a reflection of diminished faith in Kuldeep's ability. His capacity to take wickets through the middle overs remains a significant asset. But in South Africa, the risk-reward calculation could change drastically.

The downside of this strategy is that India could risk looking too conservative. World Cups are not won simply by preventing opposition teams from scoring but by taking wickets at key junctures. But considering how the one-day game is riding the wave of 350-plus scores right now, restrictive bowling could also prove an attacking ploy. Axar's challenge would be to establish that he can stem the run flow as well as provide breakthroughs when needed.

His batting — particularly the six-hitting frequency—will also need attention. The New Zealand series has offered little evidence of Axar's ability to influence the middle order, and the absence of Jadeja makes that contribution more relevant.

India can't afford to replace one allrounder with another and then discover that the batting balance has weakened. But they also have enough time to experiment. The emerging picture is unmistakable though. Axar is being positioned as a quasi-defensive spin bowling anchor, with the New Zealand tour offering an early indication of the responsibilities that could come with that elevation.



Aaryavir Sehwag celebrates his ton against UAE. BCCI

Aaryavir hits 160 to power India into semi-finals

HT Correspondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Aaryavir Sehwag continued his impressive run of form in the U19 Asia Cup, smashing 160 off 168 balls to help India beat UAE by 70 runs on Tuesday. This was his second substantial contribution in the tournament, following a 70 against Nepal last week.

Sehwag's knock, studded with 17 fours and seven sixes, propelled India to 309/7. In reply, UAE could only manage 239. Pacer Ishan Sood played a key role with figures of 4/37.

India will play Afghanistan in the semi-final.

"Feels amazing. When I started my innings, the thought process was to play long and bat for 40-50 overs. The wicket was challenging as it was turning. But everything went well," Sehwag said after bagging the Player-of-the-Match award.

With this, Sehwag registered his maiden century for India in Youth ODIs. He has already played marathon knocks of 297 in the Cooch Behar Trophy and 173 in the Vinoo Mankad Trophy for Delhi U19.

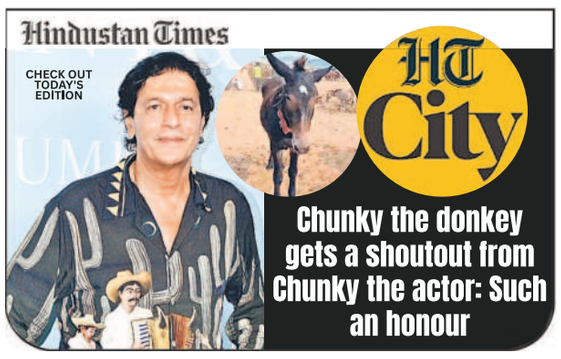
While accepting the award, Sehwag revealed the promise he had made to his father, Virender Sehwag. "I wanted to make a big score. I had promised my father. I told him I would get a big hundred because he only respects big hundreds. It's necessary to score 150 after 100 to make him happy. Feels great that I could do it," he added.

After captain Lakshya Raichandani fell for 17, the opener, who was subdued and patient during the first half of his innings, added 193 runs for the second wicket with VK Vineeth (67 off 69).

At one stage Sehwag was 63 off 91 balls. Then the floodgates opened. Fours and sixes became a more regular feature. Sehwag was particularly severe on left-arm wrist-spinner Uddish Suri, plundering him for two sixes and two fours in a 21-run 37th over. He reached both his 50 and 150 with sixes.

The innings reflected what Sehwag had stated before the start of the tournament: that he wanted to bring a bit of Virat Kohli into his game, alongside his father's traits. The blend was evident in his approach.

"I love taking to the attack. I'm a huge Virat Kohli fan and like to play my cricket aggressively. Not just the Sehwag way but the Kohli way as well. I would love to dominate every side that comes against us and try to do as much as I can for the country and win games for India."



Ghaziabad Development Authority
VIKAS PATH, GHAZIABAD
(ISO 9001 : 2015 & ISO 14001 : 2015 certified organization)

पत्रांक– 1621 / 4 / E.E. Zone- 3 / 2026–27 दिनांक– 10 / 11 / 2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)
For
Interior works of proposed office building at Madhuban Bapudham Yojna, Ghaziabad. U.P.

Details of RFP can be downloaded from the website https://etender.up.nic.in/ from **date 13.11.2026**

Bid Start Date	-	**13.11.2026**
Pre-Bid Meeting	-	**25.11.2026 time 12:00**
Bid Submission End date	-	**05.12.2026**
Bid Opening Date	-	**07.12.2026**
Tender Fees	-	**Rs.18,054.00 (on https://gdaghz.procure 247. com/ Tender Pay/x-login.)**
EMD Fee:	-	**Rs. 101.48 Lakhs (on https://gdaghz.procure247.com/TenderPay/x-login.)**

Further enquiry can be made from Executive Engineer (EE Zone-3) on mobile no 7290046784 during office hours (10:00 AM To 5:00 PM).

Chief Engineer

ई-मेल : helplinegda@gmail.com, @Gda Ghaziabad : gdagzb
हेल्पलाईन नं: 0120-4418384 व्हाट्सएप :9990988004,वेबसाईट : www.gdaghaziabad.in
एक सुन्दर शहर ..... हमारा संकल्प

INDIAN RAILWAYS
PATIALA LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
(Formerly Diesel Loco Modernisation Works)
PATIALA-147 003
Tel: 0175-2396000, 2396001 Fax: 91-175-2306413

ENGAGEMENT OF ONE (01) CONTRACT MEDICAL PRACTITIONER

Candidates (including Retired Railway/ Govt. Doctors), willing to work as **Contract Medical Practitioner (CMP)/GDMO** are called for **Walk-in-Interview on 04.12.2026** for engagement on contract basis initially for one year at Railway Hospital. PLW/Patiala on the terms and conditions available at our website **www.plw.indianrailways.gov.in** < News and Announcement < Recruitment < Contract Medical Appointments < Contract Medical Practitioners.

Dy. Chief Personnel Officer
PLW/Patiala

3938/2026
Serving Customers with a Smile

DEPARTMENT OF ARCHAEOLOGY
GOVERNMENT OF N.C.T. OF DELHI
2nd Floor, B-Block, Vikas Bhawan-II, M.G. Road, Civil Lines, Delhi-110054
Email: deptt-ofarchaeology@delhi.gov.in, Phone: 011-23814026

FELLOWSHIP Applications are Invited for Fellowship i.e. Senior Research Fellow (SRF) & Junior Research Fellow (JRF) in the Field of Archaeology and Conservation

Category/ Field/Area of Research	Eligible Age	Amount (per Month)		Period	No. of Fellowships		Prescribed Qualification
		SRF	JRF		SRF	JRF	
Archaeology	Up to 40 years	Rs. 50,000/	Rs. 25,000/-	1 Year	03 (UR)	03 (UR)	**SRF -** PhD in Ancient Indian History, Culture & Archaeology/History **Desirable:** Post Graduate Diploma in Archaeology from any recognized institute or university **JRF -** Masters Ancient/Medieval Indian History or Masters in Archaeology
Conservation	Up to 40 years	Rs 50,000/-	Rs 25,000/-	1 Year	03 (UR)	03 (UR)	**SRF -** PhD in Conservation, Preservation or Heritage Management. **Desirable:** Post Graduate Diploma from Conservation from any recognized institute or University **JRF -** Masters in Conservation, Preservation and Heritage Management Or Masters in Conservation

Please Note:-
- Those who are presently receiving a fellowship from Central/State Government are not eligible
- Application forms and requisite terms & conditions are available at the Department or can be download from the following website link:-
  https://archaeology.delhi.gov.in/latest-news
- Application must reach the department within 30 days of publication of advertisement.

SECRETARY
(Art, Culture & Language/Archaeology)
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0282/26-27

30001/144/2627

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001,Odisha
CIN:U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in

OMC ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

Short Notice for sale of Manganese Ore

The Odisha Mining Corporation Ltd intends to sell various grades of Manganese Ore produced from Dubna-Sakradihi Iron and Manganese Mines of Barbil Region in Keonjhar District, Odisha through National e-Auction which will be conducted by MSTC Ltd. The e-auction shall be held from **11.00A.M to 2.00 P.M on 20.11.2026.**

The National e-Auction for sale of Manganese Ore will be conducted by MSTC Ltd. in MSTC Portal i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com** very shortly.

For details, please visit the website OMC Ltd. i.e. **omcltd.in**

Chief General Manager (S&M)
OIPR - 30001/30005/1/26-27/0110

सत्यमेव जयते
Government of India
Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
Department of Social Justice and Empowerment

Notice Inviting Applications

Department of Social Justice & Empowerment, Government of India invites online applications for study in Masters and Ph.D courses abroad under National Overseas Scholarship Scheme for eligible students belonging to the Scheduled Castes, De-notified Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Tribes, Landless Agricultural Labourers and Traditional Artisans category for the second round of selection year 2026-27.

The portal will remain open for inviting the applications from **03-11-2026** to **02-12-2026** and, thereafter, the portal shall be reopened from **03-12-2026** to **06-12-2026** for editing/making corrections only.

The detailed guidelines for filling the form are available on the portal. Before filling the form, the candidates are advised to check their eligibility strictly as per the Scheme Guidelines.

The link of the portal is **https://nos.dosje.gov.in**

Scan QR to know more about the scheme

CBC38101/11/0005/2627

INSTITUTE OF HUMAN BEHAVIOUR & ALLIED SCIENCES (IHBAS)
(Hospital based autonomous academic Institute, under Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi dealing with)
"Brain- Mind Problems & Their Solutions"
Dilshad Garden, Delhi - 110 095 (India)
Tel.: 22114021 Extn. 285, E-mail: jda-ihbas@delhi.gov.in, Website: www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in

Advt. No. 2/6198/26/Estt/IHBAS/10443 Dated: 05.11.2026

Recruitment Notice

Applications are invited from the citizens of India for the following Faculty posts on Regular Basis

Part-A

S. No.	Name of post	No. of Post	Reservation UR	SC	ST	OBC	EWS	Pay Matrix Level	Mode of Recruitment
1	Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs. 168900-220400	Regular basis
2	Professor (Neuro-surgery)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs. 168900-220400	Regular basis
3	Professor (Psychiatry)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-14A; Rs. 168900-220400	Regular basis
4	Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs. 168900-220400	Regular basis
5	Additional Professor (Neurosurgery)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs. 148200-211400	Regular basis
6	Additional Professor (Psychiatry)	04	02	01	--	01		Level-13A2+; Rs. 148200-211400	Regular basis
7	Additional Professor (Neurology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs. 148200-211400	Regular basis
8	Additional Professor (Clinical Psychology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs. 148200-211400	Regular basis
9	Associate Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs. 138300-209200	Regular basis
10	Associate Professor (Psychiatry)	05	--	--	01	04	--	Level-13A1+; Rs. 138300-209200	Regular basis
11	Associate Professor (Neurology)	03	02	--	--	01		Level-13A1+; Rs. 138300-209200	Regular basis
12	Associate Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs. 138300-209200	Regular basis
13	Associate Professor (Psychiatric Social Work)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs. 138300-209200	Regular basis
14	Assistant Professor (Psychiatry)	08	--	01	--	07	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
15	Assistant Professor (Neurology)	02	--	01	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
16	Assistant Professor (Neurosurgery)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
17	Assistant Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	02	01	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
18	Assistant Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
19	Assistant Professor (Nero-psychopharmacology)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
20	Assistant Professor (Psychiatric Social Work)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs. 101500-167400	Regular basis
	TOTAL	**38**	**14**	**03**	**01**	**20**	**--**		

(Allowances will be as per rules. For details of eligibility criteria i.e. Qualification, Experience, Age & Application Format please visit our website (**www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in**). Interested and eligible candidates may apply with appropriate format photograph, along with duly attested copies of qualification, Diploma/ Degree, experience certificates etc., Demand Draft of Rs. 1000/- (Exempted for SC/ST and PwD candidates) in favour of "Director, IHBAS". Upper age limit is relaxable for Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe and Other Backward Classes and PwD candidates as per rules. However, OBC certificate issued by the Authority of Delhi Govt., only will be accepted. Institute reserves the right to increase/decrease, fill or not to fill any/all the vacancies.

Age Relaxation of 5 years will be applicable for Government employees as per GOI guidelines.

PwD reservation as per Govt. Rules.

Allowances will be as per Rules. Category of Posts mentioned at Sl. No. 01 to 07, 09 to 12 & 14 to 19 are **'Medical Discipline'** and Sl. No. 08, 13 & 20 are **'Non Medical Discipline'.**

The application duly filled-in along with necessary documents must reach to the Office of Director, IHBAS, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095 **on or before 10.12.2026**. The applicant who is in service of Central Govt./State Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Autonomous Body shall have to submit his/her NOC at the time of interview. A certificate from the employer is also required to be submitted that in case of his/her selection his department will be relieved him/ her to join IHBAS.

(For complete details please visit our website **www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in**)

(Lt. Col. R.K. Sharma)
Joint Director (Admn)

MENTAL ILLNESSES ARE TREATABLE

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0281/26-27

Money matters: High cost of chasing a chess dream

Behind India's 100 GMs are families that spent lakhs and staked years on a dream, not knowing what will run out first — money or belief

Susan Ninan
susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com

₹15-₹25 lakh The pursuit of a GM title can cost families between ₹15-20 lakh or more annually in air fare, accommodation, visa, tournament entry fees and coaching expenses

> "It started with a few lakhs per year, mainly focusing on nationals and other tournaments in India. In the initial years, we restricted Ethan from participating in international tournaments since they were expensive. Over the last two to three years, we spent approximately 15-20 lakhs p.a towards coaching, travel and tournament fees."
> — **EDWIN VAZ,** father of Ethan Vaz who became India's 96th GM in June this year

> "For every player who makes it to the grandmaster title, there are many talented ones who have to give up on the dream because it's too expensive. For India, it's surely been an exponential growth arc to get to 100 GMs. But, it must be said that much of the progress has happened despite the system."
> — **RB RAMESH,** Coach

BENGALURU: Chess coach RB Ramesh recalls a conversation not long ago with a sobbing parent. It was a familiar story. A family struggling to afford overseas travel for norm tournaments, a young player's rating taking a beating and confidence beginning to fray. To break the cycle, they needed money. Money to travel, compete and climb back up the rating ladder.

On Sunday, India got its 100th grandmaster.

"For every player who makes it to the grandmaster title, there are many talented ones who have to give up on the dream because it's too expensive," Ramesh says. "For India, it surely has been an exponential growth arc. But it must be said that most of the progress is despite the system."

The GM title carries no prize money. Earning it, however, can cost a small fortune. Behind the required three norms and 2500 Elo rating are years of coaching, tournament fees, flights, visas and hotel bills. For aspiring players, chess ability is only part of the test. The other is financial endurance.

"More than 90 per cent of the grandmaster norms are being made abroad because we don't have enough norm tournaments in India. This means only those who can afford to travel are making norms. Those who are talented but cannot afford to go abroad are left behind. This has always been the case," Ramesh says.

Families can end up spending ₹15–25 lakh or more a year on coaching and competition, particularly during the intensive norm-chasing years.

"We spent approximately ₹15–20 lakh annually on coaching, travel and accommodation," estimates Edwin Vaz, whose son Ethan became India's 96th GM in June.

Heena Sadhwani, whose son Raunak earned the title six years ago, puts her family's annual expenditure on chess at ₹20–25 lakh during those years. "Financially, it was a major commitment, and you're also dealing with a lot of uncertainty. Unlike many other sports, there isn't a proper pathway or support system in place for players trying to earn the title."

The bill depends on the number of tournaments played, the countries visited and, perhaps most cruelly, how long the norms take to arrive. Europe offers numerous opportunities, but travel there is expensive.

Pranav Venkatesh, reigning world junior champion and recently crowned world junior blitz champion, missed major overseas age-group events growing up because his family could not afford them, his father Venkatesh recalls.

"He was too young to travel alone, and it was tough to afford the expenses of accompanying him. Only after he reached a rating of 2100 did we begin travelling outside India for tournaments. Even then, we chose the more economical ones in Dubai and Malaysia. He became a GM within a year of becoming an International Master, so we didn't have to chase norms for too long."

For Mayank Chakraborty, who this year became the Northeast's first GM, even access to strong coaching presented a logistical challenge. His mother Monomita hosted grandmasters from other parts of India.

"We hosted a grandmaster at home for the first time in 2018. We paid for his both way airfare from Kolkata and training charges of ₹42,000 for around five to six days."

Another coach charged ₹10,000 a day. When the family invited him back after Mayank's rating rose to around 2350, three and a half days cost ₹50,000, airfare extra.

The GM title can ease some expenses. Organisers sometimes offer GMs 'conditions': waived entry fees, accommodation, meals and, occasionally, flights or appearance fees. Yet these benefits too depend on rating and reputation. At the 2026 Serbia Open, advertised appearance fees ranged from €200 (approx. ₹21,000) at the lower end to €1,500 (approx. ₹1.57 lakh) for players rated above 2650.

"If a player is ambitious and does well, things can fall into place. After Pranav became world junior champion, invitations followed," Venkatesh says. Pranav collected approximately $43,000 (₹38 lakh) in prize money from three tournaments last year, excluding appearance fees.

According to Chess.com, 26 top GMs earned six-figure tournament prize sums in 2025. Among them were Arjun Erigaisi ($431,214, around ₹4.04cr from 16 events), R Praggnanandhaa ($317,122, around ₹2.97cr from 14) and D Gukesh ($202,292, around ₹1.89cr from 13 events).

For the vast majority, the financial reality is starkly different.

Anuj Shrivatri, who declined a software engineering job and became India's 100th GM last weekend, has coached alongside playing to maintain an income. He intends to continue. Others have moved into full-time coaching, finding it more rewarding financially than competing.

For those still chasing the GM title, it is almost a race between what runs out first: funds or belief.

Manu Bhaker falls agonisingly short of LA quota berth

Avishek Roy
avishek.roy@htlive.com

Manu Bhaker. ISSF

NEW DELHI: The Indian 25m women's pistol team won gold at the ISSF World Championships in Doha but that provided little consolation as Manu Bhaker and Esha Singh, the two finalists, failed to secure an LA Olympic quota place.

Manu came agonisingly close to winning the quota and a medal for India after multiple shoot-offs in a high quality final, but finished fourth. The first three shooters — Olympic champion Jin Yang of Korea, Thu Vinh Trinh of Vietnam and Yueyue Zhang of China — bagged the three quota spots.

Double Paris Olympics medallist Manu had earlier finished fifth in air pistol, missing the quota in that event too. India have so far won just one Olympic quota, which came in men's 10m air pistol through Jaypal Malviya.

On Tuesday, Manu and Asian Games silver medallist Esha shot superbly in the second stage of qualification (rapid round) to make it to the eight-shooter final. Esha totalled 590 to take third place and Manu (587) qualified sixth, while TS Divya (584) finished 10th. The trio tallied 1761 points to clinch the team gold, finishing ahead of South Korea (1748) and Vietnam (1745).

In the final, Esha managed just one hit out of five (a hit is 10.2) in the first series, and though she had five out of five in the next series, she could not cover enough ground. Manu started with two hits but kept getting better.

After the third series, Manu and Esha were tied seventh. That's where the elimination started and Manu turned it around. She struck four in a row to survive while Esha bowed out in eighth (11/20).

Next, Manu was tied with Doreen Vennekamp of Germany in seventh place and came through three rounds of tense shoot-off to survive. The competition got fiercer at this stage. After the sixth series, Manu, Zhang and the seasoned Veronika Major were all tied with 20 hits (out of 30) and were involved in another series of shoot-offs. Manu retained her composure and pulled through, leaving the other two to fight for elimination.

With five shooters left to fight for three quota spots, the drama was still to unfold. After the 7th series, Manu, Zhang and Joana Castelao of Portugal entered another tie-breaker, having scored 24/35.

Manu calmly negotiated this one too, and was placed joint third with Zhang (24 hits). Vietnam's Trinh was at the top with 31 hits and Yang was in the second position (29). In the next series that decided the LA quota places, Manu had three hits, while Zhang had five out of five under pressure to seal the quota. Trinh and Yang also scored 5/5. All three eventually made the podium and took the Olympic quota places.

SKY REDISCOVERS JOY OF CRICKET AFTER THE PAIN OF INDIA AXING

HT Correspondent
sportm@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Suryakumar Yadav admitted that losing his place in the India T20 side after leading the side to the 2026 T20 World Cup was a very difficult phase for him.

Talking at the T20 Mumbai League event held on Tuesday to felicitate the tournament winners, Surya said: "Post the T20 World Cup, it has been a little difficult. I don't want to run away from the fact...if you're not honest to yourself, it's very difficult to lead a happy life. To be very honest, it has been very difficult but then at the same time, during IPL I was blessed with a baby girl in May. So, the focus shifted completely towards her. So, the last few months since she's born have been very beautiful."

The 36-year-old, India's 360-degree batter until not so long ago, added: "The first two months after IPL were difficult but then I thought why not think about how I was before. How I started my cricket, when I used to think I want to play age-group cricket for Mumbai, I want to play First-Class cricket for Mumbai.

"All these things I chatted with my wife and she said the same thing, that you need to bring back that love and passion for the game, what you had when you were a 15-year-old kid who wanted to represent Mumbai in age group.

"So, that's what I am following now, what I did 10-15 years ago — training again, following the same passion for this game — and everything is back to normal. When you start thinking about it and you're focused to play the sport, you want to do well for your team and your family things change completely... The main goal is what I used to think before — win the championship for Mumbai."

India A-NZ A unofficial Test ends in draw

LINCOLN: Jasprit Bumrah and Ravindra Jadeja's hopes of getting game time went down the drain as the third unofficial Test between India A and New Zealand A ended in a draw after the fourth and final day of the match was washed out. All three games ended in draws. India A had scored 464/5. NZ A had scored 36/2.

Boxer Ambekar enters Youth Olympics semis

DAKAR: Boxer L Ambekar Meetei assured India of a medal in the Youth Olympic Games defeating Namibia's Abraham Kalenga to advance to the semi-finals of the men's 50kg category. Meetei won via Referee Stops Contest (RSC) in his quarterfinal.

SL struggle to 114/3 after Pak declaration

RAWALPINDI: Debutant pace bowler Saqib Khan grabbed two wickets as Sri Lanka were 114/3 on Day 2 of the opening Test after Pakistan declared at 434/9. Kamindu Mendis (40) and Dhananjaya de Silva (22) were unbeaten at the close.

Pant likely to leave for NZ on Nov 12

NEW DELHI: Wicketkeeper batter Rishabh Pant in all likelihood will get fitness clearance from BCCI CoE and leave for NZ on Thursday. Pant, who sustained a side strain while playing Irani Cup for Rest of India, was initially named in the India A squad for one unofficial Test subject to fitness. However, he didn't get the required 'RTP' (Return To Play) certificate from the CoE.

Gayatri-Treesa pair advances in Japan

KUMAMOTO: The Indian women's doubles pair of Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly progressed to the pre-quarterfinals with a 21-17, 21-14 win over Hinata Suzuki and Nao Yamakita in the Kumamoto Masters Japan Super 500.

Savita makes way for Bansari in hockey ACT

NEW DELHI: Goalkeeper Savita Punia has been rested from the Asian Champions Trophy in Bhopal, replaced by Bansari Solanki in the Indian women's hockey squad. The tournament is scheduled to be held from Nov 19 to 28.

Another chess experiment: Now, an all-format world tournament

Susan Ninan
susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Is there such a thing as format fatigue in chess? Is it setting in already? While we catch our breath, a spanking-new chess tournament with a somewhat complicated format – the Total Chess Pilot, strategically scheduled just ahead of the Fide World Chess Championship – is here for its pilot run in Budapest.

It will be played across three time controls — fast classic, rapid and blitz — and features a galaxy of top players, with the man who went cold turkey on the classical World Championship after five consecutive title wins — Magnus Carlsen, spotted watching Peppa Pig on his flight to Budapest in his new role as a father — leading the line-up.

A nine-round blitz Swiss on the opening day carries no points or prize money but serves as a tie-breaker for the group stage and determines the seeding of the knockout semi-finalists. The group stage will run from November 11 to 15, with 24 players divided into four groups, playing two fast classical games (45 minutes plus 30 seconds per move) each day. The knockouts that follow will feature all three time controls – four blitz games, two rapid games and one fast classic game.

Last week, Carlsen posted a picture from his pre-tournament training camp in Spain, where he was analysing with his coach Peter Heine Nielsen, friend and commentator David Howell, and what appeared to be his training partner, world No.5 Nodirbek Abdusattorov. Also present at the table was Carlsen's toddler son. Abdusattorov, who has spoken of helping Javokhir Sindarov prepare for his World Championship match against D Gukesh, will also play in the tournament. So will three of India's stars – R Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi and Vaishali Rameshbabu.

Two of the three Indians – Vaishali and Arjun – have been drawn in the same group. Bibisara Assaubayeva, the only other female player in the tournament, is also in their group. Carlsen, two-time World Championship challenger Ian Nepomniachtchi and Anish Giri are in the same group, with Carlsen playing Giri in Round 1.

A full Total Chess World Championship Tour is planned for the first half of 2027 and the eventual winner will be crowned Fide World Combined Champion.

"The weird thing is we're going to have these different World Championships, which are not the classical one," world No.3 Fabiano Caruana, who too is among the tournament's star-studded line-up, said on the C-Squared podcast. "And then if Magnus wins, we're going to say: 'This proves that the classical World Championship is getting more obsolete.' And if Magnus doesn't win, then the winner of this new championship is just an accident."

Speaking to HT on Tuesday, Nepomniachtchi called the Tour interesting for its blend of formats, while maintaining that the classical World Championship would remain unmatched in history and prestige. "This reminds me a bit of the Grand Chess Tour, and also the Grand Prix, which I miss because it was one of my favourite ways to qualify for the Candidates earlier. The title, of course, is quite important, but perhaps even more important is that, I believe, starting next season two top players would qualify for the Candidates.

"Hikaru (Nakamura) isn't playing here. But besides that, arguably everyone from the top 20 is participating. It's really great to see so many strong players. So, of course, it's not even about the title, but about the opportunity to win in such a strong and arguably close competition."

WORLD ATHLETICS RELEASES ENTRY STANDARDS FOR 2028 LA OLYMPICS

HT Correspondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: World Athletics on Tuesday published the automatic entry standards for the Los Angeles Olympics, scheduled to be held from July 15-30, 2028.

The athletics programme in LA will comprise 23 women's and men's events each as well as two mixed relays – 4x100m, which makes its Olympics debut, and 4x400m.

As has been the case for recent outdoor global championships, the qualification system is based on a dual pathway. Rather than the previous 50/50 model, 40 percent of athletes are expected to qualify through entry standards and the rest through world rankings.

Should more athletes than that allotted by event achieve the entry standard, those with the best performance in the qualification period will get through. Achieving the entry standard thus does not automatically guarantee a quota place, WA said on its website. In such cases, no athlete will be qualified by world rankings.

For Indians, two-time Olympic medallist Neeraj Chopra will have his task cut out with the entry standard in men's javelin set at 85.50m. For men's long jump, the mark is set at 8.30m while the women's standard is 6.90m, meaning the likes of Ancy Sojan and Shaili Singh will have to rewrite the former's national record (6.88m) to earn a direct quota.

For marathon, the qualification and ranking period runs from November 1, 2026 to April 30, 2028. For 10,000m, combined events, race walks and relays, the window is from December 19, 2026 to June 18, 2028. For all other events, the period runs from June 19, 2027 to June 18, 2028.

HT City Delhi

Wednesday, **November 11**, 2026

■ 4 PAGES. HTCITY@HINDUSTANTIMES.COM @HTCITY @HTCITYYT

ENTERTAINMENT & PROMOTIONAL FEATURES

'The festive week is all about food!'

Actor Rakul Preet Singh reflects on evolving family traditions, festive celebrations and balancing indulgence with fitness

RAKUL'S REVELATIONS

ONE FESTIVE THING YOU CAN NEVER RESIST?
Sweets I can resist, food I can't

SAREE OR LEHENGA THIS FESTIVE SEASON?
Either, whichever is lighter

ONE SONG THAT DEFINES THE FESTIVE VIBES?
Jai Jai Ram and Mangal Ram

ONE WORD TO DESCRIBE YOUR PERFECT FESTIVE TIME?
Great food, great company, friends and family. That's all!

FONDEST FESTIVE-TIME MEMORY?
It is really difficult to encapsulate so many memories and find one

Vishakha Pandit

vishakha.pandit@hindustantimes.com

With Diwali giving way to Bhai Dooj, actor Rakul Preet Singh looks back at the festivities, from family gatherings to food and traditions. "Diwali has always been one of my favourite festivals. I love how the house is lit up, how you meet your friends and family, enjoy great food, dance and celebrate this beautiful festival of love and light," she says, recalling how bursting crackers was once a childhood favourite. Marriage to actor-producer Jackky Bhagnani has also introduced her to new customs. "My mother-in-law is amazing with pujas, and I have learnt a lot from her and understood how everything works. We haven't necessarily started a new tradition of our own, but we like doing the Diwali puja together as a family," she shares.

Food, however, remains a festive highlight. "The entire week of festivities leads to a lot of indulgence in different kinds of sweets, halwas and food," she says. So how does the fitness enthusiast balance it all? "One trick Jackky and I follow is that we finish dinner before heading to these parties. We then end up snacking rather than eating a very heavy meal. But we never take a complete break from our routine because then it is tougher to bounce back."

On the work front, Rakul is currently seen as Surpanakha in Nitesh Tiwari's *Ramayana: Part 1*, starring Ranbir Kapoor, Sai Pallavi and Yash. "My wish is that the film reaches a new benchmark in Indian cinema," she says.

PHOTO: ANUSHREE FADNAVIS/ REUTERS

Delhi's first recreational river cruise sets sail amid post-Diwali pollution concerns, sparking a debate over tourism and the Yamuna's health

PHOTO: SALMAN ALI/ PTI

YAY, YAMUNA! BUT AT WHAT COST?

Snigdha Nalini Oreya

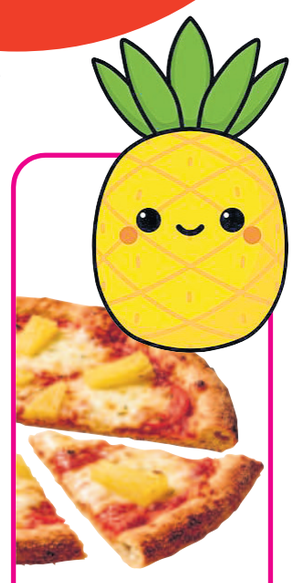
snigdha.oreya@hindustantimes.com

Diwali may be over, but the festive spirit continues as Delhi gears up for Chhath Puja on Sunday. Amid worsening air quality and persistent concerns over Yamuna's pollution, Delhiites have a new attraction to explore: a river cruise! Launched on Tuesday, the Capital's first recreational river cruise, Namo Yamuna River Safari, has drawn both excitement and questions over the city's environmental priorities.

WHAT'S ON OFFER?
Operating along the Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur stretch, the electric-powered cruise covers approximately 5-6km in 35-45 minutes, accommodating up to 30 passengers. Tickets are expected to cost ₹500 per person. The riverfront development also envisages food kiosks, a restaurant and a kid's zone.

CRUISE CONTROL OR POLLUTION CONTROL?
Welcoming the initiative, Paralympian Deepa Malik says, "A lot of developed cities have cruises on their rivers, and if we aspire to become a Viksit Bharat, this is a step in that direction. We have a beautiful, historic city and river." But she also urges residents to take responsibility for pollution, particularly after Diwali.

Artist Samar Jodha offers a contrasting perspective, comparing the cruise to paid tours of Mumbai's Dharavi. "With the Yamuna cruise, it is our own damage, something all of us have done to the river as citizens, and now we are being asked to pay to look at it, except the boat runs on the stretch above Wazirabad, which was picked because the water is still clean there, before the drains come in." He adds, "In November, with the air the way it is, I doubt you can see across the water from the deck anyway." Odissi dance guru Sonal Mansingh, meanwhile, sees the initiative as an opportunity to reconnect with the river's cultural significance. "The cruise was launched yesterday, between Govardhan Puja and Bhai Dooj, making it an auspicious beginning on the Yamuna, the sacred river associated with Shri Krishna. I believe it will bring positivity to Delhi." Hoping the experience will also educate visitors, she adds, "Yamunaji deserves our respect, affection and admiration, and I hope the cruise will also offer people information about the river's importance and significance."



Pineapple on pizza: Yay or nay?

Sweet surprise or pizza crime? Pick your side, cast your vote and stand a chance to win an exciting prize! →03

Suresh Raina's sister Renu on Bhai Dooj: I knew all his secrets growing up

PHOTO: X/ IMRAINA

No matter how big a star Sonu (Suresh) becomes, he will always be my little brother.
RENU RAINA TANEJA

I was a mischievous child, so I am sure Renu has plenty of stories she could embarrass me with!
SURESH RAINA

Karan Sethi

karan.sethi@hindustantimes.com

For former India cricketer Suresh Raina, 39, his elder sister Renu Raina Taneja has always been someone who knows him simply as Sonu, long before cricket catapulted him to fame. As the siblings reminisce about their childhood in Ghaziabad on Bhai Dooj, Renu recalls his mischief, their festive celebrations and the wedding he missed while playing a Ranji Trophy match.

"For me, Bhai Dooj is one of those occasions when I get to remind Sonu that no matter how big a star he becomes, he will always be my little brother," says Renu, who is four years older. Recalling their childhood celebrations, she laughs, "I always looked forward to applying tilak on his forehead and praying for his happiness and well-being. But, he would be more interested in the sweets and what was being prepared in the kitchen."

The 39-year-old cricketer admits he was quite a handful growing up. "I was quite mischievous as a child, so I am sure Renu has plenty of stories she could embarrass me with! Whether it was getting into little trouble while playing or doing something I wasn't supposed to, I always hoped she'd be on my side." Renu admits she often covered for him, but made sure he knew she was privy to all his secrets. There is, however, one occasion she still teases him about. "Sonu couldn't attend my wedding and we missed him terribly that day," she recalls, adding, "Even today, whenever we go through my wedding photographs, I always say, 'We missed you so much that day!' It's an emotional memory for both of us, but also one that makes me incredibly proud of him because that game was a big moment in his cricketing journey." For Suresh, Renu has been his constant through it all. "She was there long before cricket became a big part of my identity. With her, I can just be Sonu, her brother." Though busy schedules sometimes keep them apart on Bhai Dooj, a phone call is enough to bring back childhood memories. As Renu puts it, "My only prayer is that he always stays healthy, happy and at peace."

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ PAULMCCARTNEY

STOP PRESS

Former Beatles member and singer-songwriter Paul McCartney has emerged as the world's third-richest musician, with an estimated net worth of $1.4 billion, according to a recent Forbes report. Rapper Jay-Z tops the list with a fortune of $2.8 billion, followed by singer Taylor Swift at $2 billion.

PHOTOS: YOGEN SHAH AND X

It's such an honour that people still remember me and feel that naming something after me will get them eyeballs. Any news is good news

Chunky the donkey gets a shoutout from Chunky the actor: Such an honour

Rishabh Suri

rishabh.suri@hindustantimes.com

A donkey named Chunky has given actor Chunky Panday, 64, a reason to laugh after fetching ₹72,000 at the annual donkey fair in Chitrakoot, Madhya Pradesh. Traders also named donkeys after Amitabh Bachchan, Shah Rukh Khan and Mithun Chakraborty to attract buyers, but Chunky reportedly fetched the highest price, leaving the actor amused.

"This is such an honour that people did this. My friends have been sending the news clipping to me, and any news is good news!" he laughs. Taking the unusual tribute in his stride, the actor tells us, "I have been seeing this happen for 30 years now. In fact, it is done in barber shops as well, where stars and their hairstyles are advertised. There's even a burger named Chunky Paneer Panday at a burger joint."

PHOTO: KIRSTY WIGGLESWORTH/ AP

At 81, M John Harrison becomes oldest Booker winner

British author M John Harrison has become the oldest winner of the Booker Prize at 81, bagging the 2026 award for his post-apocalyptic novel *The End of Everything*. Harrison, the first writer from the established science fiction community to win the prestigious literary honour, received the £50,000 (approximately ₹62 lakh) prize after a unanimous decision by the jury chaired by historian Mary Beard. Set on England's Kent coast, the 198-page novel follows a man and his elderly aunt struggling to survive in a world transformed by a mysterious disaster. Calling it "the politics of now seen through the lens of the future", Beard said the book "turns you upside down, raises a wry smile" and leaves readers with optimism. Harrison, whose career spans six decades, beat Canadian author Margaret Atwood, who was 79 when she jointly won the prize in 2019.

Reacting to his win, he said "the era of genres as fences and boxes, pigeonholes, is over." HTC

NOTE TO READERS: Some of the coverage that appears on our pages is paid for by the concerned brands. No sponsored content does or shall appear in any part of HT without it being declared as such to our valued readers.

PHOTO: X

Pawan Kalyan, third wife Anna separate after 13 years

Telugu actor and Andhra Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan, 55, and his wife Anna Konidela, 46, have announced their separation after 13 years of marriage. In a joint statement issued late on Monday, the couple said they had decided to part ways with "mutual understanding and respect", but would remain friends and committed parents to their children, Mark Shankar Pawanovich, 9, and Polena Anjana Pawanova, whose age is not publicly confirmed. Requesting privacy, they said their children's well-being would remain their priority.

While the statement did not disclose the reason for the split, a source close to the family confirmed that a divorce petition had been filed. The two married in September 2013.

This was Pawan's third marriage. He married Nandini in 1997, separated from her in 1999 and finalised their divorce in 2008. He then married actor Renu Desai in 2009, before divorcing her in 2012. They have two children, Akira Nandan, 22, and Aadya, 16. HTC

I dislike the corporate nature of the job: James Gunn on DC exit

Filmmakers James Gunn and Peter Safran have stepped down as co-heads of DC Studios, four years after taking charge. The announcement comes after Warner Bros Discovery, DC's parent company, merged with Paramount to form Skydance. Addressing his departure in a social media post, Gunn reflected on his tenure, admitting that the corporate demands of the job had taken a toll. "My time at DC Studios has been trying, to say the least. I dislike the at-times corporate nature of the job," he wrote, adding that balancing projects he was passionate about with his responsibilities as a studio head had been difficult.

PHOTO: FACEBOOK/ ILLIT

ILLIT's Break Even debuts at sixth on Billboard 200

Kpop girl group ILLIT has entered the top 10 of the US Billboard 200 for the first time. According to Billboard's chart preview released on Monday, the group's latest EP, *Break Even*, debuted at No. 6, reported The Korea Times.

This marks ILLIT's fifth entry on the chart and its first in the top 10. The Billboard 200 ranks the week's most popular albums in the US based on physical and digital sales, streaming, and digital track downloads.

'STAGE IS MUCH TOUGHER THAN SCREEN'

Actor Shweta Tripathi talks about her return to stage and how she doesn't let the box office success of Mirzapur: The Movie put her under pressure

Vishakha Pandit
vishakha.pandit@hindustantimes.com

The festive season comes on a professional high for Shweta Tripathi with the recent box office success of *Mirzapur: The Movie*, and her return to the stage this month. The actor is excited to come back to the theatre as it is where it all started for her. "Stage is much tougher than screen because your reaction on stage is instant and there is no scope of editing. There is a lot of self control, a lot of craft, and the kind of discipline it requires is of another level," she says.

While Shweta is happy with the success of *Mirzapur*, she doesn't take any pressure from it. "If we make it a big deal, it becomes a big deal. An actor's job finishes on set. We are just supposed to do justice to what the writer has written and what the director wants. After that, there is so much which is not in our control, so we should take care of what is in our hands," she insists.

Dabbling into multiple mediums of acting keeps the excitement of the craft alive for the 41-year-old. "Be it on stage or even just through voice in a radio play, I love performing. I just don't want to restrict myself," she says, adding that the audience's love pushes her to experiment more. "Seeing the support I have received from the audience for my work, I now feel I don't have to be scared while choosing any character," the actor ends.

A still from *Mirzapur The Movie*

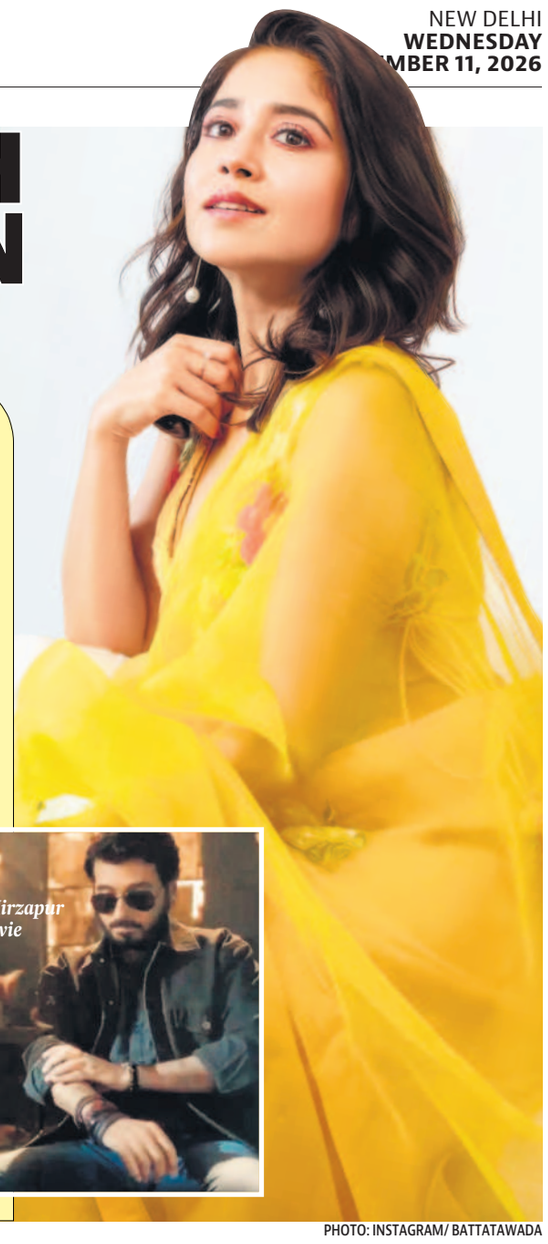


PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ BATTATAWADA

Donal Bisht with her brother Ranjan Bisht

PHOTO: INSTAGRAM/ SAMANTHARUTHPRABHUOFFL

I make sure to be home during Bhai Dooj every year: Donal Bisht

S Farah Rizvi
farah.rizvi@htlive.com

For TV actor Donal Bisht, known for shows such as *Ek Deewana Tha* and *Roop - Mard Ka Naya Swaroop*, Bhai Dooj holds a deeply personal charm, and says she would not miss a chance to celebrate the festivities with her family and brother, Ranjan Bisht.

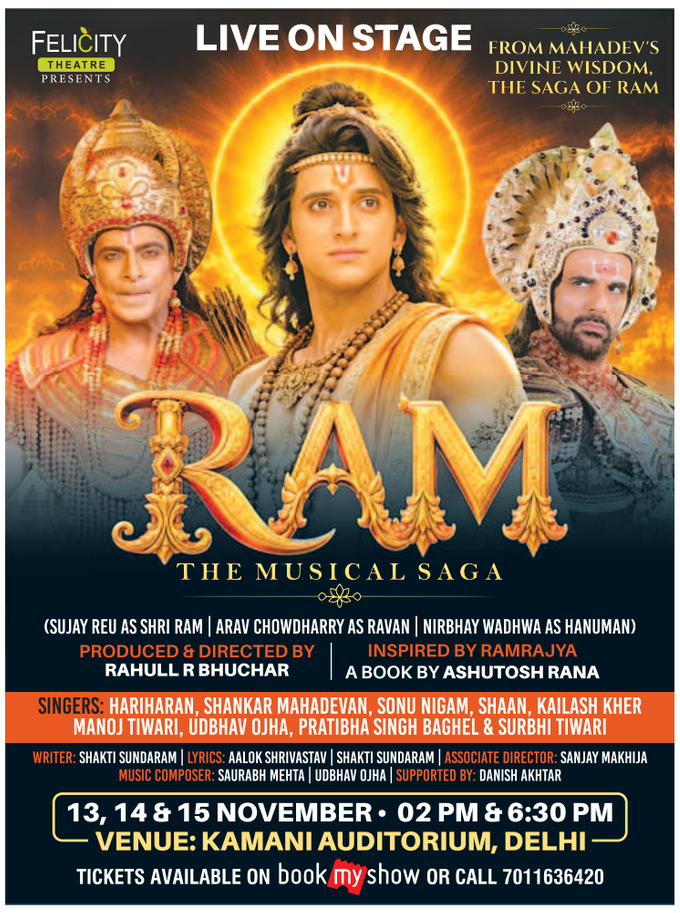
Now based in Mumbai for work, she makes it "an absolute priority" to take a breather and head home to Delhi every year for celebrations. "The days around the festivities are always special. During this time, all you want is to go home, be with your family, and celebrate together," says Donal, sharing that her Diwali holiday routine extends seamlessly into Bhai Dooj. "I usually stay at home during the festival, celebrate with my brother, family, and then return to Mumbai. This has been my routine for many years now," adds the 32-year-old.

Recalling her favourite childhood memories with her brother, Donal remembers spending hours bursting crackers, lighting sky lanterns. Over the years, however, their celebrations have evolved into quiet family moments. "We all come together as a family for the puja. We perform it ourselves, chant mantras, and sing devotional songs together. It brings everyone even closer," says Donal, who was born and raised in Rajasthan.

When it comes to Bhai Dooj festive preparations, the sibling duo has a clear division of responsibilities. Donal takes complete charge of the aesthetic domain, while her brother handles the execution outside. "I am the one who takes care of everything, whether it is the decorations, rangoli, or puja arrangements. I prefer handling the interiors because I feel girls are naturally better at these things. His department is mainly about bringing the puja essentials and crackers! So, we have our own little division of responsibilities, and it works perfectly for us," she explains.

On gift exchanges, Donal adds she never has to ask anything from him. "I am not demanding because I always get whatever I want from my brother. He is very caring, and whenever I am facing any problem, he is always concerned and tries his best to help me find a solution."

HT Classifieds { THEATRE & PLAYS }



Samantha's no-fuss maternity shoot

Actor Samantha Ruth Prabhu has given fans a glimpse of her pregnancy journey with a playful take on elaborate maternity photoshoots. On Monday, she shared a relaxed picture of herself lounging on a sofa in a red printed kurta and white trousers, posing with both hands on her baby bump. "Consider this my maternity shoot," she captioned the Instagram post.

Samantha and her husband, filmmaker Raj Nidimoru, are preparing to welcome their first child together. Recently, the actor shared a glimpse of Raj assembling a baby monitor stand as they get ready for the arrival.

The couple got married on December 1, 2025. HTC

{ DAILY HOROSCOPE }

Wednesday, November 11, 2026

Dr Prem Kumar Sharma (Astrologer and Vaastu expert) can be contacted at: **Delhi:** 011-47033152, 40532026 (Sat to Mon); **Panchkula:** 91-172-2562832, 2572874 (Tues to Thurs); **Mumbai:** 09716145644 (Last week of every month)

PREMASTROLOGER | PREMASTROLOGER | ASKPREMASTROLOGER

ARIES
MAR 21-APR 20

Mental clarity helps you stay focused on personal goals without unnecessary distractions. A project at work demands deeper research before progress feels secure. Family matters could test patience.
LOVE FOCUS: Moving past emotional hurts brings ease to relationships.
LUCKY NUMBER: 1 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Green

TAURUS
APR 21-MAY 20

Overexertion could leave you feeling more tired than expected. A cancelled insurance policy might expose dependents to unwanted financial risk. A coworker's attitude makes interactions uncomfortable.
LOVE FOCUS: Your approval can make someone feel supported and valued.
LUCKY NUMBER: 17 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Dark Grey

GEMINI
MAY 21-JUN 21

Clearing smaller dues can reduce financial clutter. Sudden workflow changes might test professional resilience. An impromptu trip with a friend may be skipped due to work.
LOVE FOCUS: Shared responsibilities deepen mutual respect.
LUCKY NUMBER: 11 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Baby Pink

CANCER
JUN 22-JUL 22

A digital detox can give your mind valuable rest and improve mental freshness. Lower royalty payments could create financial strain. International assignments might support career growth.
LOVE FOCUS: Reassuring signs remain uncertain, so avoid assumptions.
LUCKY NUMBER: 7 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Cream

LEO
JUL 23-AUG 23

Easing joint discomfort can improve mobility. Economic recovery could gradually create fresh financial opportunities. Building technical expertise can strengthen your professional value.
LOVE FOCUS: Leave negativity behind to protect warmth in relationship.
LUCKY NUMBER: 3 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Yellow

VIRGO
AUG 24-SEP 23

A calculated financial approach can strengthen readiness for significant property commitments. Proactive self care is likely to improve ongoing health concerns and support better daily comfort.
LOVE FOCUS: Revisiting memories can bring warmth to old personal bonds.
LUCKY NUMBER: 6 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Purple

LIBRA
SEP 24-OCT 23

A strategic professional partnership may develop, but aligning expectations takes time. A property purchase may prove worthwhile in the long run.
LOVE FOCUS: Quality time with your partner can bring excitement.
LUCKY NUMBER: 2 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Red

SCORPIO
OCT 24-NOV 22

Strong market knowledge can reinforce professional credibility. Smart choices create additional income streams and strengthen monetary confidence. Timely guidance from someone close can prove valuable.
LOVE FOCUS: Genuine concern makes you feel valued and supported.
LUCKY NUMBER: 8 **LUCKY COLOUR:** White

SAGITTARIUS
NOV 23-DEC 21

Improved well-being can encourage a change from routine. Preparing for unexpected expenses can protect future property-related plans. Reassessing your strengths can sharpen academic direction.
LOVE FOCUS: Your handling of a sensitive matter gets appreciation.
LUCKY NUMBER: 4 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Blue

CAPRICORN
DEC 22-JAN 21

A demanding assignment could progress favourably through focused effort. Routine medical checkups can help you stay ahead of emerging health concerns. Monetary matters move in a reassuring direction.
LOVE FOCUS: Feeling settled can bring greater emotional stability.
LUCKY NUMBER: 9 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Beige

AQUARIUS
JAN 22-FEB 19

A family discussion leads to a satisfying solution. Purposeful movement can support physical balance. Healthy cash flow makes everyday finances feel easier to manage.
LOVE FOCUS: Household tension could limit happiness despite mutual effort.
LUCKY NUMBER: 18 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Orange

PISCES
FEB 20-MAR 20

A property dispute could move towards resolution and bring welcome relief. Regular stretching can improve posture and flexibility. Thoughtful financial decisions may strengthen future monetary stability.
LOVE FOCUS: Genuine appreciation eases tension and supports harmony.
LUCKY NUMBER: 22 **LUCKY COLOUR:** Saffron

PHOTOS: ADOBE STOCK(FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY)

An Italian chef, pineapple pizza, and a fresh internet row

The firing of an Italian chef, Davide Tamburella, for refusing to make a pineapple pizza has reignited the age-old debate over whether the fruit belongs on the dish, stirring reactions worldwide.

WHAT HAPPENED
Tamburella, who worked at the now-closed La Costa restaurant in Brisbane, Australia, was sacked after refusing to make a ham-and-pineapple pizza for a group of guests. During a recent meeting, he stood his ground, stating that any direction from management "need not be followed when it is offensive to my culture."

THE BACK STORY
The irony in all this? The infamous 'Hawaiian pizza' originated neither in Italy nor Hawaii. It is believed to have been created in 1962 in Canada by a Greek-born chef named Sam Panopoulos, who added canned pineapple to a pizza after being inspired by sweet-and-sour Chinese dishes.

SOCIAL MEDIA REACTION
Tamburella's stand fuelled the long-running debate on social media. On November 9, Domino's Australia posted on Instagram, "We can confirm that pineapple still belongs in our kitchens... Our thoughts with Italy during this difficult time," and social media users were quick to pick sides. "Pineapple on pizza is a hate crime," declared one user. "Bro took one for the whole nation of Italy. Give this man a medal!" commented Tamburella's supporter. "If warm fruit on baked dough is wrong, I don't ever wanna be right. Team Hawaiian forever!" argued a defender.

HTC

Participate in the food feud to win a lucky prize

Do you like your pizza topped with pineapple or is it an absolute deal-breaker?

Cast your vote by scanning the QR. One lucky winner gets to take home a special prize!

A BIB-LICAL COMEBACK

From embellished overlays to sculptural styles, bibs are moving beyond kids' wardrobes to make a fashionable comeback for grown-ups

Snigdha Nalini Oreya

Actor Genelia Deshmukh's statement zardozi bib by Divani features Mughal-era-inspired motifs

JODI's bib is crafted from hand-block printed floral chanderi fabric

Designer Aseem Kapoor's red bib is crafted with detailed resham thread embroidery

Dash And Dot's multi-coloured bib top comes with bead and tassel details

Designer Tarun Tahiliani's OTT line features embroidered organza bibs

PHOTOS: INSTAGRAM

WHAT'S THE BUZZ

Traditionally reserved for children at mealtimes, bibs were once purely functional. But designers and style enthusiasts are now turning them into statement accessories. "A bib can completely change the mood of an outfit. It brings drama to the neckline and offers a canvas to play with embroidery, texture and embellishment," says designer Pallavi Mohan, who had previously introduced the style in her collection. Echoing her, fashion stylist Namrata Singh Dhakarey calls bibs "a hybrid between jewellery, layering and clothing." She sees the trend as part of a shift towards more expressive accessorising. "People are moving away from subtle accessories and are more comfortable with creating a statement piece," she adds.

HOW TO STYLE

- Pair a structured or embellished bib with a **crisp white shirt** and straight-leg trousers or denims for an effortless, stylish look
- Adding a statement bib to a **little black dress** can do all the accessorising for you
- Pair a dramatic bib with a **plain tank top** or **fitted T-shirt** for an interesting casual-meets- embellished look
- You can layer a bib with a structured **blazer** for a quirky, editorial finish
- Experiment with bibs over simple **kurtas**, solid **blouses** or understated **sarees** to add texture and interest to traditional silhouettes

Style tip: Don't overaccessorise. Bibs make a statement around your neck, so skip oversized earring or layered necklaces.

Inputs by Namrata Singh Dhakarey

HOW TO CHOOSE

Invest in two versatile bib pieces: one statement design and another simpler option for everyday wear.

Where to buy

- **AutumnLane** for co-ord sets featuring bib details, starting at ₹2,625
- **JODI** for lightweight and breathable styles, starting at ₹8,490
- **Sunday Story** for denim, lace and cotton bibs, starting at ₹2,999
- **Yell** for lace bib styles, starting at ₹5,000
- **After Studio** for beaded and embroidered designs, starting at ₹5,500

PHOTO: CHATGPT(AI GENERATED FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY)

Is pollution stealing your glow?

As the Air Quality Index (AQI) hit a high post-Diwali, beauty experts share the side effects of pollution and how to protect your skin and hair

Radhika Bhirani

The effect on skin

Airborne pollutants, particularly fine particulate matter, can settle on the skin and contribute to oxidative stress. This may weaken the skin's natural protective barrier, making it vulnerable to dryness, irritation and inflammation. "Prolonged exposure to environmental pollutants can lead to premature skin ageing, uneven pigmentation and a loss of skin radiance," says Dr Nivedita Dadu, founder and chief dermatologist from Dadu Medical Centre, Delhi. She adds, "Strengthening the skin barrier should take priority over experimenting with multiple active ingredients or beauty treatments."

TIPS FOR SKINCARE

- Cleanse your face after returning from outdoors
- Avoid aggressive scrubbing and excessive exfoliation
- Follow it with a moisturiser
- Apply broad-spectrum SPF 30 or higher sunscreen
- Stay away from unfamiliar skincare products

PHOTO: ADOBE STOCK

How hair faces the brunt

Dust and particulate matter can accumulate on the scalp, leading to itching, irritation and discomfort. Environmental exposure, combined with heat styling, dryness and inadequate hair care, can leave hair looking rough, lifeless and more prone to breakage. Dr Nandini Dadu, aesthetic physician and hair restoration expert, says, "People who already experience dandruff, scalp sensitivity or hair fall may notice their concerns becoming more troublesome during high pollution." She cautions, "Persistent itching, excessive shedding or visible thinning should be evaluated by a specialist."

WAYS TO PROTECT

- Cover your hair with a scarf when stepping outside
- Wash the scalp regularly with a mild shampoo
- Condition the lengths
- Avoid excessive heat styling and tight hairstyles

Beyond beauty

The impact of pollution goes much deeper than what is visible on the skin or hair. Dr Ankur Nandan Varshney, senior medical oncologist, Medanta Hospital, Noida, explains, "Fine particulate matter can travel deep into the respiratory system, triggering inflammation and aggravating existing health conditions. People with asthma, chronic respiratory diseases and cardiovascular problems are particularly vulnerable during periods of deteriorating air quality".

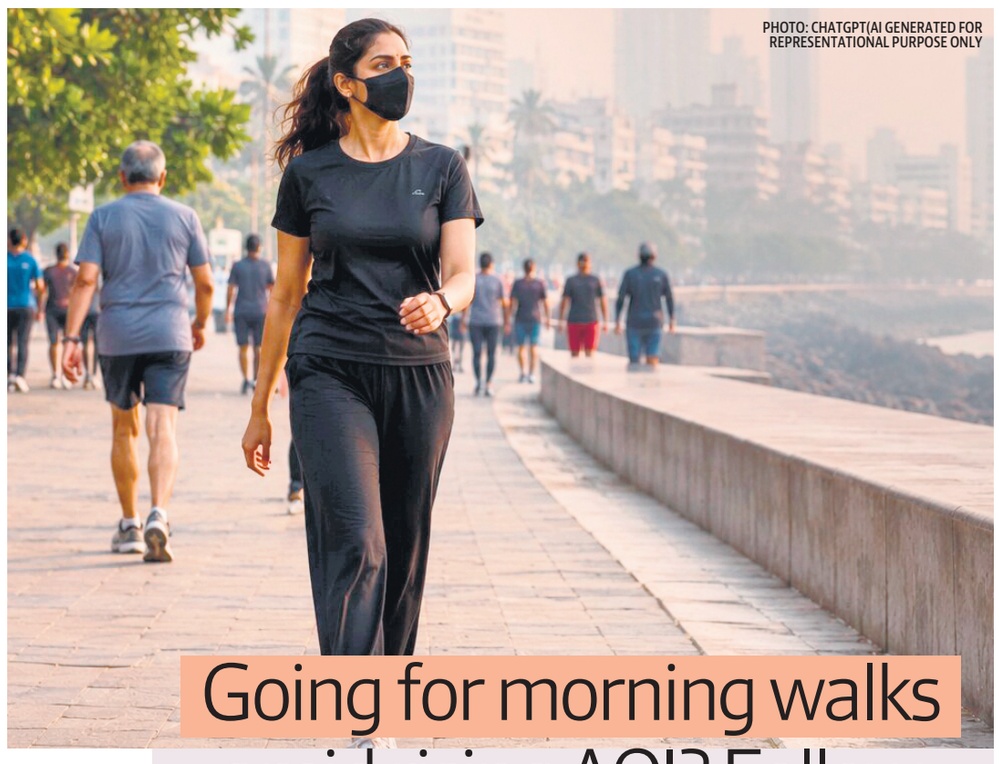


PHOTO: CHATGPT(AI GENERATED FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY

Going for morning walks amid rising AQI? Follow these 7 precautions

Morning walks support physical and mental well-being, but rising pollution levels can make outdoor exercise risky. Dr Tarang Kulkarni, consultant pulmonologist at Jupiter Hospital, Thane, shares seven precautions to follow before heading out.

1. CHECK AQI BEFORE STEPPING OUT
Make checking the local air quality index (AQI) part of your morning routine. If it is poor or worse, shift your walk indoors, particularly if you belong to a high-risk group.

2. CHOOSE YOUR WALKING TIME WISELY
Don't assume that 5-6am is the safest time to walk. Temperature inversion and low-wind conditions can trap pollutants close to the ground. Check local air quality before deciding when to exercise.

3. PICK A CLEANER ROUTE
Avoid roads with heavy traffic, junctions, bus depots, construction sites and visible dust or smoke. Choose parks and walking tracks away from major roads. Trees alone do not guarantee clean air.

4. ADJUST YOUR WORKOUT INTENSITY
Avoid brisk walking, jogging, running and strenuous outdoor exercise when pollution levels are high. Reduce the duration and intensity of your walk or exercise indoors. Increased breathing during strenuous activity can mean greater exposure to polluted air.

5. TAKE EXTRA PRECAUTIONS WITH ASTHMA OR COPD
If you have asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD), avoid outdoor exercise on high-pollution days. Follow your prescribed medication plan and carry your rescue inhaler, if applicable.

6. DON'T IGNORE BREATHING DIFFICULTIES
Stop exercising and move indoors if you experience unusual coughing, wheezing, chest tightness or breathlessness. Seek medical evaluation if symptoms persist or worsen. Severe breathlessness or chest pain warrants urgent medical attention.

7. KEEP AN INDOOR WORKOUT ALTERNATIVE
Poor AQI need not mean skipping physical activity. Try indoor walking, treadmill exercise, stationary cycling or other suitable indoor workouts.

Debapriya Bhattacharya

ILLUSTRATION: ADOBE STOCK

Bhai Dooj: All you need to know about the stories, rituals and shubh muhurat

On the festival celebrating sibling warmth today, revisit the stories behind the tilak. Here's how it is marked across states and why 11.11 is in focus this year

DIFFERENT NAME, SAME GAME

Sisters apply a tilak and exchange sweets and gifts with their brothers. The festival goes by Bhai Phota in Bengal, Bhau Beej in Maharashtra, Bhai Tika in Nepal and Yama Dwitiya in parts of southern India.

THE MYTHOLOGY OF IT ALL

As per legend, Yama, the god of death, visited his sister Yamuna. Touched by the welcome, he blessed brothers who receive a tilak from their sisters on this day with longevity and freedom from fear. Another tale celebrates Lord Krishna's welcome by his sister, Subhadra, with a tilak after he defeated the demon Narakasura.

SO, WHEN TO APPLY THE TILAK?

Bhai Dooj traditionally closes the five days of Diwali celebrations that begin with Dhanteras. This year, the tithi spans two calendar dates, which has led to confusion over when to celebrate. Citing the Panchang, Pandit Narendra Upadhyay says the Dwitiya tithi of Kartik Shukla Paksha runs from 2pm on November 10 to 3.53pm on November 11. Astrologer Jai Madaan recommends applying the tilak at 11.11am on November 11, pointing to the spiritual coincidence of the date and time. She says Amrit Siddhi Yog, a period considered auspicious for success in astrology, lasts from around 6.40am until 11.38am that day. Madaan suggests using the ring finger, associated with the Sun, to apply a kesar tilak to your brother's forehead. The ritual is believed to boost his confidence and bring him fame and success. She also suggests offering him jaggery instead of chocolates.

AQI CHATTER: DELHI MARKETS TAKE A HIT AHEAD OF BHAI DOOJ

PHOTOS: SANJEEV VERMA/ HT(FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSE ONLY)

> Footfall has reduced by 40%, affecting sales. We are hoping pollution kam ho jaaye, so people can step out and visit markets.
>
> **SHALINI DEMBLA,** Owner of Rajouri Garden-based Fashion Bells

Anshita Jain

anshita.jain@hindustantimes.com

As a thick blanket of smog engulfs the city and AQI breaches 300 most of the day, festive shoppers are ditching the physical allure for online Bhai Dooj shopping. Does this mean the usually bustling shopping hubs are now deserted? Shopkeepers share how it's affecting their daily business.

"Pollution ke chakkar mein almost poori market khali padi hai," says Shalini Dembla, owner of a Rajouri Garden-based accessory store, Fashion Bells. "Last year, Karwa Chauth, Diwali aur Bhai Dooj ke aas paas itna rush rehta tha that we used to be busy attending to customers all day. But now, shoppers are buying online and that is affecting our sales," she adds.

This year, the day after Diwali was a Monday, when most markets were closed. Due to the weekly closure, the difference in footfall wasn't immediate, says Vikas Paul, owner of bridal store Nargis in Lajpat Nagar's Central Market. "But keeping past experience in mind, sales do take a hit. Serious buyers, like those who start wedding shopping after Diwali, avoid coming to the market (due to pollution), which reduces our sales."

Meanwhile, in Kamla Nagar, visitors have reduced by 30%, informs Shrey Gupta, who owns gifting store Golden Grooves. "We experienced the smog season footfall reduction last year. In anticipation, we switched to online platforms like Instagram DMs and video calls (for orders)... Though people are not coming out to shop as much, we saw a 20% rise in our sales for Diwali and Bhai Dooj this year, thanks to our online mode."

However, going digital is not an option for everyone. Sanchit, co-owner of clothing shop Find Stalk Love in Sarojini Nagar market, says, "Lajpat Nagar and Rajouri Garden see shoppers who easily switch to online if pollution or other external issues occur. But that's not the case for us. Sarojini Nagar gets more tourists than locals, especially those seeking discounted prices. So even during the winter pollution phase, such shoppers visit physical stores as they want to touch and feel the fabric, check its fit, and see how it looks on them."

HT City Delhi Junction

FOR ALL THINGS FUN & FUNKY ABOUT DILLI
Follow on Instagram

Adopt A PET

This week, three puppers and one kitty are seeking the love and warmth of fur-ever pet paw-rents. Adopt, don't shop for pets!

Leo, a 40-day-old puppy, was left in a box outside an animal hospital. Now, he is living with his rescuer. Applications for both fostering and adoption are welcome, with screening and adoption formalities mandatory. This cutie is both naughty and playful, making him an ideal family man. His staple diet is bread and milk. To adopt or foster: Instagram DM @dogsofRohini

Charlie is an 8-month-old indie boy, rescued from a non-residential area with three members of his litter after one of his siblings passed away. Since then, he has been in foster care. This docile, friendly and well-mannered boy eats milk and roti. All he needs is a family that can shower him with the love and care he deserves. To adopt: WhatsApp 7987901776

Pogo, a 3-year-old Labrador, was rescued from a breeder. Sterilised and healthy, this beautiful girl is happy, calm and extremely friendly. Not fussy about food, all this gentle baby needs is trust and love to become a wonderful and faithful companion. To adopt: WhatsApp 9654982969

This 2-month-old tabby is presently in foster care in Gurugram and looking for a loving family to call her own. She is extremely friendly and affectionate, making her the perfect cuddle buddy for the cold winter months. She loves milk and is dewormed. To adopt: WhatsApp 8826779850

Inform us if you know of a pet who needs a home, write in to htcity.pets@gmail.com